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NEPAL DISASTER

Rescue equipment shortage hampers search operations

Death toll reaches 939, while over 4,000 people are still missing, say local authorities

Press Trust of India
Kathmandu, August 31

SECURITY PERSONNEL risking their lives to rescue survivors and recover bodies after the devastating flash floods in Nepal are facing major challenges due to shortages of specialised rescue equipment, body bags, ropes and helicopters, officials said.

The flash floods, believed to have been triggered by a collapse or avalanche of ice and rock near the Nepal-Tibet border on August 26, swept through the Bhotekoshi River corridor, destroying homes, roads and bridges and damaging hydropower projects.

The death toll from the disaster reached 939 on Monday, while over 4,000 people remained missing, according to the National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA).

Personnel from the Nepal Army, Nepal Police and Armed Police Force have been deployed in large numbers in the affected areas, but officials said the lack of state-of-the-art equipment was making operations in dangerous terrain particularly difficult, news portal ekantipur.com reported on Monday.

Among the equipment in short supply are thermal cameras, devices capable of detecting signs of life through sound, specialised tools for cutting through obstacles, body bags, ropes and advanced helicopters, the report said, quoting officials.

A police inspector said several people had contacted Police Control 100 seeking assis-



Security personnel carry out a rescue operation in Trishuli, Umerkot, on Monday. TASHI TOBGYAL

tance, but personnel were sometimes unable to reach them because of operational difficulties. The Nepal Police, considered the frontline agency in responding to emergencies, has repeatedly sought the purchase of helicopters, officials said.

Families struggle to identify victims

People are facing difficulty in recognising bodies that are recovered far downstream and brought to hospitals, where photographs, physical features and personal belongings are often being used to establish identities.

Three families initially claimed the same body at a hospital in Pokhara, each believing they had found a missing relative after Nepal's devastating floods, highlighting the growing challenge of identifying victims.

Body number 1003 at Pokhara Academy of Health Sciences was claimed by the families of Gopal Dahit, a hydropower worker from Bardiya, and Damodar Basyal, a tourist guide from Rupandehi, while a third family also initially claimed it, *Nepal News* reported on Monday. The two families still disputing the identity have agreed to undergo DNA testing.

BESENT SAYS TEHRAN ‘LASHING OUT’ NOW BECAUSE SANCTIONS TAKING HEAVY TOLL

Trump vows to hit Iran hard after first exchange of fire in a month

Continuing war is in no one’s interest, says Iran President

Reuters
Dubai, Ashville, North Carolina, August 31

US PRESIDENT Donald Trump was quoted on Monday as promising to “hit them hard” after Tehran launched missiles overnight at two US air bases in Jordan in response to a attack on Iran's Larak island.

“We’re going to hit them hard,” a *Fox News* reporter quoted Trump as telling the channel. “There will be a response.” A senior Iranian source, speaking to *Reuters*, described the overnight hostilities between the US and Iran, the first since late July, as a “limited and contained confrontation” but added that Tehran would deliver a harsh response if attacked again.

Trump also said US air defences had shot down all Iranian missiles that could have caused any damage and said that tough new economic sanctions on Iran were having a big impact, *Fox News* reported.

Washington has recently stepped up efforts to punish Tehran and its business



People drive near a billboard depicting US President Donald Trump on a building in Tehran on Monday. REUTERS

partners with costly secondary sanctions, with diplomacy in stalemate six months into a war that began with US and Israeli strikes on Iran.

US Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent, echoing Trump, said on Monday the resumed exchanges of fire showed that Iran was “lashing out” now because the new sanctions were taking a heavy toll on its already battered economy.

“They’re taking it very seriously... they’re in shock at the state of their economy,” Bessent told reporters at a meeting of G20 finance ministers in North Carolina. “I would think that they are lashing out kinetically

because they are losing economically.”

US forces on Sunday struck two Iranian launchers on Iran's Larak Island, a US official said, after “Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps forces were observed preparing to launch rockets with sea mines into the Strait of Hormuz”.

Three people were killed in the US attack, Tasnim news agency reported, and two of them had been identified as members of the Revolutionary Guards Navy. Larak is a small island in the strait near the strategic Iranian port of Bandar Abbas. In a statement, the US Central Command said it took

Chinese military firm executive held for leaking defence secrets

Beijing: A Chinese military trading company executive has been arrested for allegedly leaking sensitive defence information to intelligence agencies from two countries, China's top spy and anti-espionage agency said on Monday.

Public disclosures involving a Chinese national recruited simultaneously by multiple separate foreign intelligence agencies are extremely rare, the Hong Kong-based *South China Morning Post* reported.

The Ministry of State Security on Monday outlined the case of the suspect, identified only by his surname Zhang, in an article published on an official social media account. PTI

Putin, Xi discuss Ukraine in Bishkek as Russian drone barrage on Kyiv continues

Agencies
Moscow, Kyiv, Beijing, Aug 31

RUSSIAN PRESIDENT Vladimir Putin and Chinese President Xi Jinping touched upon the Ukraine conflict during a meeting in Kyrgyzstan on Monday, but it was not the main theme of their meeting, the Kremlin said.

Xi on Monday told Putin that under their “strategic guidance and joint efforts”, the foundations of bilateral ties will be stronger, with brighter prospects, China's state-run Xinhua reported.

“Uncertainties and unpredictable factors in the international situation have increased markedly,” Xi said. Meanwhile, Russian forces relentlessly battered Kyiv and cities in the re-



Russian President Vladimir Putin with China's President Xi Jinping on the sidelines of the SCO meet in Bishkek on Monday. AP

gion around the Ukrainian capital for a fifth straight day on Monday, leaving some supermarket shelves bare after repeated strikes on warehouses.

Spanish PM blames Russia, Israel for disinformation in Ceuta crisis

Reuters
Madrid, August 31

SPANISH PRIME Minister Pedro Sanchez said on Monday there were signs Russia and Israel had spread the disinformation over Spain's migration policy that triggered last month's rush of migrants into Ceuta, but no evidence of Moroccan involvement.

Over 72,000 migrants irregularly crossed from Morocco into the tiny Spanish territory between July 30 and 31 in an unprecedented surge at one of the European Union's only two land borders with Africa, prompting alarm across the



Spanish PM Pedro Sanchez

bloc. At least 100 people died in the attempt, according to Ceuta's local authorities.

Spanish opposition parties and some human rights groups have accused Rabat of deliberately allowing the mass crossing, an accusation Mo-

rocco has denied.

“When people talk and speculate about the participation of Moroccan authorities, I deny this outright,” Sanchez told radio station SER.

Videos on Instagram, TikTok and other social media spread misleading claims that migrants reaching Ceuta by sea could remain in Spain, encouraging thousands to attempt the crossing, Spanish authorities have said. Sanchez said research by the EU's diplomatic service EEAS had indicated that Russian and Israeli networks had been behind the spread of disinformation in conjunction with far-right networks.

• BRIEFLY

SOUTH KOREA

Unification Church leader sentenced to jail

SOUTH KOREAN court on Monday sentenced Unification Church leader Han Hak-ja to a combined two years in prison over political funding and bribery offences linked to efforts to gain influence with former President Yoon Suk Yeol's administration. The Seoul Central District Court found that Han, 83, was involved in providing money to politicians and luxury goods. REUTERS

UNITED STATES

Grand Canyon flash flood kills one, 15 missing

STATE AND federal officials ramped up efforts Monday to locate around 15 people who are missing after a major flash flood swept through in the Grand Canyon, killing at least one person. Weather forecasters warned rain and thunderstorms could bring more floods to the popular tourist attraction from where scores of visitors were evacuated following the flood Saturday in Bright Angel Creek. AP

• THE WINNERS WILL BE FELICITATED AT THE METROPOLITAN THEATRE IN MANILA ON NOVEMBER 15 WITH A MEDALLION, INSCRIBED CERTIFICATE AND AN UNDISCLOSED CASH PRIZE

Singapore diplomat, Myanmar activist & Bangladeshi aid giver win Magsaysay awards

Jim Gomez
Manila, August 31

A SINGAPOREAN lawyer and diplomat who led an international conference that adopted the United Nations Convention on the Law of the Sea, a Myanmar activist whose group documents human rights atrocities and a former Bangladeshi teacher who has helped provide aid to her country's poorest were named Monday as the winners of this year's Ramon Magsaysay Awards.

Regarded as Asia's version of the Nobel Prize and named after a popular Philippine president, who died in a 1957 plane crash,

the awards honor “greatness of spirit” through selfless service to people across Asia.

The winners of the award, first given in 1958, will be recognized at the Metropolitan Theatre in Manila on Nov. 15 with a medallion, inscribed certificate and an undisclosed cash prize.

Singaporean lawyer and diplomat Tommy Koh, 88, was recognized for promoting international dialogue and the rule of law. He is best known for presiding over a U.N. conference of more than 150 countries, which adopted the U.N. Convention on the Law of the Sea in 1982.

“Ofenommoussignificanceto maritime countries, this `consti-

tution for the oceans’ defined territorial waters and the economic rights of countries to their coastal waters and provides mechanisms for settling disputes,” the awards body said.

The UN convention was the main basis for a 2016 ruling by an arbitration panel in The Hague that invalidated China's expansive claims in the South China Sea. Beijing, however, refused to participate in the arbitration that was initiated by the Philippines in 2013 and rejected and continues to defy the decision.

China, the Philippines, Vietnam, Malaysia, Brunei and Taiwan have been locked in tense territorial standoffs in the dis-



Magsaysay Award winners Tommy Koh (left) and Bo Kyi

puted waters for decades. “Through his steadfast faith in dialogue, the rule of law and



international cooperation, he has helped make peaceful co-existence possible in a world of

unequal power,” the awards body said.

Bo Kyi, the 61-year-old winner from Myanmar, has twice been arrested in the past and spent seven years in prison for a life spent in defense of democracy and resistance against widespread human rights violations by Myanmar's military.

He has demanded the release of all political prisoners in his country, including former leader Aung San Suu Kyi, and helped raise funds to support the detainees and their families, the awards body said.

In March 2000, Bo Kyi and fellow former political prisoners

organized the Assistance Association for Political Prisoners, which has “devoted itself to documenting political imprisonment, supporting detainees and their families and ensuring the continued visibility of the junta's political prisoners in Myanmar and around the world,” the awards body said.

Runa Khan, 67, of Bangladesh won the award for “her profound empathy for the poorest of the poor in her country.”

Coming from an affluent family, she first served as a teacher to poor children in 1979. In 2002, she established an organization called “Friendship Bangladesh” that helped the

most destitute “deal with climate change, educate their children, empower women, create livelihood opportunities and bring social justice to the excluded,” according to the awards body.

Khan's group now employs more than 7,500 people, with seven hospital ships and two land-based hospitals and 550 mobile clinics, it said.

“In her hands, privilege became not an entitlement, but a responsibility; not a family legacy to protect, but a gift to be shared so that others, too, might have the chance to live with hope, opportunity and dignity,” it added. AP

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The Indian EXPRESS

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Happening today

● **DEFENCE MINISTER** Rajnath Singh will undertake the annual performance review of 16 defence PSUs.

● **THE COMMERCE MINISTRY** will meet industry associations and representatives of export promotion councils on India-US trade performance. This comes ahead of Union Minister Piyush Goyal's talks with USTR Jamie-Son Greer in late September.

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POLITICS **PAGE 5**
INDIA REJECTS HAGUE COURT'S ORDER ON INDUS WATERS TREATY

Amid pushback from within, Goa govt won't bring anti-conversion Bill in Assembly

Pavneet Singh Chadha
Panaji, August 31

AFTER PUSHBACK from legislators, including those from the BJP, the Goa government has decided not to introduce the anti-religious conversion Bill in the ongoing three-day monsoon session of the state Assembly, a BJP MLA said Monday.

The state Cabinet last week passed The Goa Prohibition of Unlawful Conversion of Religion Bill, 2026 and the proposed legislation was intended to be tabled during the monsoon session.

Goa Chief Minister Pramod Sawant held a meeting with several legislators on Monday morning, ahead of the Assembly session. At the meeting, the legislators, including some BJP MLAs and an independent MLA who backs the BJP, are learnt to have opposed the proposed legislation.

After the meeting, Michael Lobo, BJP MLA from Calangute constituency, said he felt the government acted in haste in having the Bill approved by the Cabinet. He said that in the meeting with the Chief Minister, a decision was taken not to introduce the Bill in the ongoing Assembly session.

"The Bill will not be coming. We have to study (the Bill) and »CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

HERCULEAN FEAT, SAYS PM; REFORMS BEARING RESULTS: FM

Manufacturing and services fire GDP growth to 7.8 per cent in Q1

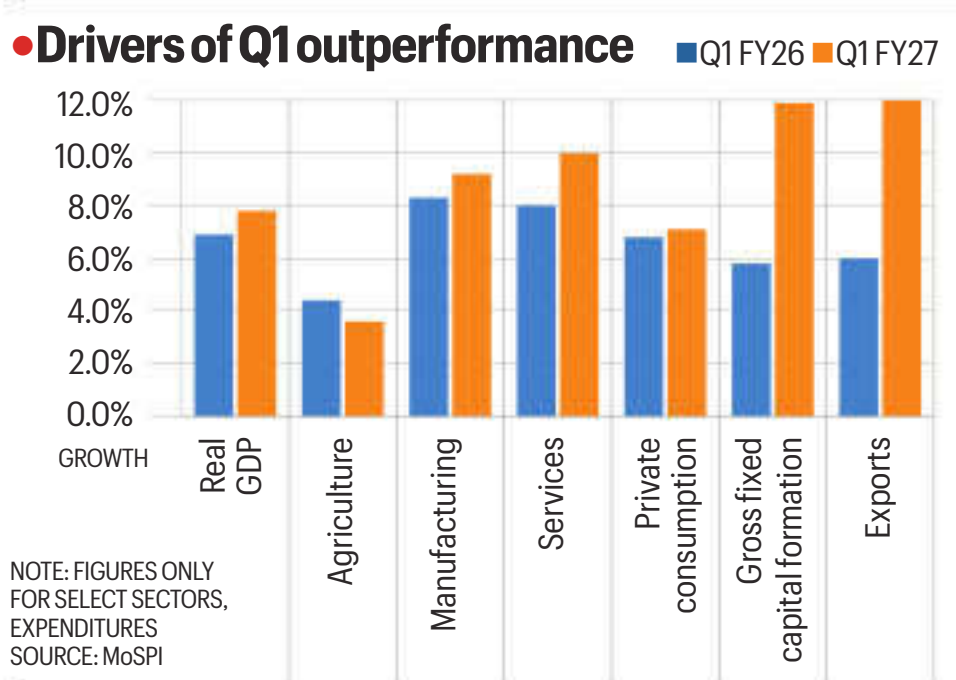
Witnessing continuous resilience, says CEA; analysts warn high growth and inflation may bring rate hike this year

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, August 31

DRIVEN BY near double-digit growth in manufacturing and services sectors, the economy grew a robust 7.8% year-on-year in the April-June quarter, despite the headwinds caused by the West Asia conflict, high energy prices and supply dis-

ruptions. This is well above the Reserve Bank of India forecast of 7%.

The manufacturing sector grew by 9.2% in April-June, up from 8.3% in the same quarter last year, while the tertiary sector — or services — expanded 10%, higher than 8% a year ago, data released by the Ministry of »CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



E. EXPLAINED

In Q1, India weathers West Asia storm

The economy weathered the West Asia conflict and the resultant turbulence, but the disruptions and high crude oil prices may last longer. This may push up inflation in India, and affect consumption in the US and Europe due to higher petrol and diesel prices.

Rajasthan HC Acting Chief Justice goes on leave; SC Collegium recommends new CJ

Allegations against Justice Sharma trigger lawyers' protests in Jaipur

Apurva Vishwanath & Hamza Khan
New Delhi, Jaipur, August 31

IN A significant move, the Supreme Court Collegium on Monday recommended Chhat-tisgarh High Court Judge Sanjay K Agarwal as the Chief Justice of the Rajasthan High Court. The decision came within an hour of Rajasthan HC's Acting Chief Justice Sanjeev Prakash Sharma going on leave.

The SC Collegium, headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, also recommended the appointment of Justice Pushendra Bhati, the second senior-most judge of the Rajasthan HC, as Chief Justice of the



Justice Sanjeev Prakash Sharma has been accused of misuse of powers by SC's Justice Sandeep Mehta

Jammu & Kashmir and Ladakh High Court.

The decisions were taken in a meeting on Monday evening in which a litany of allegations against Justice Sharma were discussed. Sources told *The Indian Express* that while there was no formal decision to ask Justice Sharma to go on leave, the Collegium will examine the allegations against him.

The development comes »CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

POLITICS **PAGE 5**
DELHI POLICE ASKS SC TO QUASH FIRS AGAINST NEET PROTESTERS



Messi hangs up his boots for Argentina

A man walks past a mural of Lionel Messi in Buenos Aires, Monday. The Argentine legend announced his retirement from international football, but will continue to be active in club football. AP **PAGE 17**

Sonia book: Penguin India lawyers asked for changes and cuts in 'several chapters'

No external pressure, claims Penguin; changes related to themes of PM's term, China, RSS and plight of minorities

Ritu Sarin
New Delhi, August 31

LAWYERS REPRESENTING Penguin Random House India flagged changes and deletions from "several chapters" of

Sonia Gandhi's upcoming book, *The Indian Express* has learnt. They prepared lists that were sent to the author in a "back-and-forth" lasting at least two months until the publishing deal fell through a few

days ago, as first reported by *The Indian Express*.

Sources said that these deliberations were "cordial" at the outset but towards the end got "rough."

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

SIR draft rolls see over 13 cr deletions so far, Delhi leads with 33% left out

Damini Nath
New Delhi, August 31

THE ELECTION Commission's Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, which began in June last year, has led to over 13 crore names being deleted from the draft rolls in 30 States/ Union Territories so far, with Delhi and Maharashtra draft rolls published on Monday showing a cut of 32.8% and 21.1%, respectively.

According to data released by the Chief Electoral Officers

● Top 5 deletions so far

State/UT	Deletion
Delhi	32.80%
Dadra and Nagar Haveli & Daman and Diu	29.60%
Telangana	21.70%
Maharashtra	21.10%
Andaman & Nicobar Islands	20.60%

of Delhi and Maharashtra, the total number of electors dropped from 1.45 crore pre-

SIR to 97.53 lakh in the draft roll, and 9.78 crore to 7.71 crore, respectively. This brings the total deletions in the third phase of the SIR in 17 States/ UTs to 6.15 crore so far.

The EC had announced the third phase of the SIR on May 14, to be held in 16 States and three UTs. So far, draft rolls in 17 of those States/ UTs have been published, while the enumeration phase is scheduled to start

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

RELATED REPORTS, **PAGE 3**

Business as Usual

By EP UNNNY



CENTRE DEFERS CENSUS EXERCISE IN MANIPUR **PAGE 6**

ALMOST A WEEK AFTER CATASTROPHIC NEPAL FLOOD, HOPE HANGS BY A SLENDER THREAD

In 'war room', workers of private firm plan search for nearly 100 missing colleagues



Residents return to check their homes after the floods, at Trishuli in Nuwakot district, Monday. TASHI TOBGYAL



INSIDE A large room on the ground floor of a midrange hotel in central Kathmandu, the air is tense. A couple of coffee tables have been put next to each other to create a longish conference table, and sofas

have been placed around it.

There are 10 people in the room. They are all staring at a wall on which a map of the region around the Upper Trishuli-1 Hydroelectric Project has been projected. Nearly 100 of their colleagues are trapped somewhere in that region.

Nepal's disaster management authorities said on Monday evening that 639 people were still missing at the sites of 15 hydropower projects — some of which were still under construction — after the catastrophic flash flood swept through the area on August 26. The Upper Trishuli-1 pro-

ject, located approximately 70 km north of Kathmandu and 30 km west of Nepal's border with Tibet, was one of them. With a planned capacity of 216 MW, it was to be the largest project in the Bhote Koshi river corridor.

In the hotel room, the discussion is on ways to rescue the stranded workers. Until which point can a vehicle travel? How long is the walk after that? Could a helicopter help?

This is the war room of the Austrian company Andritz, a project subcontractor that supplies and installs machinery for the hydropower projects. "We set up this hub

SCO SUMMIT IN BISHKEK



Prime Minister Narendra Modi with Iran's President Masoud Pezeshkian in Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan, Monday. ANI

In message to Iran's President, Modi flags dialogue, freedom of navigation & trade

By strengthening bilateral cooperation and neutralising effects of sanctions, we can further elevate ties, says Pezeshkian

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, August 31

MEETING IRANIAN President Masoud Pezeshkian for the first time since the war in West Asia began in February, Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Monday expressed "concern at the escalation of tensions" in the region and reiterated that all issues must be resolved through "dialogue and diplomacy."

The two leaders met in Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan, on the sidelines of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) leaders' summit. Modi and Pezeshkian have had at least two telephone conversations in the last six months.

The meeting on Monday took place in the backdrop of fresh attacks between US and Iran, after weeks of a fragile ceasefire. US forces on Sunday struck two Iranian launchers on Iran's Larak Is-

land. In response, Iran attacked US bases in Jordan.

In a statement, the Iranian foreign ministry said Pezeshkian asked Modi to "use India's extensive contacts with various parties to help them move away from the path of war and bloodshed and return to the path of dialogue and agreement". He cited India's "important position and capacities" in the region and the world, as well as the deep historical and cultural ties between the two countries.

The Iran readout quoted Modi as telling Pezeshkian that "during the difficult period we have recently experienced, we sought to maintain and preserve our cooperation and communications with Iran."

"From what I have come to know of your personality, you »CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Modi to Putin: Must move from endless war towards an end to war

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, August 31

FOUR-AND-A-HALF years into the war between Russia and Ukraine, Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Monday called on Russian President Vladimir Putin to move from "endless war" to "end of war".

Modi has raised the issue with Putin earlier too. "This is not the era of war," he told Putin in September 2022. Then, in a meeting with Putin in Moscow in July 2024, Modi said that "peace talks do not succeed amid bombs, guns and bullets", and a "solution (to any conflict) cannot be found on the battlefield".

In his televised opening remarks at the start of the bilateral meeting in Bishkek on Monday, Modi told Putin: "We have been discussing the Ukraine issue. When we met previously, you briefed me in detail on all aspects of the



Prime Minister Narendra Modi with Russia's President Vladimir Putin in Bishkek, Monday. REUTERS

matter. As you know, India supports all efforts towards peace, and will continue to do so."

"Every day of war sets humanity back, whereas every step taken towards peace fills humanity with new hope and enthusiasm. We must move away from endless war towards an end to the war," Modi said. "This is crucial for the well- »CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Keralam woman killed in US hit-and-run, another found dead inside flat; common friend arrested

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, August 31

THE THREE women, all from different parts of Keralam, lived in the same apartment complex in California, US. They were known to be quite close and, last week, had celebrated the festival of Onam together. Two days later, two of them were found dead – one at the same apartment’s parking lot and the other inside her flat. The third woman was arrested for allegedly causing at least one of the deaths, with police looking into possible connection with the other murder as well.

Their deaths reported on August 28 at Milpitas in California, has left the families of the two victims, and the community shocked and grappling with the possible motive behind the act.

Though police have not officially identified the victims, but according to information reaching Keralam, the deceased women are Anjana Hari, 35, a native of Thrissur, and Ann Mary Mathew, 40, from Thiruvananthapuram. Their friend Anila, 32, a native of Kottayam, has been arrested in connection with Anjana’s death.

According to the press release from Milpitas police, the deaths were reported from Mill Creek Apartment at 440 Dixon Landing Road where personnel had rushed to after receiving reports of a hit-and-run traffic collision in the parking lot.

“Witnesses reported seeing a blue SUV leaving the area immediately after the incident. When officers arrived, they found a female victim, aged 35, who had sustained significant injuries as a result of the collision. Unfortunately, she was pronounced deceased at the scene,” the press release stated.

Officers searched the surrounding area and found a blue SUV matching the description in a nearby parking lot. “The vehicle had significant damage consistent with being involved in a collision. The driver, a 32-year-old woman, was arrested in connection with the incident...” said the release. On hearing about the accident involving their friend, Ann’s husband rushed home only to find her murdered in their flat.

In its press release, the Milpitas police have not mentioned anything about the death of Ann. However, her family in Keralam said the police have confirmed to the relatives in the US about it being a case of homicide.

A family member of Anjana said, “We do not know the motive of the crime...Her husband who came down from the apartment saw his wife lying dead in the parking area. We are told that an inquest and probe are going on...” said the relative.

The relative said Chief Minister V D Satheesan and Union Minister of State Suresh Gopi had called them to help expedite the procedure to bring the body back home.

Kashmir medical interns protest Rs 12,000 stipend: ‘Does not cover cost of commuting to hospital’

Naveed Iqbal
Srinagar, August 31

AS MEDICAL interns across Kashmir held protests seeking an enhancement of their monthly stipends, alliance partner in the Jammu and Kashmir government, the Congress, has raised the issue with Chief Minister Omar Abdullah.

In his letter to the CM, Pradesh Congress chief Tariq Hameed Karra advocated for an increase in the stipends of medical interns, highlighting that young doctors routinely work long and demanding hours, including 36-hour shifts, attending to patients and performing their duties with dedication and commitment. “Despite the demanding nature of their work and the immense workload, they continue to discharge their responsibilities in the interest of patients and public healthcare,” he said.

Karra also noted that the stipend being provided to medical interns in J&K was “considerably lower” than that offered in several other parts of the country. During their protests on Monday, medical interns at the Government Medical College in Srinagar said their current stipend is just over Rs 12,000 while in other parts of the country, it is upwards of Rs 30,000.

“We are the backbone of all hospitals in J&K. We run OPDs and night shifts and yet our stipends are stuck at Rs 12,000,” Dr Anam, one of the protesting doctors, said. She said the stipends have not been revised in the last seven years.

The doctors said they have approached the government seeking a revision but have not been given an actionable response.

Termining the demands of the interns as “genuine”, Karra wrote to the CM that the issue deserves “sympathetic and immediate” consideration. “Medical interns constitute an essential and integral part of our healthcare delivery system and shoulder significant responsibilities in hospitals while undergoing their compulsory internship,” he said.

Karra also argued that the government’s “positive intervention” at this stage would not only address a legitimate concern of the medical fraternity but would also boost the morale of young doctors who are contributing significantly to the functioning of our hospitals and healthcare institutions.”

Meanwhile, J&K Health minister Sakina Itoo said that the matter has been taken up and is “under process” by the government. However, she added, “There is a financial implication to this decision and this is currently under review by the Finance Department.”

She also accepted that there is a need to increase stipend for the doctors and that the government is cognizant of rising costs. “They did not, however, need to go on strike because this affects patient care,” Itoo said.

Medical interns at various hospitals have decided to continue their strike till their stipends are enhanced.

[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM]

GDP

Statistics and Programme Implementation on Monday showed.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi said the 7.8% figure “is a herculean feat”. Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman said the government’s reforms and its “agile management” of the economy are bearing results.

“What we are witnessing is continuous resilience in the Indian growth performance,” said Chief Economic Advisor V Anantha Nageswaran, addressing reporters via video-conference from the US where he is attending G20 meetings.

Analysts, however, said high growth rates could mean a rate hike is on the horizon. A fast growing economy, inflation prints ambulating northwards, zero real interest rates, RBI monetary policy members looking at rate hike scenarios, and oil prices showing few signs of cooling, all these put together make a case for policy rate hike this year

Real Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2Vrb6RGJOKH6oBd0f>

stronger than before, said Venkatesh Balakrishnan, Head-Credit Research, SBI Capital Markets.

Earlier this month, on August 5, the RBI had left the repo rate unchanged at 5.25%.

The CEA warned that disruptions from West Asia are expected to last longer than initially expected. As such, there is “always a lurking risk of crude oil supply disruption which may prevent oil prices from declining “materially and sustainably below \$80 per barrel”. “However, more than the rise of crude oil, what we should be watching are the prices of petroleum products such as diesel and natural gas which have basically made it more expensive and that will have an implication for private consumption growth in parts of Europe and in the US,” he said.

Sequentially, the April-June GDP growth rate is lower than the 8.6% recorded in January-March, which was revised up from the previous estimate of 7.8%. It is, however, well above the 6.9% posted in the April-June quarter last year.

Sonia book

While Alfred A Knopf, a division of Penguin Random House, is the global publisher of “Belonging,” PRHI was to publish and distribute it in India. The release, scheduled for November 10, was first announced by Knopf which added that the first print run for the title would be 100,000 copies.

Among the passages that were objected to, *The Indian Express* has learnt, were: references to Prime Minister Narendra Modi and his 12-year rule; the role of the RSS; references to instances of communal divide and

riots and the plight of minorities. Representing Sonia, the wife of one of Rajiv Gandhi’s aides and a family friend worked on the book. PRHI had a team of at least three editors, including consultants.

Sources said that the author’s side pushed back with two key arguments. One, that the PRHI lawyers were being “over-sensitive.” And, two, that the “numerous” edits and deletions, as suggested by them — including mention of Prime Minister Narendra Modi or contemporary developments like the Indo-China stand-off in Galwan — would lead to an awkward situation of two versions of the book, the global edition at variance with the

As a result, economists have already begun raising their growth forecasts for 2026-27 as a whole. CareEdge Ratings, for instance, has raised its growth estimate for the year by 30 basis points (one basis point is a hundredth of a percentage point) to 7.3%, significantly higher than the RBI full-year estimate of 6.7%. Revisions were also made to previous years’ data, with GDP growth in 2023-24, 2024-25, and 2025-26 raised by 10 bps each to 7.3%, 7.2%, and 7.8%, respectively. These revisions are caused by the use of the new output Producer Price Index, the updated Index of Industrial Production data series, and the Banking Services Price Index released earlier this year.

“This marks the fourth consecutive quarter of near-potential growth rate for the Indian economy, and momentum into the second quarter of FY27 remains very strong,” said Rajni Thakur, L&T Finance’s Chief Economist.

The strong economic growth performance will be welcomed

by the RBI, which has been sending warning signals in recent weeks that interest rate hikes may not be far away.

Headline retail inflation has been rising in wake of the West Asia war and is projected by the RBI to average 5.9% in the last three months of 2026. The central bank is mandated to target inflation at 4% in a band of 2-6%.

“There are anecdotal reports in the media that corroborate the fact that the private sector’s gross fixed capital formation is showing very clear uptick even though it may be confined to a few sectors, but the bank credit growth also reinforces this feeling that there is more credit available and more investment activity in the country,” Nageswaran said.

He said all three sectors — agriculture, manufacturing, and services — had done “quite well” in the first quarter even in the face of the West Asia conflict. This was made possible partly because of the government’s efforts to make sure that input provisions were not affected by the war.

Claiming that it was “really keen on publishing as it was a hard-won acquisition,” PRHI said: “During our discussions with the author’s representatives, several points were raised and deliberated upon. On some, they agreed to changes and on others, we accepted the author’s position. Unfortunately, and ultimately, an understanding could not be reached on a particular issue. It was then that the author’s team informed us that they did not wish to proceed and we respected their decision. Since we are bound by an agreement, and author confidentiality is paramount to us, we will not divulge details of what led to the impasse.”

Americans have chosen the path of war, insecurity, and imposing their will through force,” he said.

Saying that Iran has never welcomed war, he added: “Our responsibility requires us to protect our people from danger and insecurity and to create the conditions necessary for them to achieve peace, tranquility and security.”

Referring to the agreements reached in the course of efforts to resolve existing issues, he said: “The Islamic Republic of Iran has remained committed to the obligations it has undertaken within the framework of the agreements, but unfortunately, the American side has failed to fulfill its commitments.” He said they continued to work towards achieving agreement and understanding, as the continuation of war is not in the interest “of us, the region, or humanity”.

“Unfortunately, there are groups within the US that see the continuation of war as serving their interests and seek to perpetuate conflicts. We believe,

however, that by strengthening the forces committed to peace, we must move toward peace, stability and security,” Pezeshkian said, according to Tehran’s readout. “We believe that the solution to the issues we face lies in dialogue and cooperation, and that all available capacities must be mobilised to prevent the spread of insecurity and conflict,” he said.

The MEA said Modi reiterated “India’s readiness to closely cooperate with Iran in multilateral organisations, including BRICS and SCO”, and conveyed that he looked forward to welcoming Pezeshkian to India for the BRICS summit.

The Iranian foreign ministry said the President emphasised “‘Tehran’s readiness to further develop and deepen bilateral relations”. “By strengthening bilateral cooperation and neutralising the effects of sanctions, we can further elevate the level of relations between the two countries,” Pezeshkian said, according to the readout.

PM-Pezeshkian

are a peace-loving person, and I believe that you can play an effective role in advancing the cause of peace. I am confident that your efforts will ultimately lead to positive results... I agree with you that there are those who see their interests in war, but we must intensify our efforts to establish peace. My belief and conviction is that, ultimately, peace and security will prevail,” Modi was quoted as saying.

“The two leaders discussed bilateral ties. They also discussed the recent developments in the West Asia conflict and shared perspectives on the evolving situation. The PM expressed concern at the escalation of tensions in the region and reiterated India’s consistent position that all issues must be resolved through dialogue and diplomacy,” the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said.

It said Modi reiterated the

need for continued efforts to ensure lasting peace and stability in the region. “Calling for safeguarding the freedom of navigation and commerce, he emphasised that civilians and civilian infrastructure, including commercial shipping and seafarers, must not be harmed under any circumstances,” the MEA said, referring to the attacks on ships in the Strait of Hormuz.

The Iranian statement said Pezeshkian “expressed appreciation for New Delhi’s support and cooperation... and emphasised the need to intensify diplomatic efforts to establish peace and security in the region”.

“From the very beginning of our administration, our efforts have been focused on ensuring peace and security and resolving issues through dialogue and negotiations. Unfortunately, instead of making use of diplomatic mechanisms, the

Goa Bill

take everyone into confidence. We need to know what the bill is all about. What is happening is wrong. Everyone’s religious beliefs are important, and there should be respect for all religions. Sooner or later, there needs to be a discussion on what’s good for Goa; things are moving in the wrong direction,” Lobo said.

Independent MLA Aleixo Reginaldo Lourenco, who backs the BJP-led government, said the consensus in the meeting was that the Bill will not be introduced during the session. Lourenco said the Bill is in “bad taste” and questioned the timing of the proposed legislation. “There are no religious conversions happening in Goa, according to me. There is no data, there are no statistics. So, why is it required? Goa is a peaceful state, and people here have lived in harmony. So, why disturb this harmony? I have supported the government... but this doesn’t have my support.”

“Even in a few offences that have been registered, the cases have not been charge-sheeted, and have either been quashed by the courts or closure reports have been filed,” he said. “Our religious minority organisations are involved in helping the vulnerable sections of society. There is no evidence, nor have we heard that this has resulted in conversions.”

The draft Bill proposed stringent punishment including imprisonment up to life, a minimum fine of Rs 50,000 and compensation of up to Rs 5 lakh for victims for religious conversions carried out through “force, coercion, undue influence, allurements, fraudulent means or marriage”.

SIR

in two (Nagaland and Tripura) over the next two months.

In Maharashtra, a CEO office statement showed that 3.56% of the electors were marked deceased, 15.78% permanently shifted/ absent/ others and 1.81% enrolled at multiple places, leading to their names being deleted from the draft roll.

In Delhi, the data showed that almost a third (29.86%) of electors were marked absent/ shifted/ others, 1.95% deceased, and 0.98% enrolled at multiple places.

As per the EC’s schedule, those incorrectly deleted in the draft roll can apply for inclusion in the final roll over the next one month.

The EC had started the SIR with Bihar in June last year. The second round was an-

nounced in October 2025, covering nine states and three UTs.

In the third phase, the EC covered the rest of the country, barring Himachal Pradesh and Jammu and Kashmir, where it said the SIR would be held at a later date due to the ongoing Census work and weather conditions, and Assam, where it announced that it would not conduct an SIR until the pending National Register of Citizens was published in the state.

So far, the SIR has led to the deletion of 13.37 crore names in the draft rolls across the three phases or a 14.1% deletion from pre-SIR rolls. Delhi has recorded the highest deletions so far, at 32.80%, followed by 29.60% in Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu, 21.70% in Telangana, 21.10% in Maharashtra, and 20.60% in Andaman and Nicobar Islands, according to EC data.

For the past two decades,

the EC had not conducted intensive revisions (where the electoral rolls are prepared afresh), opting to conduct annual and pre-poll special summary revisions instead, where additions and deletions were made to existing rolls.

In the SIR, the EC evolved a new procedure that requires all registered electors to submit enumeration forms within a one-month enumeration phase, “map” themselves with their names or their parents’ names in the roll of the last intensive revision that was held in the early 2000s, and submit documents to establish their eligibility.

A batch of petitions had challenged the EC’s June 24, 2025 order of the SIR in the Supreme Court, questioning the commission’s powers and process adopted in the SIR. The Supreme Court upheld the SIR order in its judgment in May this year.

Rajasthan HC CJ

days after letters by Supreme Court judge Justice Sandeep Mehta to Chief Justice of India Surya Kant became public. In his letters sent to the CJI — on August 2, August 10 and August 17 — and copied to other members of the Supreme Court Collegium, Justice Mehta accused Justice Sharma of “misuse of powers” and said he had received “several complaints”, which “raise doubts” on the Acting CJ’s “integrity”. Based on this, Justice Mehta also sought transfer of the acting CJ to another High Court and the appointment of a new Chief Justice.

The examination of the alle-

gations against Justice Sharma, the Collegium discussed, could also include looking into some of his orders that have been reportedly flagged in the complaint. There is also a view within the Collegium to tread cautiously given Justice Sharma is anyway due to retire on 26 September.

Apart from CJI Kant, the Collegium comprises Justices Vikram Nath, M M Sundresh, B V Nagarathna and P S Narsimha.

As per the updated roster for the Jaipur Bench, Justice Sharma will not be holding any sitting from September 1 to September 5.

Earlier in the day, Rajasthan HC witnessed unprecedented scenes with lawyers’ associations escalating their protests against Justice Sharma.

In Jaipur, a section of lawyers sat outside his court, while in Jodhpur, both lawyers’ associations announced a strike till Sunday and demanded that Justice Sharma be relieved of judicial and administrative duties.

Meanwhile, the SC Collegium also recommended Justice Almesh Yeshwant Kogje, a judge at the Gujarat High Court, as Chief Justice of the Madhya Pradesh HC. With these three new names, seven recommendations for appointment as Chief Justices will be pending before the government.

NCLT

members Atul Chaturvedi and Ravindra Chaturvedi.

The Special Bench has been directed to sit at 10:15 am on September 1.

The constitution of the larger Bench follows the NCLT’s earlier order approving a repayment plan under which creditors would receive only about Rs 6.25 crore against guarantees of around Rs 22,000 crore signed by Chandra. The case has attracted attention because of the exceptionally large gap between the claims and the amount proposed to be paid to creditors.

The personal insolvency proceedings against Chandra were initiated in 2024 following a petition by Indiabulls Housing Finance. The proceedings relate to personal guarantees given by Chandra for borrowings of Essel Group-linked companies and are separate from corporate insolvency proceedings involving group companies and regulatory proceedings concerning Zee Entertainment Enterprises.

The NCLT’s August 25 order

approving the repayment plan came after a split verdict by a two-member Bench was resolved by a third member. The plan received 80.814% of the voting share, while banks opposing it accounted for only 19.186%.

Banks and other creditors had raised objections over the exceptionally low recovery and questioned whether Chandra’s financial position and assets had been examined sufficiently. They had also questioned whether a forensic investigation was warranted.

On August 30, Subhash Chandra said borrowers associated with his personal guarantees had assured him that they would reconcile the accounts with lenders and settle the balance of Rs 4,262 crore.

The tribunal, however, concluded that the repayment plan could provide a better outcome for creditors than pushing the matter into bankruptcy. It also held that where creditors had approved a plan in accordance with the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code, the tribunal would not ordinarily substitute its own commercial assessment for that of the creditors.

PM-Putin

being of humanity. A peaceful resolution to all issues at the earliest is the call of humanity, and this is India’s message. The land of Gandhi and Buddha shares a single message: the path of peace,” he said.

Modi said Putin’s visit to India in December last year was “highly successful and truly memorable”. “It is a matter of deep satisfaction for us that our cooperation continues to scale new heights and that we are working together for the welfare of the people of both nations,” he said.

“Focusing on national interest as the paramount priority has been our shared approach, and this will remain our guiding principle in the future as well,” he said, hinting at India buying Russian energy over the last four-and-a-half years of the war to cushion the inflationary impact on Indians.

Putin, on his part, said that relations between the two countries “continue to strengthen on the principles of a special and privileged strategic partnership”. Addressing Modi, he said: “This is undoubtedly facilitated by your personal attention to the development of Russia-India relations, as well as by the close personal friendship that has developed between us, for which I am very grateful to you.”

Flagging economic ties, he said, “Trade and economic cooperation is showing positive trends overall. There was a slight decline last year, but in the first half of 2026, trade turnover increased by 2.6%. A week ago, the Intergovernmental Commission met in Moscow and also reported good results.” He was referring to External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar’s recent visit to Moscow where they discussed the upward trend.

“I would also like to say a few words about humanitarian cooperation. India is among the leaders in terms of the number of students studying in Russia: over the past 10 years, their number has increased sevenfold and now stands at almost 40,000,” Putin said.

Underlining people-to-people ties, he said both Indian and Russian culture festivals are held regularly. The next one is scheduled to take place in India in 2027. Tourist exchanges are also developing rapidly, increasing by 16% in 2025, Putin

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A ‘war room’ in Nepal

dead or alive.

The company executives do not have equipment to dig deep into the tunnels, but they are hopeful they won’t have to.

“Our camp was just beside the river. The area is now completely under mud, so people may be stuck in the riverbed. It’s an open area, and we can conduct search operations there. We also know the location of some people in the tunnel, and we can try to look for them as well,” Tomer said.

But the team is facing problems even before it has started out. “Why is there no Internet in this room?” someone exclaims in frustration.

The hotel WiFi does not seem to be working, and mobile phone signals are weak. “You have to go out to get connectivity,” another person says.

The team is trying to see the latest Google Earth images of the area. But they don’t have a paid subscription to the soft-

ware. None of the Nepalis have a credit card. And the cards that the Indians have do not allow international spending.

After five phone calls, a working credit card is arranged. But even the paid subscription does not provide pictures in real time.

The affected area is huge, Timer says. “Our workers can be anywhere in a 15-km stretch. We have identified five spots where we have a better chance of finding someone. The site of the camp and the inlet of the tunnel are our two priority spots,” he said.

“*Kya lagta hai? Koi milega?* (Do you think we will find someone?) someone in the room asks no one in particular. “*Kal Tuesday hai, ek hafta ho jayega* (Tomorrow is Tuesday; it will be a week since the flood),” someone else responds.

No one is ready to give up just yet, but hope in the room hangs by a slender thread.

One-third of Delhi's voters dropped from draft electoral rolls

Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, August 31

AT LEAST one-third of Delhi's voters have been dropped from the draft electoral roll published by the State Election Office on Monday, as part of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR).

The draft list has dropped around 47.56 lakh of 1.45 crore voters from the existing electoral roll. At 33 per cent, it's the "highest percentage" of deletions at the draft stage when compared to other states/UTs.

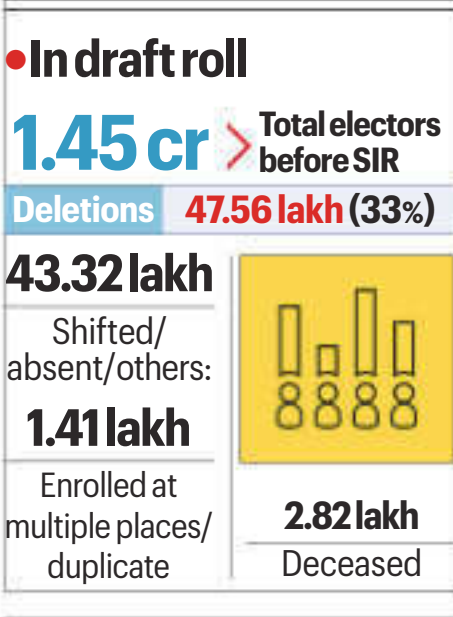
"The floating population might also be one of the reasons for the highest number of deletions in Delhi because being the National Capital, people come to Delhi in search of opportunities and they shift (back) to their native place for other reasons...", said a poll official.

As per the details shared by the Delhi CEO office, of the total 47,56,722 voters dropped from the electoral rolls, 43,32,775 have either permanently shifted or are absent or in "others" category; 2,82,412 are deceased; and the balance 1,41,535 are enrolled at multiple places.

"The BLO (booth-level officer) did not find these electors or did not get back their Enumeration Forms because they became electors in other states/UTs, were not found in existence, did not submit the form till August 17 or were not willing to register as an elector for some reason or the other," said the CEO's office.

For the voters whose names are not included in the draft roll of SIR 2026, the CEO's office said that the "BLO, in consultation with BLAs (booth-level agents), has prepared a list of voters whose Enumeration Forms have not been received."

According to officials, ag-



grieved persons whose names are not included in the draft roll can submit their claims through Form 6 along with the declaration form and supporting documents between August 31 and September 30.

Officials said claims and objections will be examined and the notice and disposal process will continue till October 29. The final roll is due on November 4.

"Genuine electors can still be added back in electoral rolls during the claims and objections period using Form 6, along with (the) prescribed declaration form. The name of the electors found enrolled at multiple places in electoral rolls will be retained only at one place. The list of ASDD (Absent/Shifted/Dead/Duplicate) electors is available on the website of CEO Delhi via the link <https://ceodelhi.gov.in/ceodelhiasdd/>...", said officials.

"Booth-wise lists of Absent/Shifted/Dead/Duplicate electors whose names are not included in the draft roll has been displayed on the notice board of respective ERO/AERO Offices, polling stations to enable the general public to have access to the aforesaid voter lists along with the probable reasons for non-inclusion of their names. These lists have

also been put on the CEO's website," said officials.

In case any elector is unable to submit her/his filled-in enumeration form within the specified time, she/he may file Form 6 along with the prescribed declaration form for inclusion during the claims and objections period.

Another objective of the claims and objections period is to give opportunities for corrections in electors' particulars and also to invite objections against any wrong inclusion in the draft electoral roll.

The CEO office also said that during the notice and verification phase, Electoral Registration Officers (EROs) will scrutinize the eligibility of proposed electors with the help of the Enumeration Forms and issue hearing notice to those who could not be linked with the electoral roll of the previous SIR or the linking has some discrepancy.

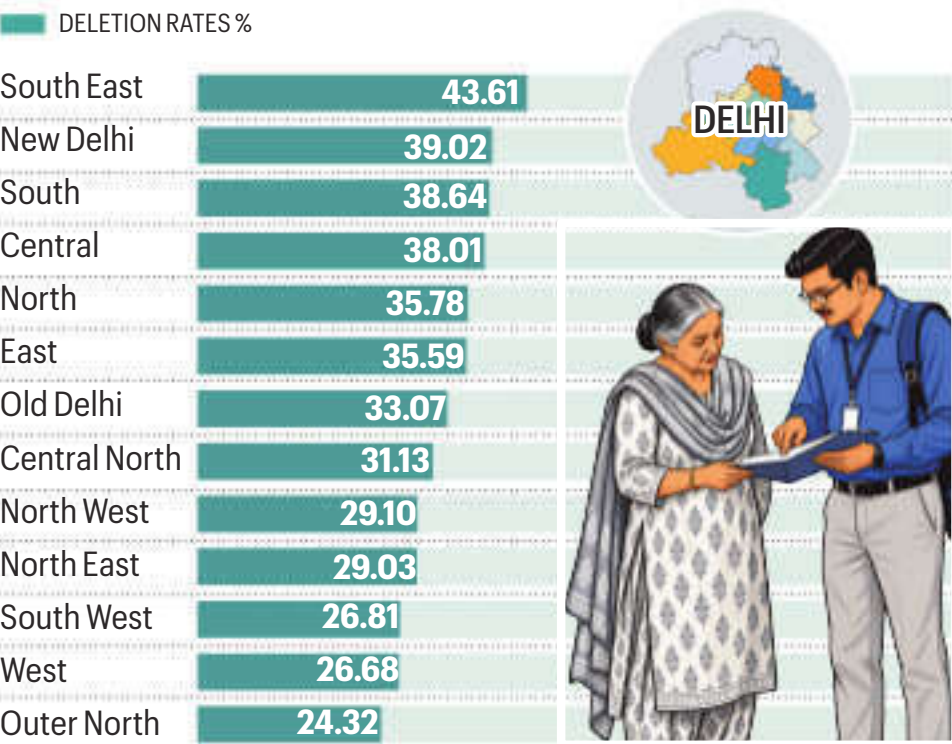
It also asked EROs and AEROs to "not delete any entry/name from the draft electoral roll without issuing notice, conducting an inquiry and giving a fair and reasonable opportunity to the person concerned whose name has appeared in the draft roll. In each such case, ERO/AERO shall pass a speaking order."

Further, the CEO office said that if any person is not satisfied by the decision of the ERO, he/she may appeal to the District Magistrate within 15 days of the ERO's order. They can file a second appeal before the CEO within 30 days of the District Magistrate's order.

The draft roll contains around 97.53 lakh electors whose enumeration forms were received and digitised during the house-to-house exercise carried out from June 30 to August 17.

Higher deletions in districts with lower turnout in '25

• District-wise deletion rates (SIR 2026)



District-wise turnout of 2025 Delhi Assembly elections

(BASED ON THE ECIS DATA OF 11 REVENUE DISTRICTS)

North East Delhi	66.25%
Shahdara	63.99%
East Delhi	62.49%
South West Delhi	61.33%
West Delhi	60.98%
North West Delhi	60.71%
North Delhi	59.61%
Central Delhi	59.12%
South Delhi	58.20%
New Delhi	57.23%
South East Delhi	56.40%

SOURCE: CHIEF ELECTORAL OFFICE, DELHI

(ELECTION COMMISSION OFFICIALLY GROUPS DELHI'S 70 ASSEMBLY CONSTITUENCIES INTO 11 REVENUE DISTRICTS. FOR SIR, DELHI HAS BEEN GROUPED INTO 13 DIVISIONS)

EXPRESS special

Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, August 31

DISTRICTS WITH the lowest voter turnouts in the last Assembly elections in Delhi have shown the highest percentage of deletions: this is what the data from the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) draft electoral rolls released on Monday has revealed.

As per the district wise data, constituencies with lower voter turnout in the 2025 Assembly elections had higher deletion percentages than those with higher voter turnouts.

The South East district recorded the highest deletion rate among all 13 administrative districts at 43.61%. In the Assembly elections last year, the district also recorded the lowest voter turnout at 56.4%. In a similar pattern, the New Delhi district, which reported a 57.23% voter turnout, and 39.02% deletions. The South Delhi district — with a 58.2% turnout — recorded 38.64% deletions in the draft rolls.

On the other hand, the Northeast district registered 66.25% voter turnout and one of the lowest deletions in the draft rolls at 29.03%. Similarly, Southwest district, which had a voter turnout of 61.09%, reported 26.81% deletions. The deletions rate was the lowest in the Outer North district at 24.32%.

A caveat to note here is that the Election Commission of India officially groups Delhi's 70 Assembly constituencies into 11 revenue districts. For the SIR 2026 exercise, Delhi has been grouped into 13 administrative electoral divisions with separate categories for Old Delhi, Central North, and Outer North.

Sources said that areas with a larger number of electors who have shifted, died or are otherwise ineligible may record lower turnout. This also implies that these areas see a larger proportion of names classified as "uncollectable" during the revision.

The enumeration phase

concluded earlier in August after an exercise that spanned nearly 1.5 months. Forms of over 97.5 lakh electors — approximately 67% of electors on the roll — were collected and uploaded on the EC portal. The remaining 47.58 lakh electors were "uncollectable".

During this phase, booth level officers (BLOs) went door-to-door to distribute enumeration forms, help electors fill them out, and collect the completed forms. After this, the BLOs upload the details to the EC's official portal.

The "uncollectable" electors include those who were absent, may have moved or died, duplicate entries among others. The names of these 47.58 lakh are set to be excluded from the draft roll but the revision process will provide them with an opportunity to seek inclusion.

The final scale of exclusions will be known when the final electoral roll is published on November 4. For now, voters whose names are missing can seek inclusion in the final rolls.

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H.E. Rasmus Albrigtsen
Denmark's Ambassador to the Republic of India

Dr. Vijay Kumar Saraswat
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Minor raped in bus that travelled 47 km through Delhi-NCR with ‘zero checks’

Sakshi Chand
New Delhi, August 31

A 17-YEAR-OLD girl was allegedly raped on a sleeper bus that travelled nearly 47 km from Greater Noida to Old Delhi’s Kashmere Gate without being checked at a single police picket, sources said.

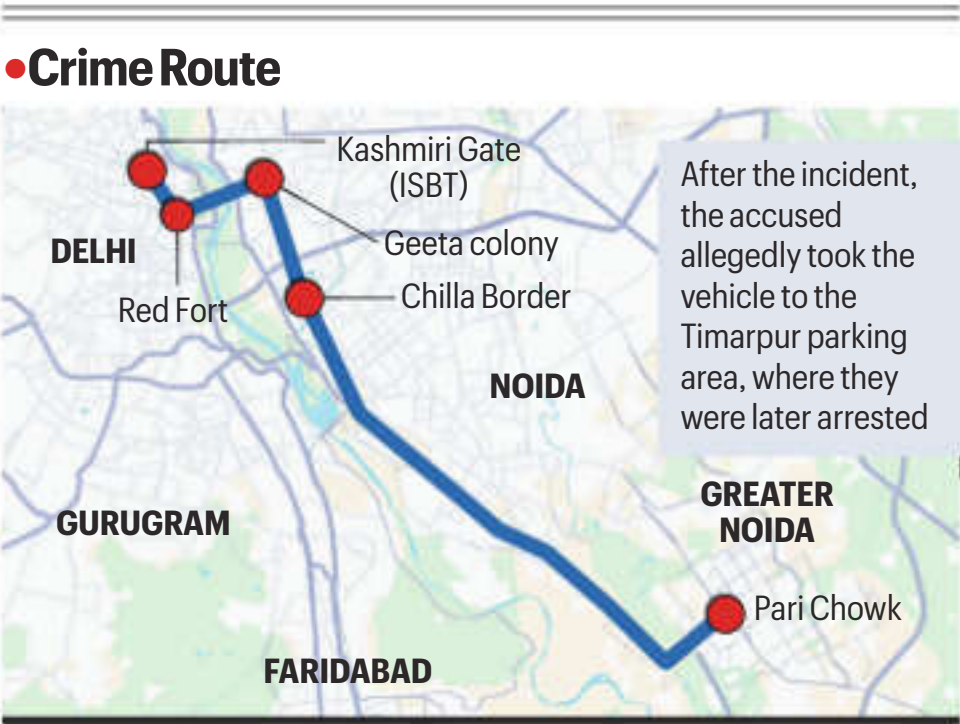
The incident, which took place on August 4, has raised fresh concerns over the implementation of safety measures mandated for public and private passenger buses after the December 16 gangrape case in 2012.

Niharika Bhatt, DCP, North Delhi, said, “On the night of August 4, a 17-year-old girl approached Kashmere Gate Police Station and reported that she had been raped inside a bus in Noida. During the inquiry, it was found that the girl was travelling from Mainpuri in Uttar Pradesh to the house of a relative in Noida. The alleged sexual assault took place while she was travelling from Pari Chowk, Greater Noida”.

The accused have been identified as bus driver Kuldeep, 39; and conductor, Sandeep, 26. The duo, hailing from Kanpur, was arrested within four hours of the incident, said officers.

After the incident, Bhatt added, the bus driver and conductor allegedly dropped the minor off at a location on Ring Road, within the jurisdiction of Kashmere Gate Police Station, far away from the scene of the crime.

“Considering the sensitive



nature of the case and in accordance with the new criminal laws, Kashmere Gate Police immediately arranged the victim’s medical examination and registered a case without getting into jurisdictional issues. With the help of CCTV cameras, the police traced the bus within four hours and arrested both accused. The victim was produced before the Child Welfare Committee and, as per its directions, was handed over to her father. The investigation into the case is still underway,” Bhatt said.

Police have collected forensic evidence from the bus, including hair strands and semen samples, officers said. The two accused have also undergone medical examinations.

According to sources, Kuldeep and Sandeep had taken the bus to a workshop in Surajpur, Greater Noida, for repairs after it developed a technical fault.

The duo worked with Vishwanath Travels for the last two years. After the vehicle was repaired, sources said, the two were driving back to a parking facility in North Delhi’s Timarpur when they noticed the girl.

Police sources claimed she was waiting alone at Pari Chowk. The two men allegedly persuaded her to board the vehicle. Officers said the girl was allegedly gangraped inside the bus. The accused then allegedly abandoned her at Kashmere Gate. The girl approached the police booth nearby and asked for directions for the police station. Officers present at the booth made her board an auto and directed it to take her to the Kashmere Gate police station, said sources.

After the incident, the accused allegedly took the vehicle to the Timarpur parking area, where they were later arrested by police, said officers.

11 pending challans against vehicle, defunct CCTV camera: Lapses flagged during probe

Sakshi Chand
New Delhi, August 31

ELEVEN PENDING traffic challans and a defunct CCTV camera inside the bus where a 17-year-old girl was allegedly gangraped earlier this month has raised questions over compliance with mandatory safety norms for commercial passenger vehicles.

The challans against the bus include violations related to retroreflective tape and speed-limit devices, driving without a permit or non-compliance to permit conditions, as well as violations of prescribed speed limits, *The Indian Express* has learnt. According to sources, seven of these challans were issued in July — on July 3, 4, 5, 6, 8, 11 and 23.

The passenger bus, run by a private operator, usually entered Delhi during the early hours, around 3.30 am to 4 am, according to investigators. Its last recorded entry into the Capital was on July 25, after which it was taken to Greater Noida for servicing, they added.

The investigation has also revealed that the bus allegedly had heavy curtains covering its windows, restricting visibility into the passenger compart-



The bus has been seized.

ment from outside, officers said. This goes against Supreme Court-mandated safety requirements for commercial passenger vehicles that prescribe measures intended to ensure visibility and passenger safety. Obstructions that substantially reduce visibility into the passenger compartment are not permitted under the applicable safety requirements after the 2012 gangrape case in the Capital.

The bus had also travelled through several stretches connecting Noida and Delhi, including the Noida-Greater Noida Expressway and the Ring Road corridor. During its movement, it passed through or near major entry and exit points, in-

cluding the Chilla border, Mayur Vihar and Geeta Colony. Despite travelling through these stretches, the vehicle was not stopped for a safety or compliance check, officers said. No alert was raised during the journey.

Such buses are also required to be equipped with systems including GPS or vehicle-tracking mechanisms and panic buttons, which are intended to be connected with monitoring or emergency-response mechanisms.

Investigators are now examining whether these systems were installed in the bus, whether they were functional at the time of the incident and whether any alerts or location data were generated during the journey. They are also looking into whether the bus had been subjected to the requisite checks and whether its previous traffic violations had prompted any enforcement action.

The 11 pending challans are likely to form part of the broader investigation into the vehicle’s regulatory compliance and movement. Officers are also examining the circumstances in which the bus continued to operate despite the recorded violations.

10-yr-old punished at school for not carrying book, falls ill and dies; govt orders action

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 31

A 10-YEAR-OLD girl died after she was allegedly harshly punished at her school in East Delhi for not carrying a book and she fell ill, police said.

Even as no case has been registered yet, police are investigating the claims made by the family.

The Chief Minister’s Office on Monday said the government has taken a strong stand on incidents involving the safety and alleged mistreatment of young children. Chief Minister Rekha Gupta directed officials to ensure immediate action in matters concerning child safety and said that any compromise would not be tolerated.

According to police sources, the child died on August 27 and last rites were held the same day.

Police said that the girl was suffering from epilepsy. Officers added that they received a call on Monday morning from a relative of the girl who said that the child had been allegedly “scolded” and “beaten” at school before she fell sick.

A preliminary investigation subsequently revealed that on July 22, the girl had gone to school despite being “sick”. She was, however, allegedly scolded by her teacher as she had forgotten to carry a book.

“She was allegedly punished and asked to stand ... After she fell sick, the school called her parents who took her home,” officers said.

On Monday, the child’s family told mediapersons that she was “distressed and under depression due to the behaviour of the teachers”.

Delhi Education Minister Ashish Sood, in a statement issued on Monday, said a teacher has been transferred, pending the inquiry.

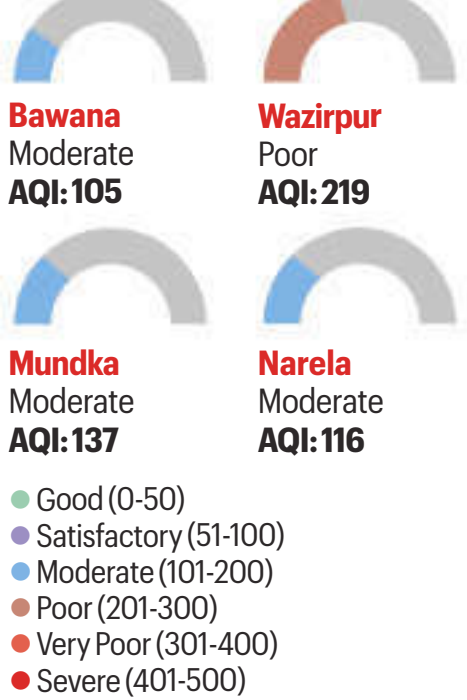
“An inquiry is currently underway into the tragic death of the student at the school... Pending the completion of the inquiry, the concerned teacher has been transferred with immediate effect to ensure that the investigation is conducted fairly and without any interference.”

“The government is treating this matter with the utmost seriousness and sensitivity. If the inquiry establishes any negligence, dereliction of duty, or irregularity at any level, strict and decisive action will be taken against those found responsible, in accordance with the law,” he also said in the statement. The Delhi Commission of Women (DCW) has taken note of this case as well as alleged sexual assault of a three-year-old nursery student, gang rape of a 16-year-old girl and written to Delhi Police Commissioner Anurag Kumar.

• Skywatch

Forecast: September 1, 2026
Partly cloudy sky; spell of very light to light rain
MAX: 34-36
1.5°C above normal
MIN: 25-27
0.5°C below normal

• AQI Tracker



Delhi to set up medical rooms in 100 schools

New Delhi: To strengthen the safety and overall health of students, Delhi government will set up medical rooms in 100 of its schools as a pilot project, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said on Monday. “Based on the outcome and evaluation of the pilot project, it will be expanded to other schools,” said CM. ENS

CM orders sealing of playschool after boy aged three is sexually assaulted, tied to chair

Pragynesh,
Sophiya Mathew
New Delhi, August 31

A DAY after the arrest of an attendant over the alleged sexual assault of a three-year-old boy, the playschool in Northeast Delhi was sealed on Monday following directions from Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, said officials.

Police on Sunday said that a case under relevant sections of the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act and the Juvenile Justice Act has been registered against the attendant and a teacher at the playschool was served a notice. The teacher has now been suspended. In an official statement, the Chief Minister’s office on Monday underlined, “On the directions of the CM, the District Magistrate has initiated proceedings to seal the premises of the school. Police investigation is underway. The Delhi government will ensure that responsibility is fixed and those found guilty face the strictest action under law.”

The CM has assured the family that legal support would be extended, if required.

The FIR in the case names four persons, including the owner of the school and the

principal, as the accused. As per police, the incident came to light on August 16 when the child’s parents noticed bruises on his arms and face. “On August 16, I saw bruises on his face and arms. Two days later, when he came home, he started vomiting. We took him to an ENT (Ear, Nose, and Throat) specialist. The doctor said his eyes were swollen. Some tests were run and it was found that his eardrums were damaged,” said the child’s father.

The father also claimed that once he and his wife approached the school authorities, they allegedly refuted their claims, but “reluctantly agreed to share the CCTV footage”.

“On August 26, we saw the footage. About 9.45 am on August 18, he was tied to a chair for three hours. He managed to open it... then was beaten up by the attendant. On August 17, he was slapped by the teacher,” the child’s father said.

Some of the clips, officers said, show the child being tied to a chair in a classroom full of children, and being stacked against the wall.

On August 27, the family got a medico-legal certificate for the child and then got an FIR registered.

Anti-encroachment drive near Jama Masjid after HC order



An anti-encroachment drive underway in the Jama Masjid area in New Delhi on Monday. PRAVEEN KHANNA

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 31

THE MUNICIPAL Corporation of Delhi (MCD) Monday launched an anti-encroachment drive in the Jama Masjid area following a two-month-long survey, carried out under the directions of the Delhi High Court, officials said.

“As part of ongoing efforts to ensure compliance with the directions of the Hon’ble High Court and to safeguard public spaces, an enforcement action was undertaken in the park areas around Jama Masjid under Old Delhi Zone, MCD,” read a statement by the civic body. According to sources, the drive covered the North and South Park adjacent to the historic monument.

Officials said that “unauthorised and temporary struc-

tures” were removed by the MCD, adding that the drive also saw cooperation from all stakeholders and authorities concerned. The drive was carried out peacefully and clearance of debris was underway, they said.

In January this year, acting on a PIL by local residents, the Delhi High Court had directed the MCD to conduct a survey within a period of two months, and verify allegations of unauthorised construction and encroachment in and around Jama Masjid. The court had also said that if any illegal construction, encroachment or illegal use is detected during the survey, then “appropriate action which may be warranted under law shall also be taken with expedition”.

The direction came even as the civic body had informed the court that it was undertaking

regular anti-encroachment drives in the area.

Since Jama Masjid has been notified as a protected monument of national importance under the Ancient Monuments and Archaeological Sites and Remains Act, 1958, the plea argued that the mosque and its regulated and prohibited areas were entitled to protection against unauthorised construction, damage, disfigurement, or commercial exploitation, in accordance with the statutory framework and guidelines issued by the Archaeological Survey of India.

Among the alleged illegal structures and encroachment flagged by the petitioners were an illegal parking, an e-rickshaw charging station, “unlicensed” Medicare Hospital and illegal commercial activities ongoing in and around the area.

School cab driver arrested for sexually assaulting minor

Pragynesh
New Delhi, August 31

A MINOR girl was allegedly sexually assaulted by her school’s cab driver in Outer Delhi, police said Monday, adding that the accused has been arrested.

Police said the incident came to light when the child’s parents noticed her changed behaviour when she came home on August 23.

“Her mother noticed that and asked what happened. The child told her about a ‘bad uncle’ who gives her chocolates but also touches her and makes her uncomfortable. Since the child didn’t know the name of the accused, the parents took up the matter with the school the very next day,” said a police source.

On August 24, police said, school authorities showed the child CCTV footage from several cameras, and she recognised the accused driver from one of them.

Police said the footage showed the accused following the girl till the washroom and offering her chocolates before allegedly assaulting her.

“The accused was arrested from the school premises. A case under the Protection of

The child was shown a CCTV footage from the school where she identified the accused, according to the police

Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act was lodged. His phone was seized, which had multiple videos of him offering chocolates to children. Investigation is underway,” said a police officer. Police claim that their investigation found that the accused has six previous cases lodged against him, including theft cases.

“He used to drive for cab operators in 2025 before he joined the school over eight months ago. We are verifying whether the school did a proper background check on him. We are also trying to find and talk to other students who he gave chocolates to,” said an officer.

Police also formed a Special Investigation Team to look into the issue.

Officers have also advised the school to verify vehicles that they hire for service, and give preference to registered commercial vehicles.

• SHARP-TAILED SANDPIPER BREEDS IN NORTHERN SIBERIA, MIGRATES SOUTH OVER EAST ASIA TO NON-BREEDING GROUNDS IN AUSTRALIA, NEW ZEALAND

Only fifth recorded sighting in 150 yrs: Rare Siberian visitor spotted at Delhi lake

Sophiya Mathew
New Delhi, August 31

IT WAS the bold white supercilium — the stripe above the eye — and rusty-brown scalloped feathers fading into the underbelly that helped identify the puffy-bodied wader at Najafgarh Jheel as a sharp-tailed sandpiper, rather than the similar-looking pectoral sandpiper. The bird was spotted near Mankrola village on the Gurgaon side of the marshy lake on Sunday – a rare sighting that added to the very limited records of the species in Delhi-NCR and the country as a whole.

Akshit Dua, an NCR-based conservationist and birder, documented the sharp-tailed sandpiper (*Calidris acuminata*) as it moved in the fields, ac-

tively foraging amid a flock of common sandpipers and wood sandpipers.

Crown features including the rufous-streaked cap, along with the distinctive eye-ring and rusty-brown scalloped feathers with diffused breast markings helped identify and distinguish the bird, Dua said.

“It is hard to identify waders easily in the field, especially with the naked eye. Many species have similar bills and calls, making short viewings difficult,” he said. Dua’s sighting of *Calidris acuminata* is significant because it was only the fifth recorded sighting of the species in India over a period of almost a century and a half.

A study published in Indian Birds, widely regarded as the bird journal of record in India,

documents the sighting of a male in Gilgit in 1880, a female in Vandalur in Tamil Nadu in 1915, an unconfirmed record from Kurud Tank in Chhattisgarh in 2004, and a photographed individual at the Najafgarh marshland on September 24, 2019.

The sharp-tailed sandpiper breeds in northern Siberia, in an area that extends from the Lena river delta on the eastern Arctic Ocean southeastward to the Kolyma region, and migrates south over East Asia to its main non-breeding grounds in Australia and New Zealand.

Smaller numbers fly to Melanania, a cluster of islands in the southwestern Pacific Ocean between New Guinea in the west to Fiji in the east.

The species is, therefore, an



A sharp-tailed sandpiper at Najafgarh Lake, Sunday. AKSHIT DUA
Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mIjMzg1
Ecologist Sohail Madan said, “The sighting of the sharp-tailed sandpiper at Najafgarh Lake is remarkable not just because it is an uncommon visitor to the Delhi-NCR region, but because

Real Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Vn2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F>
land wetlands, in freshwater and hypersaline habitats. It feeds on seeds, worms, molluscs, crustaceans, and insects after rainfall, and often forages in agricultural pastures and in the shallow-water edges of wetlands.

Around the Yellow Sea between China and the Korean peninsula, an important stop-over region on the annual migration route of the bird, coastal habitats have been lost to residential, industrial and aquaculture development. Pollution, altered sediment flows, and rise in sea levels have added to the pressure. In Australia, drought and reduced areas of inland wetlands are major concerns.

The sharp-tailed sandpiper reported by Dua is not the only unusual migrant recorded at Najafgarh. A rustic bunting was

spotted at the wetland a few days earlier, another rare sighting in the region, NCR birder Yatin Verma said.

Dr Anil Kumar, a veterinarian with the Haryana government and a birder who has been visiting the Najafgarh lake for around 15 years, said the region sees active migration in August-September, and again in March. Birds also take time to shed their breeding plumage as they move between their breeding and non-breeding grounds, he said.

While temporarily flooded areas in the NCR provide feeding grounds for waders and other passage migrants in the monsoon, Kumar said Najafgarh lies on the broader Central Asian flyway, and offers a diversity of habitats around the wetland.



Amid 'NRC first' demand, Centre defers Census exercise in Manipur

Deepthiman Tiwary
New Delhi, August 31

THE CENTRE on Monday decided to defer the house-listing phase of the Census 2027 in Manipur amid strong opposition from civil society groups in the Meitei-dominated Imphal Valley. The groups have been demanding that the government undertake a National Register of Citizens (NRC) exercise in the state before the Census.

The decision came hours after the Manipur High Court recorded an undertaking from the Centre that the house-listing operations scheduled to begin September 1 would be postponed. The state government also told the court that it would keep its notification on the Census in abeyance. "The decision has been taken in view of demands from Meitei and Naga groups in the state and also the tenuous security situation in Manipur," a senior government official said.

The High Court, which was hearing a PIL filed by the Kangleipak Students' Association and the International Peace and Social Advancement, along with a connected writ petition, ordered that the house-listing operation remain in abeyance until the next hearing on October 12.

Real Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F>



Protesters conduct a torch rally demanding NRC updation ahead of the Census, in Imphal East. ANI FILE
Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RG9mljMzg1

The Centre's decision followed a high-level meeting chaired by Union Home Minister Amit Shah in New Delhi on Monday to review the situation in Manipur. According to a statement issued by Chief Minister Yumnam Khemchand Singh's office, the meeting was attended by state Governor Ajay Kumar Bhalla, the Chief Minister, Union Home Secretary Govind Mohan and other senior officials.

The meeting discussed the demand from sections of people from Manipur that the Census exercise be deferred until the implementation of the NRC, the CMO said. It said the Centre agreed to defer the exercise "con-

sidering the feelings and aspirations of the people of Manipur". The Chief Minister thanked Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Shah for accepting the demand. He also thanked BJP president Nitin Nabin, leaders of 14 civil society organisations and a delegation of BJP MLAs who recently travelled to New Delhi to press for an NRC in Manipur.

The High Court order shows that the Centre's decision was communicated through Deputy Solicitor General Kh Samrajit, who said, on instructions of the Registrar General and Census Commissioner, a decision had been taken to postpone the house-listing operations in Ma-

nipur. The Centre was to issue a notification formally modifying the January 7, 2026 notification that had provided for the Census exercise. The court recorded this submission as an undertaking by the Registrar General and the Census Commissioner.

The state government subsequently told the court that in view of the Centre's decision, it would not commence the house-listing operation from September 1 and would keep it March 22, 2026 notification in abeyance, pending the Centre's formal notification. The court ordered that the exercise remain in abeyance until the next listing of cases on October 12. It also directed the parties to complete their pleadings in the intervening period.

The petitions before the court focus on demands for postponement of the Census and the implementation of NRC in Manipur. During the proceedings, the petitioners' counsel pointed to two resolutions of the Manipur Assembly — one dated August 5, 2022 and another reiterating it on March 1, 2024 — seeking the introduction and enforcement of the NRC in the state.

In January 2023, the Manipur government had also

written to the Union Home Ministry seeking the introduction and enforcement of the NRC in the state. The communication, reproduced in the High Court order, referred to concerns over illegal immigration and demographic changes and requested that the Centre consider introducing and enforcing the NRC in Manipur. A similar communication was sent in June 2024.

The opposition to the Census has been particularly strong in the Valley, with civil society groups arguing that carrying out the exercise before an NRC would result in undocumented or allegedly illegal immigrants being included in the population count and could have implications for future delimitation and allocation of resources.

The state government had previously frozen all administrative boundaries from January 1, 2026 through March 31, 2027, to prepare for census operations. This triggered massive strikes, torch rallies and closure of educational institutions across the valley districts.

Delegations of local civil society leaders and state legislators had recently traveled to New Delhi to press central authorities to defer the Census until an NRC exercise was initiated.

Modi calls 7.8% GDP growth 'Herculean feat'; Cong calls it 'Greatly Distorted Picture'

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 31

AS THE Indian economy posted a real GDP growth rate of 7.8% in the April-June quarter, the government and the Opposition were caught in a war of words, with Prime Minister Narendra Modi calling it a "herculean feat", while the Congress described it as "Greatly Distorted Picture" of the economy. India's GDP grew 7.8% in the April-June quarter, surpassing the RBI's 7% estimate. However, elevated crude oil prices, food inflation and a strengthening El Niño pose risks to the growth outlook.

In a post on X, PM Modi said that India's "exemplary GDP growth of 7.8% during Q1 of FY 2026-27 is a herculean feat". "The collective strength of four people ensured India delivered such growth despite oil price shocks and supply chain issues in the midst of global uncertainties. Doomsayers were doomed and India bloomed... yet again."

Union Home Minister Amit Shah said the Indian economy has once again trumped global uncertainties, and that this stands as a testament to the "visionary" leadership of PM Modi. "Indian economy growing from strength to strength against global odds under Modi govt. Once again, the Indian economy has trumped global uncertainties and secured a GDP growth of 7.8% in Q1 of FY 2026-27."

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman said the reforms undertaken by the NDA government, together with an agile management of the economy, are bearing results.

Meanwhile, the Congress called the numbers a "greatly distorted picture" of the economy and said that it was a case of "premature celebration" by PM Modi.

Congress MP and communications in-charge Jairam Ramesh said, "The quarterly GDP numbers, such as they are reported, present a GDP — Greatly Distorted Picture — of the economy." He said that the numbers "do not convey the decidedly depressed private investment sentiment in the economy — both domestic and foreign".

"Consumer confidence is very sluggish, hitting its lowest point since COVID and on a relentless downward trajectory since November 2025. Prices of household essentials are galloping. Educated unemployment is at alarming levels. The unabated trade deficit with China is wreaking havoc." Ramesh also said that the "capture of key sectors by a couple of big conglomerates deliberately encouraged by the PM is having deleterious effects". "The wealth of India's five richest families has grown by 400% while the real wages of salaried workers have fallen. Household savings rates have fallen and debt has reached record highs... This is a case of premature celebration by the PM."

Congress MP and senior leader Pawan Khara said that one quarter of 7.8% growth is not an economic spring. "If India has truly 'bloomed', why do rampant unemployment, leaked exam papers, and a crumbling education system define the ground reality?... Why the republic's prosperity is not translating into the prosperity of its public?"

New generation, old contest: After 9 years, campus politics returns to Madhya Pradesh

Anand Mohan J
Bhopal, August 31

IN INDORE, ABVP protesters broke through police barricades outside the District Collector's office while demonstrating over basic facilities in government colleges. In Katni, water cannons were used against an NSUI march demanding a government medical college.

Across Madhya Pradesh, motorbike rallies, student meetings and membership drives are gathering pace as political organisations prepare for student union elections — the first in the state since 2017. After an eight-year gap, the ABVP, the RSS-affiliated students' wing, the NSUI, the Congress-affiliated body, and smaller outfits are mobilising a generation of students with little or no experience of campus politics.

The polls are returning at a time when student politics has acquired fresh visibility nationally. The BJP-led agitation over irregularities in exams and the NEET paper leak grew from an online campaign into weeks of street protests in Delhi, culminating in Dharmendra Pradhan's resignation as Union Education Minister on July 25.

Madhya Pradesh will now test whether that wider ferment translates into campus politics. A troubled history

Student elections in the state have long been marked by concerns over campus violence and political interference. Direct polls were discontinued in 2003 after repeated clashes between student groups. An indirect system



(Top) ABVP activists participate in 'Vidyarthi Hunkar Abhiyan'; NSUI members stage a protest on students' issues

continued, with students electing class representatives who then chose union office-bearers. The debate over violence and political influence intensified after the August 2006 killing of H S Sabharwal, head of the political science department at Madhav College in Ujjain. Sabharwal was attacked during a dispute over the postponement of student union polls.

The incident became a turning point in discussions around campus violence and political interference. The Supreme Court's subsequent adoption of the Lyngdoh Committee recommendations brought further restrictions on student polls. Elections resumed intermittently, first in 2010 and again in 2011-12, before another prolonged gap.

The process was revived in 2017 under a largely indirect system. The ABVP emerged as the dominant force, winning the principal posts at five of the state's six universities, while the NSUI won at Rani Durgavati University in Jabalpur. But the 2017 exercise did not restore a regular electoral cycle.

No student union polls were held again after that year. The latest revival followed a PIL filed by student leader Adnan Ansari, who challenged the prolonged absence of polls and said that students continued to be charged a student union fee despite there being no elected body. On August 3, a division Bench of Madhya Pradesh HC took note of the state's 2026-27 academic calendar, which provides for student union elections in September, and directed colleges and universities across the state to conduct them, with police assistance where required by college authorities.

ABVP's advantage

The ABVP is seeking to turn its longstanding campus pres-

ence into an electoral advantage. Its leaders are also keen to distinguish their politics in MP from the recent student agitation in Delhi. The organisation says it has been raising exam irregularities independently through protests and demands for stronger action even before the latest wave of demonstrations.

"We work round-the-clock in campuses," state secretary Ketan Chaturvedi said, describing the organisation's approach as a combination of agitation around student grievances and year-round programmes.

ABVP workers have continued raising local grievances and conducting activities through the years without elected student bodies. Chaturvedi said the organisation can now draw on those relationships rather than having to build campus networks from scratch. The organisation has identified a range of deficiencies in government colleges likely to form a central part of its campaign.

Its 'Vidyarthi Hunkar Abhiyan' has taken these complaints to district headquarters, and submitted memorandums to collectors addressed to the state Higher Education Minister.

NSUI tries to rebuild

For the NSUI, the return of polls is first an organisational challenge. State NSUI chief Ashutosh Chouksey has travelled across Gwalior, Bhind, Morena, Ujjain, Indore, Dewas, Rewa, Satna and Maihar districts for meetings with students and office-bearers, along with marches and bike rallies. The NSUI is also identifying potential campus

leaders and assessing them against the two possible electoral structures — whether candidates would need to appeal to individual classes or a college.

Chouksey said the organisation had identified around 10-12 potential candidates in each college. NSUI state vice-president Ravi Parmar said the outreach was aimed at students who may be willing to vote but have little interest in politics. He said 30-40% of students on some campuses could fall into that category. Recent NSUI campaigns have included protests over bus fares in Bhairunda and Sironji, a fee increase at a law college in Mandsaur and exam results and teacher shortages at GDC College in Dewas. In Gwalior, the organisation said a phased protest at Birla Nursing College was followed by the administration accepting students' demands.

The NSUI is pushing for direct elections and has also demanded a 33% quota for women in student union positions.

Smaller outfits seek space

Smaller organisations are entering the contest as well. The Karni Sena Parivar plans to contest in five to six government colleges in Bhopal, although it has not finalised the campuses.

State vice-president Chetan Singh Chandel said its campaign would focus on drinking water, fees, alleged discrepancies in fees charged to scholarship students, etc. The organisation had taken up student grievances in 70 colleges over the past year and helped resolve about 95% of the issues it pursued.

'Attack on values of social justice': Congress leaders protest FIR against Rahul

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 31

CONGRESS WORKERS on Monday held protests over the FIR lodged against Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi in Uttarakhand's Haldwani under sections of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita and the SC/ST Act.

Congress general secretary (organisation) K C Venugopal said Gandhi had demanded an FIR against BJP workers for the "purification" ceremony after Congress president and Dalit leader Mallikarjun Kharge's rally in Haldwani earlier this month, but the Uttarakhand Police filed an FIR against Gandhi instead.

"This is nothing but the pot calling the kettle black! What is worse, BJP has jumped in to defend this abhorrently casteist behaviour, showing to the world that they are the biggest perpetrators of social injustice today," said Venugopal. He alleged that the BJP is willing to put the entire might of the State to attack those who speak against Dalit atrocities. "What BJP has done is to attack the values of social justice enshrined in the Constitution, and Congress will fight against this attack tooth and nail..."



Assam Pradesh Congress Committee members protest the FIR against LoP Rahul Gandhi in Guwahati on Monday. ANI

"This evening, Congress workers across the country will be on the streets demanding prosecution of the BJP leaders who insulted Kharge ji and to defend our Constitution against the BJP's assault on its values of social justice," Venugopal said.

On Monday, Congress MP and in-charge for Uttarakhand Selja Kumari met Kharge and said Congress is planning a protest on September 7. The FIR was lodged a day after Gandhi, at a press conference in Delhi, urged PM Narendra Modi to order an FIR over "shuddhikaran havan" (purification ritual) held at Ram-lila Maidan in Haldwani, days after a rally there by Kharge.

Panjab University polls: ABVP wins president's post for second time

Asmita Maini
Chandigarh, August 31

THE PANJAB University Campus Students' Council (PUCSC) elections ended with a dramatic political payoff on Monday as the Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad (ABVP) retained the council's presidency for a second consecutive term, with candidate Ankit Bidhan defeating his closest rival Aadil Brar of ASAP by 512 votes.

Bidhan secured 3,149 votes, while Brar polled 2,637, handing ABVP a significant victory in one of the university's most closely watched student polls. The result also marked the first time ABVP has retained the PUCSC president's post for two consecutive terms. Both the other key parties — Association of Students for Alternative Politics (ASAP) and National Students' Union of India (NSUI) — fail to win any students' council post.

ABVP received last-minute support from the Students' Organisation of India (SOI), which emerged as a crucial factor in the win. The late realignment helped consolidate support behind Bidhan and gave ABVP the edge in the contest. The result reinforces ABVP's growing influence on the PU campus. The organisation ended its long wait for the presidency last year when research scholar Gauravveer Singh Sohail won the top post. Bidhan's victory now establishes that last year's breakthrough was not an isolated success and gives ABVP back-to-back presidential wins.

"It is not my sole victory. It is the victory of the entire Gen Z," Bidhan told the media.

The author is an intern at The Indian Express

Left vs Left in Kerala: Why CPI is pushing back against CPI(M) over Dy LoP

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, August 31

AFTER PLAYING second fiddle to the CPI(M) during the Left Democratic Front's (LDF) decade-long rule in Kerala, the CPI has now demanded a larger role in the Opposition — the post of Deputy Leader of the Opposition (LoP) in the Assembly, triggering a churn in the Opposition alliance.

While the CPI(M) has refused to give up its claim, the CPI has found support from an unexpected quarter — the Indian Union Muslim League (IUML), a key constituent of the ruling United Democratic Front (UDF). The CPI's demand came against the backdrop of the LDF's poor showing in the May 2026 Assembly polls, in which it was reduced to just 35 seats in

the 140-member House.

The CPI argues that the Left needs collective leadership to stage a political comeback, and has sought the Deputy LoP's post. The CPI has been pressing for the post since May, after the CPI(M) chose former Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan as the LoP. Vijayan, who headed the LDF government for a decade from 2016, has already taken the fight to the Sathesnan-led UDF government, which recently completed 100 days in office.

However, the failure of the CPI(M) and the CPI to reach an agreement on the Deputy LoP has meant that the Opposition has struggled to project a united front against the UDF on several issues. The differences came to a head last week when Vijayan said he would write to the Speaker recommending a CPI(M) leader for

the post. "Once the letter is given as directed by the Speaker, the Deputy LoP will be appointed. There is no doubt the name written in that letter will be that of a CPI(M) leader," Vijayan had told the media. Since the formation of the LDF in 1980, the CPI(M) and the CPI have been its principal constituents. Whenever the alliance has been in Opposition, both the LoP and Deputy LoP posts have gone to the CPI(M). The CPI(M) has 26 MLAs in the 35-member LDF, while the CPI has eight.

"The CPI has to make clear on what basis it has been demanding the post of the Deputy LoP, which has been held by the CPI(M) since 1980. Contrary to tradition, the CPI is demanding the post. Does the CPI think that they have grown after the LDF lost the (2026) Assembly polls? The CPI should not hurt Left unity in Kerala by raising new



CPI has been pressing for the post of Deputy LoP since May, after CPI(M) chose former CM Pinarayi Vijayan as the LoP. FILE

demands," said CPI(M) state secretary member C N Mohanan in the party mouthpiece Deshabhimani. The CPI(M)'s recent poll review has concluded that weaving the campaign largely around Vijayan contributed to the party's debacle.

For the CPI, the demand is also an opportunity to chal-

lenge Vijayan's dominance within the LDF. During his decade at the helm, the CPI(M), and at times Vijayan personally, has exercised considerable influence over the functioning of the LDF, with the CPI often reduced to a secondary role. The CPI has been critical of Vijayan's handling of several issues.

On policy matters, the CPI had complained that it was not adequately consulted before Kerala joined the PM SHRI scheme. The party had also demanded the suspension of then ADGP M R Ajith Kumar over allegations relating to the disruption of the Thrissur Pooram in 2024 and his meeting with senior RSS leaders. Vijayan had not accepted the demand.

The CPI, set to hold its state conference in September, is also banking on grassroots-level resentment over Vijayan's dominance within the party. Reacting

to the former CM's assertion that the Deputy LoP would be from the CPI(M), senior CPI leader and former minister C Divakaran said that the CPI(M) couldn't unilaterally decide the matter. "Who is he (Vijayan) to give the final verdict? Often he adopts a stand which is difficult in Kerala politics. It is the CPI(M) which has to drive the LDF ahead. The post of the Deputy LoP is not the CPI(M)'s right. When talks are on to find a solution, no one can make a comment like that," Divakaran said.

IUML national vice-president KPA Majeed, in an article in the party mouthpiece, *Chandrika*, criticised the CPI(M)'s treatment of its junior ally and described ties within the LDF as resembling a "master-slaves system". Majeed said that the CPI had its political identity and history, and could not be reduced to a subordinate partner

merely because it was electorally weaker than the CPI(M). He also pointed to the CPI's role in Kerala's political history.

Despite many CPI(M) leaders extending an olive branch to its "disgruntled" ally, the CPI's bargaining power in Kerala politics remains limited. The Congress-led UDF has 102 members in the 140-member House, leaving little room for the CPI to seek an independent political space in the Opposition.

The CPI(M)'s resistance to the CPI's demand has allowed Vijayan to rally party leaders around him as the state unit prepares for a broader state panel meeting next month to discuss the party's strategy for rebuilding its organisation and electoral base. For now, both sides have time to resolve the dispute. The next major electoral battle — the 2029 Lok Sabha polls — is still more than two years away.

‘Wait 3-4 decades for delimitation, till population of states stabilises’

FORMER CHAIRMAN of the Indian Council of Social Science Research (ICSSR) **J K BAJAJ**, who was also a member of the Justice G Rohini Commission for the sub-categorisation of OBCs, says delimitation should be frozen for another 25 years and that the federal principle be considered more important than one-person, one-vote, one-value till the population stabilises across all states. Excerpts of his interview with **VIKAS PATHAK**:



Your latest research shows that the population of Uttar Pradesh declined sharply relative to the country's population up to 1971, and that of Bihar somewhat less sharply up to 1991, while that of Kerala grew relative to India's population up to 1971. You say the population of all states will stabilise in the next three or four decades. Are you proposing extending the delimitation freeze till then?

Yes, we should extend the freeze that Parliament enacted first in 1976 and again in 2001 for at least another 25 years.

Since the delimitation of seats was frozen in 1976, the difference in population has become large over five decades. Will it not become larger in another three to four decades?

After three or four decades, the population of all states is expected to stabilise. That would be an appropriate time to rework the relative shares of different states in Parliament. Those shares will be different from what we have today, but the logic of delimitation on a stable population is much more persuasive than doing it when various states are at different stages of demographic transition.

‘One person, one vote, one value’ principle is enshrined in Constitution. There have been demands to factor in the economic and social performance of states. Do you agree that the government can diversify criteria and not run the risk of violating this principle?

The differing patterns of demographic transition in different states are directly related to their economic and social performance. Keeping the share of states unchanged is an obvious and simple way of recognising the varying socio-economic performance, which leads to varying growth of population.

How will the government reconcile the principle that substantive equality permits positive discrimination only for those who are disadvantaged with the demand that more prosperous states be given

a share larger than their current populations?

Keeping the share stable does not necessarily reward more prosperous states. Punjab is far less prosperous today as compared to Haryana, but delimitation based on the 2011 Census data shall raise the seats for Haryana and lower those for Punjab. The decision to freeze the share of different states is not a matter of rewarding or punishing. It is a matter of keeping the federal compact unchanged until all states have completed their demographic transition.

If demographic transition happens in different states at different times, has family planning had any real impact?

Many parameters have an impact on the rate of demographic change. The most significant are the state of nutrition, hygiene and health. Education and social, economic and political stability also matter. The population in southern states began rising from 1921 onwards for these reasons. In a state such as UP, where these parameters remained backward, significant growth began after 1971.

Easy availability of family planning resources is important, but their adoption depends on the factors we discussed earlier.

How can the concerns of southern states be allayed?

The likely loss that the southern states, and many others, will suffer in case of fresh delimitation is so large that nothing can allay their fear of losing their voice in national affairs. The assurance of the Home Minister that no state shall have fewer than its current seats in a larger Lok Sabha does not mean much, for it is the relative share of different states that matters, not the absolute number of seats.

Given ‘one person, one vote, one value’, is it possible for the government to take the 2011 Census as the reference point and yet keep the seat allocation consistent?

The currently allocated seats within a state can be delimited according to their current population rather than the historical population. This preserves both the federal principle and the principle of ‘one person, one vote’.

Navy Chief: *INS Nipun* will enhance our critical underwater capabilities

Amrita Nayak Dutta
New Delhi, August 31

INS NIPUN will significantly enhance the Navy's niche underwater capabilities required for multi-domain operations, Chief of Naval Staff Admiral Krishna Swaminathan said on Monday. He emphasised that this dedicated Diving Support and Submarine Rescue Vessel adds specialised capability for complex underwater operations and to respond to emergencies in one of the world's most “challenging and mysterious environments”.

The Navy Chief was speaking at the commissioning ceremony of *INS Nipun* in Mumbai on Monday. Vice Admiral Sanjay Vatsayan, Flag Officer Commanding-in-Chief, Western Naval Command, other senior naval officers, representatives from Hindustan Shipyard Ltd., Visakhapatnam, among others, were present.

INS Nipun is the second Diving Support Vessel (DSV) of the Nistar Class and is a strong addition to the Navy's deep-sea diving and underwater support capabilities.

“We are living through a period of significant strategic



Navy Chief Admiral Krishna Swaminathan, Vice Admiral Sanjay Vatsayan along with other officers during the commissioning ceremony of *INS Nipun* in Mumbai on Monday. ANI

Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1 capability will enable the Western Naval Command to strengthen its capabilities to operate above, on, and beneath the waves.

Stating that the vessel brings together a range of capabilities possessed by only a handful of navies, which includes the ability to embark the Indian Navy's deep submergence rescue vessel, he said submarine rescue is a discipline where preparedness admits little margin for delay.

“*Nipun*'s ability to embark and operate the Indian Navy's Deep Submergence Rescue

He said the addition of this

Vessel significantly enhances our capacity to respond to a distressed submarine quite significantly — whether our own, or that of a partner Navy. This capability would also enable India to support submarine rescue and emerge as the ‘preferred submarine rescue partner’ in the region,” he said.

He added that the vessel's specialised diving capabilities can support partner nations in underwater salvage and HADR missions, adding another dimension to the Navy's maritime cooperation efforts.

He said the Western Naval Command will now have to integrate *INS Nipun* fully into operational plans, exercise her capabilities rigorously, develop proficiency around her systems, and ensure that the ship is ready at the earliest for every task at sea.

INS Nipun is capable of supporting saturation, air and heliox diving and is equipped with remotely operated underwater systems for inspection and intervention. Its specialised diving complex, dynamic positioning capability and associated life-support and medical facilities enable the conduct of sustained and complex operations at sea.

After seven-month hiatus, ISRO to launch key satellite on Sept 4

Anonna Dutt
New Delhi, August 31

THE INDIAN Space Research Organisation (ISRO) on Monday announced that the earth observation satellite EOS-05 will be launched via GSLV F17 on September 4 at 02:55 am from Sriharikota.

The Indian Express had earlier reported that the satellite will be launched in the first week of September; the other satellite parked at the spaceport NVS-03 is likely to be launched in November. This will end the space agency's seven-month-long hiatus since the last failed launch — PSLV-C62 Mission — in January this year.

GISAT-1A or Geo Imaging Satellite — also referred to as EOS-05 under the new nomenclature system — is a replacement satellite for GISAT-1 (or EOS-03). The previous satellite, which was launched in 2021, failed to reach orbit after the cryogenic upper stage of the rocket failed to ignite. A failure analysis committee found that a malfunctioning valve led to insufficient pressure in the liquid hydrogen tank, causing

the failure. The satellite, with a 10-year mission life, is designed to image large areas of interest at frequent intervals for purposes such as monitoring natural disasters or keeping track of agriculture or forestry.

This is India's first earth observation satellite in a higher geosynchronous orbit. Most earth observation satellites are placed in low earth orbit.

Launches were put on hold after the space agency suffered several setbacks, according to officials. Three of the six missions undertaken by the space agency in 2025 and 2026 ended with the satellites not reaching the intended orbits due to anomalies in the launch vehicle or spacecraft engine.

ISRO has undertaken only one launch this year — its workhorse launch vehicle was to place an earth observation satellite in orbit on January 12 in the PSLV-C62/EOS-N1 mission. The satellite could not be injected into the intended orbit due to an “anomaly” in the third stage of the rocket. The report of the failure analysis committee — or even a summary of it — has not been made public yet.

कौशल से आत्मनिर्भरता प्रशिक्षण से सफलता

महत्वपूर्ण सूचना

केवल SCVT ट्रेड्स

(STATE COUNCIL FOR VOCATIONAL TRAINING)

में प्रवेश प्रारम्भ

★ ★ सत्र 2026-27 ★ ★

आई.टी.आई. स्तर पर प्रवेश

31.08.2026 से 09.09.2026 तक

SCVT ट्रेड्स के प्रमुख कोर्स

इलेक्ट्रीशियन

फिटर

वेल्डर

प्लम्बर

वायरमैन

मशीनिस्ट

COPA

Draughtsman (Civil)

आवश्यक योग्यता

- ✓ 10वीं पास (न्यूनतम)
- ✓ आयु: न्यूनतम 14 वर्ष-
- ✓ किसी मान्यता प्राप्त विद्यालय से उत्तीर्ण

सीमित सीटें

पहले आओ,
पहले पाओ!

दस्तावेज साथ लाएं

- ✓ 10वीं की अंक तालिका
- ✓ आधार कार्ड
- ✓ पासपोर्ट साइज फोटो
- ✓ जाति प्रमाण-पत्र (यदि लागू हो)
- ✓ अन्य आवश्यक दस्तावेज संस्थान के अनुसार

★ अधिक जानकारी के लिए अपने नजदीकी ITI संस्थान से संपर्क करें।

वेबसाइट: www.admissions.itiharyana.gov.in

हेल्पलाइन: 0172-2996321, 2997265

QR Code स्कैन करें

निदेशालय, कौशल विकास एवं औद्योगिक प्रशिक्षण, हरियाणा

सूचना, लोक संपर्क तथा भाषा विभाग, हरियाणा

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New Delhi

कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग, वृत्त श्रीगंगानगर

क्रमांक:- निविदा संशोधन आदेश (NIB No. PWD2627A2018) दिनांक:-

इस कार्यालय की निविदा सूचना संख्या 04/2026-27 में निम्नानुसार संशोधन किया जाता है :-

क्र.स.	विवरण	मूल निविदा में अंकित दिनांक	संशोधित दिनांक
1.	निविदा प्रपत्र डाउनलोड/अपलोड करने की दिनांक	दिनांक 10.08.2026 प्रातः 9.30 बजे से 27.08.2026 सायं 6.00 बजे तक	दिनांक 10.08.2026 प्रातः 9.30 बजे से 31.08.2026 सायं 06.00 बजे तक
2.	निविदा खोलने की दिनांक	दिनांक 31.08.2026 सुबह 11.00 बजे	दिनांक 01.09.2026 सायं 03.00 बजे से

UBN No. - PWD2627WSOB08774, PWD2627WSOB08808, PWD2627WSOB09004, PWD2627WSOB09008, PWD2627WSOB09012, PWD2627WSOB09015, PWD2627WSOB09018, PWD2627WSOB09023, PWD2627WSOB08802, PWD2627WSOB08815, PWD2627WSOB09005, PWD2627WSOB09009, PWD2627WSOB09013, PWD2627WSOB09016, PWD2627WSOB09020, PWD2627WSOB09025, PWD2627WSOB08804, PWD2627WSOB09002, PWD2627WSOB09007, PWD2627WSOB09011, PWD2627WSOB09014, PWD2627WSOB09017, PWD2627WSOB09021, PWD2627WSOB09026

निविदा की अन्य शर्तें चयावत रहेगी।

अधीक्षण अभियन्ता सांनिधि वृत्त श्रीगंगानगर

DIPR/15480

कार्यपालक अभियन्ता का कार्यालय क्षेत्र सर्वेक्षण प्रमण्डल, अग्रिम योजना, पथ निर्माण विभाग चौथा तल्ला, निरूपण भवन, डोरण्डा, राँची e-mail--- eercdapfsdran-jhr@nic.in

शुद्धि-पत्र एतद द्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि कार्यालय द्वारा निर्गत e-Tender Reference No -RCD/FSD /AP/ RAN/06/26-27 Dated 25.08.2026 जिसका फ़ीडआरन0 388536 Road (26-27) D है, अपहिर्य कारणों से रद्द किया जाता है।

कार्यपालक अभियन्ता, क्षेत्र सर्वेक्षण प्रमण्डल, अग्रिम योजना, पथ निर्माण विभाग, राँची

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU

0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F), email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

Hue and Cry Notice Rule No. 712/191

SDPO City East, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Vishal Kumar alias Vishu S/O Balbir Chand R/O Pandoori Manhaasa Tehsil Bishnah A/P Rorian Di Chapri Janipur, Jammu is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 181/2017 U/S 406 RPC, of P/S Bahu Fort, Jammu. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded. It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments/ Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :- Name :- Vishal Kumar alias Vishu S/O :- Balbir Chand Address:- Pandoori Manhaasa Tehsil Bishnah A/P Rorian Di Chapri Janipur, Jammu 30-35 Years Age :-

Contacts/Telephone Numbers:- 1. DPO, Jammu :- 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578 2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D :- sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in 3. PCR Jammu :- 0191-2605949 4. SP City South :- 0191-2430002 5. SDPO City East :- 01912433778 6. P/S Bahu Fort :- 0191-2475133

For Sr. Superintendent of Police Jammu Date:- .08.2026

कार्यपालक अभियन्ता का कार्यालय क्षेत्र सर्वेक्षण प्रमण्डल, अग्रिम योजना, पथ निर्माण विभाग चौथा तल्ला, निरूपण भवन, डोरण्डा, राँची e-mail--- eercdapfsdran-jhr@nic.in

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0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F), email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

Hue and Cry Notice Rule No. 712/191

SDPO City East, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Jagdish Kumar S/O Bankey Lal R/O Kanota District Doda is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 82/2006 U/S 377 RPC, 4/25 Arms Act of P/S Bahu Fort, Jammu. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded. It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :- Name :- Jagdish Kumar S/O :- Bankey Lal Address:- Kanota District Doda 45-50 Years Age :-

Contacts/Telephone Numbers:- 1. DPO, Jammu :- 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578 2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D :- sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in 3. PCR Jammu :- 0191-2605949 4. SP City South :- 0191-2430002 5. SDPO City East :- 01912433778 6. P/S Bahu Fort :- 0191-2475133

For Sr. Superintendent of Police Jammu Date:- .08.2026

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For Sr. Superintendent of Police Jammu Date:- .08.2026

Govt. of Bihar RURAL WORKS DEPARTMENT

Office of the Engineer-in-chief-cum-Additional Commissioner -cum-Special Secretary/Engineer-in-Chief, Rural Works Department, Bihar

5th floor, Visvesvaraya Bhawan, Nehru Path, Patna-800015

DETAILED NOTICE INVITING TENDER (through e-procurement mode only http://pmsgstendersbih.gov.in) for Construction of road/bridge and 06 year Operation & Management (O&M) with surface renewal under component of Sulabh Samparkta Yojana (SSY).

Notice Inviting Tender No.- RWD/SSY/HQ/ET/27/2026-27

1. Designation and Address of the Advertiser : Engineer-in-chief-cum-Additional Commissioner-cum-Special Secretary/Engineer-in-chief, Rural Works Department, Govt. of Bihar

2. Date of Notice Inviting Tender : 25.08.2026

3. Period for download of Tender Document : From 25.09.2026 (9:00 hrs) to up to 09.10.2026 15:00 hrs

4. Date, Time & Place of Pre-Bid meeting : Date 01.10.2026 at 15:00 hrs

5. Last Date & Time for uploading tender : Date 09.10.2026 till 15:00 hrs documents by bidder http://pmsgstendersbih.gov.in

6. Date and time of opening of Technical Bid : Date 09.10.2026 Time 15:30 hrs.

7. Details of Works and Services :

Sl. No.	District	Division	Block	Road/Bridge Name	Length (in km)	Total Constructi on Cost (in Lakhs)	6 years Operati on & Manage ment Cost (in lakh)	Total Estimated Cost (in Lakhs)	Amount of Earnest money in Online Mode(i n Lakh)*	Cost of B.O.Q. In Online Mode (Rs.
1	Gopalganj	Gopalganj-1	Kataiya	Parsauni Nahar pul se sota dharhara tak path ka nirman	6.64	1014.605	93.427	1108.03	21.080	10000/-
2	Gopalganj	Gopalganj-1	Kataiya	Sota Dharhara se Dhanauti petrol pump tak path ka nirman karya	6.66	924.405	96.845	1021.25	20.213	10000/-
3	Gopalganj	Gopalganj-1	Kataiya	H.L Bridge across Sona river at chainage- 2.950 km in Parsauni Nahar pul se sota dharhara path	0.05137	457.990	5.190	463.18	9.26	10000/-

8. Bid Validity : 180 days. For further details please visit : www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar

PR. No. 010726 (RWD) 2026-27 सुरक्षित जीवन अपनाओ, अपनी नियमित एच.आई.वी. जाँच कराओ।

Engineer-in-chief-cum- Additional Commissioner -cum-Special Secretary/ Engineer-in-chief Rural Works Department,

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER, INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY AND COMMUNICATION DIVISION KASHMIR POWER DISTRIBUTION CORPORATION LIMITED (KPDCL) PDD COMPLEX BEMINA, SRINAGAR

Tel No: 0194-2490821 | Fax No: 0194-2490829

Tender Notice

eNIT No: 05 of 2026 Dated 25-08-2026

For and on behalf of the Lt. Governor of Jammu and Kashmir Union Territory, e-Tender (in Two Cover System) is hereby invited from eligible bidders meeting the eligibility and qualification criteria prescribed in Section 4 of the Standard Bidding Document including MeitY-empennelled Cloud Service Providers with the requisite legal, financial and technical standing - for "Middleware Cloud Infrastructure" at IT&C Division (KPDCL), PDD Complex, Bemina, Srinagar.

S. NO.	Description of Work	Earnest Money (In Rs)	Estimated Cost (In Laacs)	Last date of submission of e-bid
01	Middleware Cloud Infrastructure (Design and Implementation of Cloud Infrastructure and Managed Services for Integration Middleware Platform.)	Rs. 1,60,000	Rs. 80.Lacs (inclusive of GST)	21-Sep-2026 02:00pm

Bidders are advised to study the Bidding Document carefully. Submission of e-Bid against this SBD shall be deemed to have been done after careful study and examination of the procedures, terms and conditions of the Standard Bidding Document with full understanding of its implications by the bidder.

The tender document is available on website http://jktenders.gov.in. Interested bidders may view or download the e-Bid document, seek clarification and submit their e-Bid online up to the date as per the details mentioned in the table below:

A	Date & Time of downloading of Standard Bidding Document	The Standard Bidding Document can be downloaded over http://jktenders.gov.in from 29-Aug-2026 04:30pm
B	Sale of Bid Document (Start)	29-Aug-2026 04:30pm
C	Pre-Bid Meeting (Online) (Meeting Link: https://meet.google.com/tuw-gkax-pav)	03-Sep-2026 02:30pm
D	e-Bid submission (start) date and time (submission of e-tender fee, EMD and other supporting documents in PDF/XLS format)	05-Sep-2026 04:30pm
E	e-Bid submission (End) date and time (submission of e-tender fee, EMD and other supporting documents in PDF/XLS format)	21-Sep-2026 02:00pm
F	Online Techno-Commercial e-bid opening date and time	24-Sep-2026 11:30am
G	Online financial e-bid opening date & time (only of the technically qualified bidders)	Will be communicated to the technically qualified bidders
H	Venue of opening of technical & financial e-bids	The office of Chief Executive Officer, IT&C Division (KPDCL), PDD Complex, Bemina, Srinagar
I	Bid Processing Fee	Rs. 1000 (Rupees One Thousand only)
J	Amount of Earnest Money Deposit	Rs. 1,60,000.00 (Rupees One Lakh Sixty Thousand Only)

The bidders need to submit the proof/Bid Processing Fee document as stated above through e-Challan/Treasury Receipt pledged to Chief Executive Officer, IT&C Division (KPDCL), PDD Complex, Bemina, Srinagar to be credited to M.H-0801-Power payable at Srinagar. The scanned copy of the e-Challan/Treasury Receipt must be enclosed along with the e-Bids. Bidders registered/located within Jammu and Kashmir Union Territory shall pay the Bid Processing Fee only through e-Challan/Treasury Receipt; out-of-State bidders may alternatively pay through Demand Draft in favour of Chief Executive Officer, IT&C Division, KPDCL, Bemina, Srinagar, payable at Srinagar.

All the e-Bids must be accompanied by the scanned copy of EMD in the form of CDR / FDR only, pledged to the Chief Executive Officer, IT&C Division, KPDCL, Bemina, Srinagar. No Interest would be payable on Earnest Money deposited with the Department.

- The successful bidder shall, within 7 days of notification of award, submit to the office of the Chief Executive Officer, IT&C Division (KPDCL), PDD Complex, Bemina, Srinagar a complete hard copy of its uploaded e-bid, together with the original CDR/FDR pledged as above and the original e-Challan/Treasury Receipt. No other bidder shall be required to submit hard copies. The successful bidder shall be determined in accordance with Section 5 of the Standard Bidding Document.
- The date and time of opening of financial bids shall be notified on website http://jktenders.gov.in. This is conveyed to the qualified bidders automatically through an e-mail message on their e-mail address. The financial bids shall be opened accordingly online on the same website at the office of the Chief Executive Officer, IT&C Division (KPDCL), PDD Complex, Bemina, Srinagar.
- The e-Bids will be electronically opened in the presence of bidders' representatives, who choose to attend at the identified venue on the indicated date and time mentioned in the above table, or any subsequent day to the convenience of the Tender Opening Committee. An authority letter of the bidder's representative will be required to be produced.
- The Department reserves the right to cancel any or all the e-Bids/the e-Bid process without assigning any reason thereof. The decision of the Department will be final and binding.
- In the event of the date specified for e-Bids opening being a holiday/closed day for the Department's office, then the due date for opening of e-Bids shall be the following working day at the same time and place.
- All the required documents excluding Price Schedule/BOQ should be uploaded by the e-Bidder electronically in the PDF format, whereas Price Schedule/BOQ should be uploaded electronically in the same BOQ sheet provided with the SBD.
- To participate in the e-bidding process, bidders have to obtain a 'Digital Signature Certificate (DSC)' Class III(b), as per the Information Technology Act 2000, to participate in online bidding.
- The Name of the Work/Job along with the e-NIT reference should be superscripted in bold letters on the envelope, and the Name/Firm should be clearly written on the cover.
- The name of the bidder and e-NIT no. shall be clearly written on the cover. Other details can be seen in the bidding documents. Any other information regarding the e-tendering process can be had from the office of the Chief Executive Officer, IT&C Division (KPDCL), PDD Complex, Bemina, Srinagar.

No: CEO/IT&C/KMR/1527-30
Dated: 25-08-2026
DIPK-NB-1516/26 - DATE 31 AUG 2026

Sd/-
Chief Executive Officer,
IT & C Division
Bemina, Srinagar

"IMPORTANT"

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GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. NO. NAME OF BOARD/CORP/ AUTH NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER OPENING DATE (CLOSING DATE) (TIME) AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/CORP/ AUTH NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL

1 HARYANA STATE WAREHOUSING CORPORATION PANCHKULA CONSTRUCTION OF LABOUR HUT, LABOUR TOILET, QC LAB, GUARD ROOM ETC. AS PER REQUIREMENT OF DEPOT DARPAN INTRODUCED BY FCI AND REPLACEMENT OF SHEET AND ANNUAL SPECIAL REPAIR INCLUDING EI WORK AT SWH, TOHANA- LIH AND III + 26 WORKS 24.08.2026 03.09.2026 9,24,22,231/- https://etenders.hry.nic.in 7206674854 secretary-ho@hswc.org.in

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 48767/HRY

AXIS FINANCE LIMITED (CIN U65921MH1995PLC212675)

Axis House, C-2, Media International Centre, Pandurang Budhkar, Near: Worli, Mumbai - 400 025

Under Section 13 (2) of the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 ("Act") read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 ("Rules"). Whereas the undersigned being the Authorized Officer of Axis Finance Limited (AFL) under the Act and in exercise of powers conferred under Section 13 (12) read with Rule 3 of the Rules already issued detailed Demand Notice dated below under Section 13(2) of the Act, calling upon the Borrower(s)/Co-Borrower(s)/Guarantor(s) (all singularly or together referred to "Obligors")/Legal Heir(s)/Legal Representative(s) listed hereunder, to pay the amount mentioned in the respective Demand Notice, within 60 days from the date of the respective Notice, as per details given below. Copies of the said Notices are served by Registered Post A.D. and are available with the undersigned, and the said Obligor(s)/Legal Heir(s)/Legal Representative(s), may, if they so desire, collect the respective copy from the undersigned on any working day during normal office hours.

In connection with the above, Notice is hereby given, once again, to the said Obligor(s) /Legal Heir(s)/Legal Representative(s) to pay to AFL, within 60 days from the date of the respective Notice/s, the amount indicated herein below against their respective names, together with further interest as detailed below from the respective dates mentioned below in column (d) till the date of payment and / or realization, read with the loan agreement and other documents/writings, if any, executed by the said Obligor(s). As security for due repayment of the loan, the following Secured Asset(s) have been mortgaged to AFL by the said Obligor(s) respectively.

Sr. No	Loan Account No.	Name of Obligor(s)/ Legal Heir(s)/ Legal Represent-ative(s)	DETAILS OF SECURED ASSET	Total Outstanding Dues (Rs.) as on below date	Date of Demand Notice	Date of NPA
1.	0456MMA00011118	Govind Yadav, Rita Yadav & Baba Cement Traders	All the piece, part and parcel of Commercial Property which is part of property ID i.e. N0400414285221 which is also comprised in Khewat No. 1609 Khatori No. 1826 Rect. No. 209 Kila. No. 51/2min(0-11) measuring 11 Marla its 17/2200th share i.e. 1.7 Marla i.e. 51 sq. yards situated at Sector-3 Part-2, Rewari Tehsil and District Rewari Haryana 123401. Bounded by: East : Property of Ramesh West: Government Land North :Garhi Bolni Road South :Property of Reeta Yadav	INR. 74,88,435/- (Rupees) Seventy Four Lakhs Eighty Eight Thousand Four Hundred Thirty Five Only) due as on 24 th August 2026	24.08.2026	03.08.2026

*with further interest, additional Interest at the rate as more particularly stated in respective Demand Notices dated mentioned above, incidental expenses, costs, charges etc incurred till the date of payment and/or realization. If the said Obligor(s) shall fail to make payment to AFL as aforesaid, then AFL shall proceed against the above Secured Asset(s)/Immovable Property (ies) under Section 13(4) of the said Act and the applicable Rules entirely at the risk of the said Obligor(s)/Legal Heir(s)/Legal Representative(s) as to the costs and consequences. The said Obligor(s)/Legal Heir(s)/Legal Representative(s) are prohibited under the said Act to transfer the aforesaid Secured Asset(s)/Immovable Property(ies), whether by way of sale, lease or otherwise without the prior written consent of AFL. Any person who contravenes or abets contravention of the provisions of the Act or Rules made thereunder shall be liable for imprisonment and/or penalty as provided under the Act.

Place: REWARI

For Axis Finance Limited
Authorised Officer

India's tradition is to educate, not conquer: RSS chief in Canada

Deeptiman Tiwary
New Delhi, August 31



“Whenever it became big, it never became a superpower. It (India) became a glorious country... it became Vishwaguru, not Mahashakti”

MOHAN BHAGWAT, IN TORONTO ON MONDAY.

MOHAN BHAGWAT, the chief of BJP's ideological parent Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS), said on Monday that Bharat attained the status of "Vishwaguru" – meaning the world's teacher – not by becoming a "Mahashakti" (superpower), but through its "character" and tradition of serving the world. Bhagwat said that India's rise should mean a "more united and emancipated humanity". "Whenever it became big, it never became a superpower. It became a glorious country... one might call it a superpower then. But it served the world. By its character, it became Vishwaguru, not Mahashakti," Bhagwat told members of the Indian community in Canada.

He said India's civilisational tradition is to share knowledge, not to "conquer" or "convert", and cited the journeys of Indians across regions from Mexico to Siberia and Southeast Asia. "They conquered no country. They converted no body. Wherever they went, they gave knowledge, mathematics, ayurveda, civilisational values," he said.

The RSS chief said this tradition of service and acceptance is rooted in the Hindu understanding of the unity underlying diversity. "The inanimate and animate, both are ours. That is what a Hindu feels. They have been trained to see the unity underlying the diversity," he said.

He cited instances of India providing refuge to persecuted communities and helping people caught in crises abroad, including the evacuation of citizens of other countries from conflict zones in the Middle East. "Whenever there was a crisis anywhere in the world and help was sought, Bharat provided help. It provided help

even when it was not asked. This is the DNA of Bharat," he said.

Bhagwat's remarks came a day after his address at New York's Madison Square Garden, where he described Bharat's "destiny" as making the world realise that unity could coexist with diversity, and that this had to be demonstrated "not by preaching, but by practice". His Canada speech similarly sought to define India's global role in terms of its civilisational values rather than its economic or military power.

He said India's ancient understanding of Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam was based on seeing everyone as a brother rather than as an owner or possessor. "Thinking that this is mine, that is his is narrowness. Those who are broad-minded believe in Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam," he said.

India, he said, has always been diverse, with multiple castes, creeds, languages and religions. "Because we know diversity is natural. And unity is the reality," he said.

STEM WATER DISTRIBUTION & INFRASTRUCTURE CO. PVT. LTD., THANE

Vardan Commercial Complex, 9th Floor, MIDC, Road No. 16, Wagale Industrial Estate, Thane (W)-400 604. stemwatercompany@gmail.com

E-Tender Notice No.6 for 2026-27.

STEM Water Dist & Infra. Co. Pvt. Ltd., Thane are invited E-Tender in the form of B-1 & D Tender for following work.

Sr. No	Name of Work	Date & Time
1.	Annual Maintenance contract for maintenance & repairs to Civil Components & Electrical /Mechanical Machinery of Shahad Head works & 285 MLD WTP Temghat with allied components with supply of manpower services for 2 years.	Start Dt. 02/09/26 at 12.00 Hrs Pre bid Dt 08/09/26 at 12.00 Hrs End Dt. 28/09/26 at 12.00 Hrs Technical bid Open on Dt. 30/9/26 at 12.00 Hrs

E-Tender documents will be available for view/downloading on authorized website https://mahatenders.gov.in Right to reject any or all tenders without assigning any reason there of is reserved by the STEM Water Distri, & Infra. Co. Pvt. Ltd, Thane

Sd/-
Managing Director

AMARAVATI GROWTH AND INFRASTRUCTURE CORPORATION LIMITED (AGCIL)

2nd Floor, APCRODA Office, Rayapudi (P), Thulluru (M), Amaravati, Guntur (D), A.P.-522237

NIT. No. 13/MO/CE/AGCIL/2026

E-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE

1. AGCIL-Engagement of Project Management Consultancy (PMC) for Construction of Shell & Core and MEP services for Twin Office Towers (T1 & T2) at Amaravati Industrial Valley, Amaravati.

The bids can be downloaded on AP e-procurement portal from 02-09-2026. For further details, please refer to www.approcurement.gov.in and www.agcil.org

Sd/- Managing Director (FAC), AGCIL.

AXIS FINANCE LIMITED (CIN U65921MH1995PLC212675)

Axis House, C-2, Media International Centre, Pandurang Budhkar, Near: Worli, Mumbai - 400 025

APPENDIX IV (See Rule 8(I)) SYMBOLIC POSSESSION NOTICE (For Immovable property) [As per Appendix IV read with rule 8(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002]

Whereas, The undersigned being the Authorized Officer of the Axis Finance Limited (AFL), under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of Powers conferred under Section 13 (12) read with the Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, issued a demand notice dated 17th June, 2026 calling upon the Borrower(s) / Guarantor(s) / Mortgageor(s)

1. R D Dresses (Borrower) Address: 1st Floor Near Main Roa138 Ganeshi Das Building Raghurber Purgandhi Nagar Delhi East Delhi Delhi Email: MEENJUSY@YAHOO.COM Mob: 9911299383

2. Sanjay Jain (Co-Borrower 1) Address: A-49, Preet Vihar, Nirman Vihar East Delh East Delhi Delhi 110092 Email: MEENJUSY@YAHOO.COM Mob: 9911299383

3. Meenu Jain (Co-Borrower 2) Address: A-49, Preet Vihar, Nirman Vihar East Delh East Delhi Delhi 110092 Email: MEENJUSY@YAHOO.COM Mob: 9911299383

4. Himanshu Jain (Co-Borrower 3) Address: A-49, Preet Vihar, Nirman Vihar East Delh East Delhi Delhi 110092 Email: MEENJUSY@YAHOO.COM Mob: 9911299383

(Hereinafter collectively referred as "Borrowers") who have mortgaged the property more particularly described hereunder to repay the amount mentioned in the notice being INR 75,02,634/- (Rupees Seventy Five Lakh Two Thousand Six Hundred And Thirty Four Only) due as on 04 June, 2026 with further interest at the contractual rate thereon till the date of payment within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice.

The Borrower(s) / Guarantor(s) / Mortgageor(s) having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the Borrower(s) / Guarantor(s) / Mortgageor(s) and the public in general that the undersigned has taken Symbolic Possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 on this 29th day of August of the year 2026.

The Borrower(s) / Guarantor(s) / Mortgageor(s) in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of the Axis Finance Limited for an amount of INR 75,02,634/- (Rupees Seventy Five Lakh Two Thousand Six Hundred And Thirty Four Only) due as on 04 June, 2026 and further interest thereon at the contractual rates together with costs, charges, etc. of Axis Finance Ltd until the full payment or realization in full.

The Borrower(s) / Guarantor(s) / Mortgageor(s) attention is invited to provisions of sub section (8) & sub section (13) of section 13 of the said Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets.

DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY

ALL THAT PIECE AND PARCEL OF ENTIRE BUILD UP THIRD FLOOR WITH ROOF RIGHTS, LAND AREA MEASURING 80 SQ. YDS., I.E. 66.88 SQ. MTRS., HAVING ITS PLINTH/COVERED AREA MEASURING 66.88 SQ. MTRS., ALONGWITH ITS WHOLE OF STRUCTURE ACCORDING TO THE SITE THEREIN, CONSISTING OF ONE HALL THEREIN, FITTED WITH ELECTRICITY & WATER TAP CONNECTIONS WITH THEIR SEPARATE METERS, COMMON ENTRANCE, PASSAGE & STAIRCASE, WITH THE RIGHTS TO INSTALL/MAINTAIN THE WATER TANK & T.V. ANTENNA ON THE ROOF OF TOP FLOOR, A PART OF PROPERTY BEARING NO. X/138 (CONSTRUCTED ON OLD PLOT NO.15 & 16) OUT OF KHASRA NO.588/457/73/8, SITUATED IN THE ABADI OF GANESHI DASS BUILDING, RAGHUBER SHAHADRA, DELHI-110031, ALONGWITH PROPORTIONATE UNDIVIDED, INDIVISIBLE & IMPARTABLE OWNERSHIP RIGHTS IN THE LAND UNDERNEATH AND BOUNDED AS-

EAST- GALI
WEST- GALI
NORTH- OTHER'S PROPERTY.
SOUTH- OTHER'S PROPERTY.

Date: 29-08-2026
Place: Delhi

Authorized Officer
Axis Finance Ltd.

Tata Advanced Systems to co-produce US Javelin missile system in India

Amrita Nayak Dutta
New Delhi, August 31

TATA ADVANCED Systems Limited (TASL) will co-produce the Javelin anti-tank guided missile system with the Javelin Joint Venture (JJV) — a partnership between American companies Raytheon and Lockheed Martin — in India. In a joint statement on Monday, TASL and JJV announced that they had signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU).

The statement, which comes days after India finalised a deal to purchase the Javelin system from the United States, said TASL was selected by JJV as the prime partner for future in-country co-production efforts based on capability and expertise.

“Under the industry MoU, TASL and JJV will explore the establishment of a final assembly Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1 integration, it said.

Under the MoU, a final assembly and integration facility for Javelin AUR will be set up in India, said a statement

Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1 integration, it said. “Partnering with TASL to establish a dedicated Javelin final assembly and integration facility in India is a pivotal step in ensuring a resilient supply chain for this critical anti-tank weapon system,” said Rich Liccion, vice president, JJV, and programme director, Lockheed Martin Javelin. “This collaboration not only expands India’s high-tech manufacturing capabilities but also reinforces a stronger, more stable security architecture across the Indo-Pacific region, enabling our partners around the world to respond swiftly to emerging threats,” he said.

“We are pleased to partner with the JJV on this important next step in our long-standing relationship with Lockheed Martin and Raytheon,” said Sukaran Singh, Chief Executive Officer & Managing Director, TASL. “This initiative brings critical assembly expertise and knowledge transfer into India’s defence industrial ecosystem, while strengthening self-reliance. Local assembly of the Javelin All Up Round will enhance operational readiness and ensure timely access to proven, combat-ready capability for the Indian Armed Forces,” he said.

The joint statement noted that the agreement would support future production of the Javelin system while providing unique opportunities for Indian industry and strengthening regional stability in the Indo-Pacific by ensuring

a reliable, locally sourced supply of the Javelin weapon system, supporting faster fielding and sustained readiness for partner nations in the region.

It said the establishment of in-country co-production would strengthen India’s defence industrial base by bringing final assembly and integration of the Javelin AUR to Indian facilities and suppliers, creating high-tech jobs, advancing local manufacturing expertise and supporting global supply chain resiliency due to increased worldwide demand.

The partnership demonstrates deeper strategic collaboration between the JJV and Indian partners, reinforcing interoperability and joint defence initiatives that align with broader Indo-Pacific partnership objectives, the statement said, adding that the larger volume from co-production can

help the US government achieve economic order quantities, improving affordability and creating measurable cost-saving opportunities for programmes that support JJV production.

The JJV has produced over 55,000 Javelin missiles and over 12,000 reusable Command Launch Units so far.

In 2010, plans to procure the missile system could not go through as the US refused to share the missile’s core seeker technology under a 100% transfer of technology model, causing India to pivot to Israel’s Spike missile system in 2014.

A US Congressional Research Service report in 2012 subsequently noted that India turned down a proposed Javelin purchase that included a co-production offer, with issues surrounding US end-use monitoring and technology transfer being among the complications.



UP: 8 children among 11 killed in firecracker factory blast

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, August 31

EIGHT CHILDREN were among 11 killed in an explosion at a firecracker factory in Uttar Pradesh’s Manauri village, located on the border of Kaushambi and Prayagraj districts, on Monday.

The factory was reportedly being operated from a house situated in the middle of agricultural fields. Police said the blast was so powerful that four to five houses nearby were damaged.

Superintendent of Police, Kaushambi, Satya Narayan Prajapati, said the manufacturing unit belonged to one Naushad, whose licence was already under suspension. Police said Naushad is on the run and they have detained his relatives for questioning.

Police said the illegal portion of the building where the blast took place is being demolished.

The deceased have been identified as Priyanjali (5), Praveen Singh (13), Jahanvi (12), Aditya (12), Aditya (8), Ravi (8), Anju (32), Gyan Singh (40), Vikram Saroj (35), Ansh (6) and Nana (4), said District Magistrate Amit Pal.

Police have not yet confirmed whether any of the deceased was a member of Naushad’s family.

Officials are yet to ascertain what triggered the blast.

According to the preliminary inquiry, a series of powerful explosions reportedly occurred after which smoke was seen billowing from the building, prompting villagers to rush towards the spot.

Given the intensity of the blast, train operations on the Delhi-Howrah railway line passing near the site were suspended for about an hour.

The Ajmer-Sealdah Express, which had reached near the incident site, was sent back to Manori railway station, while the Vande Bharat Express travelling from Delhi to Varanasi was stopped at Saiyad Sarawan railway station, one station before the site.

The Manori Air Force Station is located around two kilometres from the site.

Following information about the explosion, local police and fire department teams rushed to the spot. Several fire tenders were deployed to control the flames and assist in the rescue operation.

The injured were taken to hospitals in Prayagraj.

In a post on X in Hindi, UP Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath said, “Instructions have been issued to local officials to ensure proper medical treatment for the injured and to reach out to the affected families to provide all possible assistance. Furthermore, directives have been issued to provide financial aid of Rs 2 lakh each to the next of kin of the deceased and Rs 50,000 each to the injured.”

WITH PTI INPUTS



Police officers keep vigil following the inundation of Daraganj, after rainfall in Prayagraj, on Monday. PTI

After 16% rainfall deficit in August, IMD says Sept to remain below normal as well

Anjali Marar
Bengaluru, August 31

DESPITE A few good spells of rainfall during the month, India finished August with over 16 per cent shortfall in normal rains for the month, the India Meteorological Department (IMD) said on Monday. It forecast less than 91 per cent of normal rains for September, the last month of the monsoon season.

India’s seasonal rainfall, for the entire four-month rainy season between June and September, is likely to remain well below 90 per cent. Till August, the seasonal rainfall has been 84 per cent of normal. August is the second rainiest month of the season, after July. It accounts for 29 per cent of the seasonal rainfall compared to 32 per cent of July.

“With below-normal rainfall expected in September, the season is most likely to remain below 90 per cent of the LPA,” said IMD Director General Mrutyunjay Mohapatra at a press conference on Monday.

The IMD said of the 741 districts being monitored, 312 (42 per cent) had deficient rains till August, and another 38 districts (5 per cent) had large deficiency. Only 290 districts, which included all in Odisha, have received normal rainfall till now, it said.

IMD said the El Nino phenomenon persisting in the equatorial Pacific Ocean had begun to have its impact on the Indian monsoon, and that was one of the main reasons for the 16 per cent deficit in August, which was the seventh largest deficiency for the month since 2001.

“Although four low pressure systems developed during August and collectively persisted for 26 days, their rainfall activity was largely confined to the Indo-Gangetic Plains,” it said.

The southern peninsula had a rainfall deficit of over 27 per cent for the month. Central India and eastern and northeastern regions both had a deficiency of about 16 per cent while the northwestern region received rains that were about 10 per cent less than normal.

For September, the IMD said normal rainfall would be limited to parts of Odisha, eastern parts of Madhya Pradesh, Bihar, Jharkhand, eastern Uttar Pradesh, Nagaland, Manipur, Mizoram and Ladakh, whereas the rest of the country will experience below-average rain.

North India, including Delhi, Punjab, Haryana, Jammu and Kashmir, Himachal Pradesh, Uttar Pradesh and Uttarakhand, is bracing for heavy rain which will cease by September 5.

EXPRESS special Song with 54 mn views, a gang’s anger: Why Haryanvi singer Baliyan was killed

2 of the 4 suspects were shot dead in Shamli on Monday

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, August 31

A SONG about shooting a man in court, watched 54 million times on YouTube, allegedly put Haryanvi singer Ankit Baliyan in the crosshairs of the Jitender Gogi gang — and eventually cost him his life, police said.

The 28-year-old had appeared in the song “*Bhari Court Mein Goli Marenge Meri Jaan*”. Members of the Gogi gang allegedly believed its lyrics mocked their gang leader’s killing inside a Delhi courtroom in 2021 — at the hands of his arch rival Tilly Tajpuria — and accused Baliyan of releasing the song in collusion with the rival Tilly gang.

Police said Baliyan had allegedly been threatened by the gang in 2022-23 when he was in Delhi. He told them he had only acted in the video, and had no role in writing the lyrics or composing the music, police said. But the gang allegedly continued to suspect him. Baliyan was shot dead on the evening of August 26 while leaving a gym in Shamli’s Kotwali. He had not told his family or approached them about the threats.

“Ankit Baliyan featured in



Police said gang members believed Ankit Baliyan’s song *Bhari Court Mein Goli Marenge Meri Jaan* mocked their leader Jitender Gogi who was killed at the Delhi court in 2021

the song “*Court mein goli*”... As Tilly also belonged to the Baliyan gotra, like Ankit, members of the Gogi gang suspected that the song was intended to insult and provoke them,” said Shamli SP Narendra Pratap Singh.

On Monday, police gunned down two of the four men who allegedly shot Baliyan in an encounter in Shamli. Singh said efforts are underway to arrest the other two shooters, those who allegedly provided shelter to the accused, and those suspected of being part of the conspiracy.

Police said a team was conducting a checking drive in Kotwali early Monday when it spotted two men riding a motorcycle with a Baghpat registration number. When police signalled

them to stop, the men allegedly opened fire and fled. Police pursued them. When the road came to an end, the suspects abandoned the motorcycle and again opened fire, injuring Head Constables Harvinder and Pradeep in the hand and leg. The police team retaliated, injuring both suspects. They were taken to a hospital, where they were declared dead on arrival.

The two injured constables are undergoing treatment. Police said they recovered three pistols, live and spent cartridges, a motorcycle, a bag, a cellphone and Rs 5,000 in cash from the encounter site. The men were identified as Gogi gang members Mohit, 22, and Sumit, 24. They were from Sonipat in Haryana, and carried a reward of Rs 50,000 each. Police records showed around 14 cases had been registered against Mohit in Haryana, while Sumit had one case registered against him.

Police said the two accused, while being taken to hospital, told them they had been sent to carry out the killing on instructions of Haryana-based gangster Rahul alias Bholu Shahpuria, who is allegedly a member of the Gogi gang. Police said Rahul had instructed the two to travel to Shamli and meet two other men. He allegedly provided them with money and weapons, and instructed them to kill Baliyan.

Investigators found that the four suspects had visited Shamli

on August 20 to conduct reconnaissance of the area before the attack. They allegedly stayed at a hotel in Shamli during the visit. After the killing, police said, the four suspects immediately fled Shamli, with two travelling towards Baghpat and the other two towards Karnal. On the night of August 26-27, a social media post surfaced from an Instagram account claiming that the Gogi gang had taken responsibility for Baliyan’s killing.

Police said Rahul, believed to be hiding in India, carries a reward of Rs 1 lakh in connection with a triple murder case in Yamuna Nagar in 2024. Police suspect he uses social media platforms, including Snapchat, to communicate with his associates. Rahul operates under the direction of Rohit Rana alias Rohit Moi, who is lodged in Tihar Jail, and Rakesh alias Pampu, lodged in Karnal Jail in Haryana. Both are allegedly involved in running the Gogi gang.

Police said Rahul’s cousin Chirag, based in Canada, was allegedly behind the social media post claiming responsibility for Baliyan’s killing. Uttar Pradesh DGP Rajeev Krishna has announced a Rs 2 lakh reward for the police team involved in the operation and commended them for their courage. He added that the said effective coordination between police forces of different states had helped crack the case.

Check attacks on Nagas: Manipur’s 8 MLAs write to Shah

Express News Service
Imphal, August 31

A GROUP of Naga legislators from Manipur has sent a letter to Union Home Minister Amit Shah to intervene in the prevailing situation in the state, alleging that Kuki-Zo leaders and militant groups were involved in attacks on Naga civilians.

Manipur Deputy Chief Minister Loshii Dikho confirmed to *The Indian Express* that the

letter bearing the signatures of eight of the nine Naga MLAs has been sent to the Union Home Minister.

Nungba MLA Diganglung Gangmei was the only Naga MLA who did not sign the letter. When contacted, a close aide of the MLA said Gangmei hasn’t yet taken a decision on the letter.

In the letter, the MLAs described the situation in Manipur as “critical and volatile”

and called for what they termed “decisive and bold action” to prevent further deterioration.

The legislators have put forward five demands, including the arrest of Kuki-Zo leaders whom they alleged had publicly claimed responsibility for the killing and dismemberment of six Naga civilians.

They have also sought the arrest of Thangboi Kipgen of the Kuki National Front-P (KNF-P), alleging his involve-

ment in the killings.

The legislators have also demanded action against Manipur Deputy CM Nemcha Kipgen, alleging that Nemcha Kipgen’s office was colluding with the Kuki militant group allegedly led by her husband, Thangboi Kipgen.

The Naga legislators have also demanded immediate abrogation of the Suspension of Operations (SoO) agreement with all Kuki militant groups.

● AT THE FIRST-OF-ITS-KIND CAFÉ IN INDIA, INCLUSION IS ON TOP OF THE MENU AS THE FAMOUS ROYAL FAMILY WORKS TO CHANGE LGBTQI LIVES

Maharani’s café turns three, serving a platter of ‘pride’ and dignity in Vadodara

Aditi Raja
Vadodara, August 31

WHEN TANVI Parmar arrived in Vadodara after completing her Class 12, she left one life behind at her family’s home in Ahmedabad — that of a woman trapped in a man’s body.

The 19-year-old found work in Vadodara with Lakshya Trust, a public charitable trust founded by Prince Marvendra-sinh Gohil of Rajpipla, described as the first openly gay member of India’s erstwhile royalty for the LGBTQI community.

It helped Tanvi navigate the uncertainties that confront many young transgender people who leave their homes after finding their families are unable or unwilling to under-

stand who they are.

And then she heard about an unusual new café that had opened in Vadodara — Gazra.

She met Radhikaraje Gaekwad, the titular Maharani of the erstwhile Baroda State, and over the next three years, Tanvi worked as a server at the café and also at its front desk.

She served customers and greeted visitors, and became part of the daily rhythm of a space that was attempting something deceptively radical: to normalise LGBTQI inclusion, make it look ordinary.

Tanvi is now preparing to undergo gender-affirming surgery, funded by Gazra. But the café has given her much more than just financial support, she says — it has changed the way

her family sees her.

“They had feared that after leaving home I would disappear into the marginalised world of transgender ghettos run by maasis,” she said. Instead, Tanvi’s family learnt that she had a dignified, public-facing job, at an establishment supported by one of Vadodara’s most recognisable families.

Founded by Radhikaraje, Gazra, completed three years last week. It is located in the building occupied by the 150-year-old royal women’s trust, Maharani Chinnabai Stree Udyogalay (MCSU).

Gazra takes its name and inspiration from Gajarabai, the birth name of Maharani Chinnabai II, the reformist queen who married into the Baroda



The cafe in Vadodara: Radhikaraje Gaekwad, the titular Maharani of the erstwhile Baroda State. BHUPENDRA RANA

royal family in 1885, and went on to campaign against purdah and child marriage.

Gazra’s profits, together with proceeds from the trust’s annual Garba fundraiser at the

Lukshmi Vilas Palace, now fund what the café sees as its real work — gender-affirmation surgery, support for families living with HIV, legal aid, and mental health resources.



A 46-year-old chef at the café is a married father of two daughters at home. “I am Dharmendra at home and Sridevi at Gazra,” she said, referring to two iconic Bollywood actors

seen by many as the epitome of masculinity and femininity respectively on screen.”

At age 15, the chef knew “who I was”, but being the “only son in a conservative family”, did not have the language to explain it.

“I got married and had two children, but I kept looking for ways to escape,” she said. “There was no acceptance for LGBTQI in those days, and in my community I would be not just ostracised but probably even harmed.” Gazra, she said, is an inclusive space that allowed her “to live my life without feeling suffocated”.

She did feel “extremely guilty” about having to keep secrets from her loved ones, though. But the double life, she added quietly, was necessary, for

there is “no other choice”.

“Many people don’t come out because they fear a backlash. But I can 100 per cent say now that the Garba festivities and my vocal support to the community has helped many people find their own voice too,” she said.

The café currently employs about 20 people, about half of whom belong to the LGBTQI community, Radhikaraje said.

But her larger objective, Radhikaraje said, is to not create a permanent dependence on a single institution.

“Education in any form that will give them employment and they can be independent is the way forward,” she said, placing particular emphasis on vocational training and mental health support.

The Indian EXPRESS

~ FOUNDED BY ~

RAMNATH GOENKA

◆ IN 1932 ◆

BECAUSE THE TRUTH INVOLVES US ALL

Strong quarter quickens pace, but risks remain

THE INDIAN economy grew at a robust 7.8 per cent in the first quarter of the ongoing financial year, despite the adverse fallout from the West Asia conflict. Growth surpassed expectations of most analysts, including the central bank, which, in the last Monetary Policy Committee meeting, had pegged the economy to grow at 7 per cent. The strong number for the quarter suggests that the full year's estimate of growth — the RBI had, for instance, projected growth at 6.7 per cent — could now be revised upwards.

Economic indicators had suggested that the underlying growth momentum was holding up despite an uncertain environment, with both industry and services growing at a fairly healthy clip. Within industry, manufacturing grew at a strong 9.2 per cent in the quarter while construction maintained a steady pace at 7.7 per cent, according to the National Statistics Office. This reflects in indicators such as cement production and steel consumption. Services have grown by a staggering 10 per cent, driven by the financial, real estate and professional services segment. In the recent State of the Economy report, economists from the RBI had noted that both manufacturing and services firms had seen improvement in their operating profits. For manufacturing firms, operating profit rose to 21.3 per cent during the quarter, up from 9.4 per cent in the one before that, while for IT and non-IT services it rose to 19.9 per cent and 12.7 per cent, respectively. Private consumption remains healthy, growing at 7.1 per cent in the quarter. Buoyant sales of passenger vehicles, two-wheelers and tractors, indicators of both urban and rural demand, reflect this. Investment activity, too, was robust. The capital goods segment in the index of industrial production grew by a steady 15 per cent. Alongside, the Centre's capex grew by roughly 24 per cent, while the combined capex of 17 major states rose by 6.8 per cent, as per Crisil. Bank credit has also been strong, with loans to both industry and for consumption growing at a fairly healthy rate. The subsequent recovery in the monsoon has aided kharif sowing.

There are, however, expectations of the growth momentum softening over the coming quarters. On the external front, the risks stem from continuing trade and geopolitical tensions — Brent crude oil prices have jumped after the US and Iran exchanged fire — while on the domestic front a strengthening El Niño is a challenge. These will require close monitoring.

Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RGF9mljMzg1

In US vs Iran, all roads lead back to Hormuz

THE US and Iran trading strikes for the first time in more than a month has brought the spotlight back on the military dimension in a conflict that had acquired an increasingly economic character. The US said its forces on Sunday attacked two Iranian rocket launchers that were preparing to deploy sea mines in the Strait of Hormuz, prompting an Iranian counterattack on American fighter jets at air bases in Jordan. The exchange comes as gasoline prices in the US rose again in August, while Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian acknowledged the economic pain being caused by US sanctions. The conflict's economic and military fronts remain closely intertwined, but neither side appears willing to call a halt to the hostilities.

Washington's resolve is evident in Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent's threat to unleash an "economic D-Day" to force Iran back to the table. Besides sanctioning dozens of Iran-linked entities, the US has said it could also target any country, company or bank that trades with Tehran. That is easier said than done. Iran has been hit by multiple layers of sanctions for years and has periodically adapted to withstand them. As for going after countries that trade with Iran, the problem is China. Beijing buys up to 90 per cent of Iran's oil and has threatened to retaliate if Chinese companies are included in Bessent's secondary sanctions. With US President Donald Trump and Chinese President Xi Jinping due to meet in Washington in the second half of September for trade negotiations, it is unlikely that Washington will risk antagonising Beijing, which has significant leverage of its own over critical minerals and manufacturing supply chains. Iran, or at least its civilian leadership, is also seeking a way out. Pezeshkian has repeatedly called for peace and went a step further over the weekend by saying that the June 17 MoU is in Tehran's interests. How far he will be allowed to pursue such an approach will depend on the hard-line IRGC, which opposes major concessions and views compromise as weakness.

Ultimately, all roads lead to Hormuz. Until there is a durable agreement on how to manage the waterway, there will be sporadic military attacks and renewed threats of economic escalation. The latest exchange makes clear that neither side is ready to forgo the military option.

Here's looking at you, Sooryavanshi

ALL EYES were on Vaibhav Sooryavanshi when East Zone began their first innings against Central Zone on Day 2 of the Duleep Trophy semi-final in Bengaluru on Monday. At 15, with the attention surrounding him growing with every innings, that was inevitable. Yet, he did not seem weighed down by it. He went out and played his own game against both the fast bowlers and spinners.

His 92 off 81 balls showed why there is so much excitement around him, and equally, why he remains a work in progress. He cover-drove fast bowler Yash Thakur for four, but was later beaten by the same bowler, who induced an outside edge that fell short of the wicketkeeper. He recovered quickly, straight driving Thakur before smashing a six over his head. Sooryavanshi did not curb his attacking instinct when off-spinner Saransh Jain came on in the 13th over. He was deceived in flight on 40, only for Yash Rathod to drop a sitter. The left-hander, though, did not go into his shell despite the reprieve. He tried the reverse sweep, used his feet, and launched Jain over long-on to reach 50 from 42 balls.

There is a little bit of Virender Sehwag in the way he bats: See the ball, trust yourself, and play without fear. He also has an uncluttered mind, unburdened by the fear of failure. But it is far too early for comparisons, and his dismissal showed why. With a fielder at mid-wicket, he still tried to clear him off Harsh Dubey and fell for 92. Yet, Sooryavanshi gives his team flying starts and makes captains think differently. His next step is learning when to attack and when to hold back and play bigger knocks, without losing what makes him special.

RSS CHIEF Mohan Bhagwat's New York speech must have frustrated those who opposed the event and sought its cancellation. They have done a disservice to the idea of free speech, which mandates the expression of all kinds of views, including those that people may find repulsive. The protestors' main grievance was the exclusionary and polarising ideology of Hindutva, which the RSS espouses and which, according to them, is not only alien to the great Hindu religion but also contrary to the liberal and secular ethos of the Constitution.

Bhagwat not only clarified his idea of Hindutva yet again, but also silenced the proponents of "one nation, one religion, one nation, one language, one nation, one law, etc." by explicitly emphasising diversity as the defining feature of Indian civilisation. This sermon on diversity is at variance with the classical idea of Hindutva propagated by V D Savarkar. Of course, unlike its advocates today, Savarkar was absolutely clear that Hindutva had nothing to do with Hinduism and both were distinct philosophies.

Bhagwat's words on August 29 at Madison Square Garden are not an abrupt change of heart. He has been making such positive statements for some time now. He has, at times, contradicted himself — for instance, his statement that Hindus had been at war with Muslims for over a thousand years, or that Muslims deliberately increase their population. Such statements have provided fodder to liberals to claim that the RSS has not changed and Bhagwat's positive

statements on diversity and Muslims are meant for optics. A few Muslim intellectuals who met him were criticised by this section, which is not yet ready to trust the RSS on its commitment to heterogeneity and inclusivity. Highly polarising statements bordering on hate speech by some Hindu right-wing groups and political leaders substantiate the thesis that there is no Hindutva perestroika, led by Bhagwat, in sight. Judicial decisions that have not found clearly provocative and threatening slogans to be problematic and a violation of hate-speech provisions enhance this distrust.

However, despite such distrust, it is important to look at the ramifications of Bhagwat's statements. He remains the most authoritative voice for Hindutva.

In his speech, Bhagwat repeated a thought he has often articulated: "If a Hindu thinks that there should be no Muslim in Bharat, he will not remain Hindu. If you want to call yourself Hindu, you must believe that all paths are leading to the same goal and every human has dignity." In another pleasant departure from the classic Hindutva position, Bhagwat asserted in an interview with a Hindi daily a few years ago that nowhere does the Constitution say that Hindus alone can live in India, or that only Hindus will have a say in this country, or that one has to accept the supremacy of Hindus to live in India.

Bhagwat deserves appreciation for repeatedly saying that Muslims are equal citizens of this country while Hindutva forces have histori-



FAIZAN MUSTAFA

Bhagwat silenced the proponents of 'one nation, one religion, one nation, one language, one nation, one law, etc.' by emphasising diversity as the defining feature of Indian civilisation

Next employment challenge is better jobs



GOURAV VALLABH

INDIA ENTERS its next employment decade with notable achievements. The government has expanded the foundations of work through infrastructure development, formalisation, financial inclusion, skilling and encouragement to entrepreneurship. The Reserve Bank of India's KLEMS productivity database provisionally estimates that employment rose from 47.15 crore in 2014-15 to 64.33 crore in 2023-24. The question is how this base can now produce more formal jobs, higher productivity, better wages and career progression.

NITI Aayog's report, Reimagining Skilling for Viksit Bharat@2047, released on August 18, places the challenge within a blueprint for demand-led, industry-linked and outcome-oriented skilling. It estimates that 9 crore young Indians were neither in education, employment nor training, excluding those seeking jobs, and that about 88 per cent were engaged in domestic duties. It is inaccurate to describe all of them as unemployed. But it's also true that millions of young women remain outside paid work because unpaid care, safety, mobility, social norms and limited local opportunities restrict choice.

Care is also needed when monthly, weekly and annual labour data are discussed together. The monthly Periodic Labour Force Survey bulletin provides a current pulse, but its Current Weekly Status classifies activity over the preceding seven days; the annual survey's usual status captures the durable yearly pattern. Monthly and weekly-status figures should track short-term movement, while annual usual-status figures assess structural progress. They are not interchangeable.

The aspiration of 2 crore jobs a year also needs clarity. It cannot mean 2 crore salaried government posts annually. The provisional KLEMS series records 17.18 crore additional workers over nine years through 2023-24, averaging about 1.9 crore a year. That is meaningful expansion, but aggregate numbers cannot settle the debate. India should publish an employment dashboard covering formalisation, real wage growth, social security, hours worked, sectoral productivity and movement from low-income work into stable careers.

Real Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F>

Sanctioned vacancies should be filled transparently; examination integrity and timely results must be non-negotiable. But the government cannot be the sole employer for a country adding millions of workers

This brings us to every family's concern: Where is the opportunity after graduation? Educated unemployment among first-time entrants is real. Yet saying graduates form a large share of unemployed youth is not the same as saying most graduates are unemployed. Important building blocks are in place. More than 1.64 crore candidates have been trained or oriented under the Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana, while over 56.08 lakh apprentices have been engaged since 2016.

The start-up sector offers evidence of progress. By April 2026, start-ups had reported more than 23 lakh direct jobs. India moved from four unicorns in 2014 to over 120 firms valued above \$1 billion, with a combined valuation exceeding \$350 billion. Around half of recognised start-ups emerge from Tier II and Tier III cities, and over 45 per cent had at least one woman director or partner by December 2025.

Public employment remains important. Sanctioned vacancies should be filled transparently; examination integrity and timely results must be non-negotiable. But the government cannot be the sole employer for a country adding millions of workers. The next step is helping viable micro-enterprises scale, formalise and hire.

Women will be the decisive measure of the next employment transformation. Female labour force participation in usual status rose from 23.3 per cent in 2017-18 to 41.7 per cent in 2023-24. Women hold 56 per cent of Jan Dhan accounts, receive about two-thirds of MUDRA loans and number over 10 crore in self-help groups. Tap water, clean cooking fuel and sanitation reduce drudgery, while housing ownership strengthens assets. This must be matched by affordable childcare, safe transport, working women's hostels, flexible formal work, digital access and quality jobs closer to home.

India's employment record gives the government a credible platform for the next leap. A compact among government, industry and education can convert scale into quality.

The writer is professor of Finance, XLRI and part-time member of the Economic Advisory Council to the Prime Minister. Views are personal

In India, a hard limit for X's transparency pledge



SUBIMAL BHATTACHARJEE

X complies with 83 to 99 per cent of demands. In July 2025, it said the government ordered 2,355 accounts blocked, including Reuters, within an hour — X objected loudly, then complied

ON AUGUST 15, Elon Musk distilled X's latest policy shift in a single line: "Any censorship required by governments is now clearly visible." Rather than quietly withholding a post under a local legal demand, X says it will tell users when a government sought the removal, name the agency, and, where possible, disclose the legal grounds.

Within days came the response from the establishment in India. On August 18, a senior Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) official told reporters that X "will have to comply with the Indian laws," adding that orders issued under Section 69A are "intended to be maintained as confidential."

The heart of the difficulty is Rule 16 of the Information Technology (Blocking) Rules, 2009, the operative framework under Section 69A, which mandates strict confidentiality over all requests and actions taken. Secrecy is what lets the executive block content often without a reasoned public order and without notifying the person whose content is blocked.

That is the direct collision. X proposes to publish exactly what Rule 16 forbids — that an order exists, which body issued it, and on what basis. And the stakes are not merely civil. Section 69A attaches criminal liability, including imprisonment up to seven years, to an intermediary that fails to comply. Because X operates as a locally incorporated entity with resident compliance and grievance officers, those consequences land on identifiable individuals inside the country.

There is a more immediate problem: The mechanism does not yet do what Musk claimed. The August release paired the open-sourced "Phoenix" recommendation code with a pilot feature, "Under the Hood", that shows selected users visibility labels on their own accounts, like spam flags and reach restrictions, not the government request behind a block. A 69A order works separately, and the user sees only the familiar "withheld in India" notice, naming neither order nor agency.

Meanwhile, a growing share of Indian takedowns no longer flows through Section 69A. Since a 2023 MeitY memorandum, ministries, states, and police issue orders under Section 79(3)(b), routed through the MHA's "Sahyog" portal, which X calls a censorship portal. Section 69A orders themselves have surged, from roughly 6,000 a year through 2023 to about 24,300 in 2025. Where orders arrive without a stated basis, X has little to surface even if it wanted to.

Then there is will. X brands itself a free-speech absolutist, yet complies with 83 to 99 per cent of demands. In July 2025, it said the government ordered 2,355 accounts blocked, including Reuters, within an hour — X objected loudly, then complied, restoring Reuters only after a public outcry.

Nor is the law shifting X's way. In September 2025, the Karnataka High Court dismissed its Sahyog challenge, calling the portal "an instrument of public good"; X's appeal and parallel Bombay petitions were consolidated when the Supreme Court stayed all four in July 2026.

Until a court says otherwise, "clearly visible" collides with a wall and the establishment has just said so out loud.

Bhattacharjee is a defence and tech policy adviser and author of The Digital Decades: On 30 Years of the Internet in India

40 YEARS AGO

September 1, 1986



Fund to counter South Africa

FOREIGN MINISTERS of non-aligned countries have reportedly agreed to set up a separate fund to help frontline states facing aggression from the racist South African regime. The ministers have also endorsed the Special Declaration on South Africa put forth by the 52-member Organisation of African Unity, calling on all countries to impose comprehensive sanctions against South Africa.

India-Pakistan summit likely

THERE IS a distinct possibility of a summit next week between India and Pakistan next week. President Zia-ul-Haq of Pakistan, who

is arriving in Harare to attend the non-aligned summit, is likely to seek a meeting with Prime Minister Rajiv Gandhi for a bilateral exchange of views. Gen Zia is attending the non-aligned summit amid much speculation about a rift between him and the Pakistani prime minister, M K Junejo.

After Srirampur massacre

THE HOME Minister, Buta Singh, has asked the Minister of State, Ghulam Nabi Azad, to visit Tripura following the killing of 14 people in Srirampur. Azad will leave for Agartala to study the situation and hold discussions with Chief Minister Nripen Chakraborty, senior officers of the state and security officers. Azad and the Deputy Chief

Minister of Tripura will visit Srirampur, the scene of the killings, on September 2.

Gavaskar dropped

SUNIL GAVASKAR has been dropped for the first two one-day internationals against Australia. The selection committee, which met in Bangalore under the chairmanship of Chandu Borde, has come out with what it called an "experimental team, keeping the 1987 World Cup in mind". Borde told newsmen that the team for the internationals to be played in Jaipur (September 7) and Srinagar (September 9) did not contain Sandip Patil, Mohinder Amarnath, wicket-keeper Kiran More or Shivaliv Yadav, besides Gavaskar.



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The Ideas Page

TUESDAY, SEPTEMBER 1, 2026

In 21st century, we need to be saved from 20th-century ideas meant to save us



DESHKAAL
BY YOGENDRA YADAV

WE LIVE in a *bhuta-kaala*. Forget the jazzy self-images of the 21st century. We actually live in a tired century that belongs to *bhuta* in both senses of the word — past age and time of ghosts. We are living inside the haunted ruins of a building meant for a different age and another part of the world that we still mistake for our house. Every day, a manmade disaster appears on our timeline — destruction in Nepal, genocide in Gaza or the tantrums of Donald Trump — and reminds us that the grand designs that continue to rule us have mutated into *bhutas*, grotesque inversions of what they were meant to achieve. We need to be saved from the ideas that were meant to save us.

About two centuries ago, Alexis de Tocqueville described his predicament thus: “I find no parallel to what is occurring before my eyes; since the past has ceased to throw its light upon the future, the mind of man wanders in obscurity.” We are in a similar spot, in between two worlds — one that is dead and another yet to be born. Except that we insist on carrying the cursed old furniture to the new world. Europe’s past and America’s present have ceased to throw light upon our future. Western modernity is stale. It stinks. Yet we dress it up daily to serve to our children.

Take democracy, that charming ideal of realising every human being’s quest for self-rule. The revolutionary idea of the last century has by now turned into a standardised global template called liberal democracy. The idea of popular sovereignty has been translated into representative government based on majority rule through competitive elections. In our collective struggle to protect this minimalist version, we shy away from facing the harsh truth that the regimes we call democracy have achieved self-rule only for a few, in select places and that too for a



ILLUSTRATION: C.R SASIKUMAR

short period of time. More often than not, modern democracy or its clones have produced disempowerment of the people in the face of an omnipotent state, unaccountable party oligarchy, corporate-controlled media and money power. Populism, majoritarianism or elected autocracies are not maladies of modern democracy. These are the natural consequence of the mechanism that we have accepted and celebrated as democracy.

Turn to the next grand template — the nation-state — that we now treat as the natural political home for citizens. This arises from human beings’ innate need to belong, their desire to be free from solitude. In modern times, we realise it by carving the world into political communities called “nations”. These imagined communities serve as the loci of state power, solicit our affection and demand our undivided loyalty. Again, any unvarnished history of nation-states would tell us that these political communities have produced more othering than belonging. Except for anti-colonial nationalism like ours, the sense of we-ness has usually been produced by inventing an enemy within or at the cost of hatred for neighbours. In this century, nationalism has become synonymous with chauvinism and jingoism, if not blood-thirsty supremacy.

Europe’s past and America’s present have ceased to throw light upon our future. Western modernity is stale. Yet we dress it up daily to serve to our children



TAHIR MAHMOOD

A PROMINENT politician speaking recently to students in Pune has reportedly referenced an oft-cited verse from a great religious treatise of ancient India: *Manusmriti*, or *Manava Dharmashastra*. Does this verse really say something derogatory about women? For over half a century I have, as a law professor, been discussing with my students — and writing in my books — on the reality of this alleged “verdict” of the so-called “classical Hindu law” on the social status of women.

Manusmriti and similar other treatises came into existence in an era when Christianity and Islam were not born, and the word “Hindu” was unknown. Branding the general law of ancient India as “Hindu law” was the handiwork of British rulers. I often wonder: If Roman law cannot be called a Christian law, how can the ancient Indian law be described as Hindu law? The fact is that it was the traditional law of ancient India, which is the inherited cultural legacy of all Indians of the present generation.

Manusmriti speaks of *dharma* (divine code of conduct for human life) and adds that man is to be guided by four different sources — the *shruti* (divine revelation in divine language heard by sages of antiquity), *smriti* (the same transmitted by them from memory in human language), *sa-dachara* (practices of divinely in-

Whatever Manusmriti says must have been in accordance with contemporary civilisation. The authors could not have meant that what was being said had to be literally followed in all ages to come

Don’t read Manusmriti through colonial lens

spired seers), and *atmanastushti* (what modern jurisprudence calls “good conscience”). The four holy Vedas are *shruti*, and *Manusmriti* was the first in the galaxy of a large number of *smritis*.

Coming to *Manusmriti*’s verse on women under reference, how many of us can understand, or even accurately read, its original wording? It is a shame that whatever we, Indians of the present age, know about our ancient law is through English translations by foreign writers centuries ago. Our knowledge of *Manusmriti* rests on William Jones’s translation of 1794. Let us check the original words of the verse: *Pita rakshati kaumare bharta rakshati yauvane/Rakshanti shavire putra na stri swatantrayamarhati*.

This verse uses derivatives of the word “*raksha*” thrice — who in India does not know what *raksha* means? According to all dictionaries, it simply means protection and safety. So by *Manusmriti*’s command, a woman’s father, husband, and son are charged with the sacred obligation of ensuring her “protection” and “safety” at different stages of her life. Was this a verdict on women’s inferior status, as the foreign translators of our sacred texts have claimed? They chose to mechanically translate the Sanskrit expression *swatantrayamarhati* as “undeserving” or “unfit” for independence. Sanskrit is an extremely rich

all knowledge must follow. This format insists that any claim to knowledge must be objective, value-free, replicable and validated. Technological success serves as the proof of truth. This regime of science, the new religion of our age, has bifurcated human knowledge into domains that have registered hitherto unknown advances and domains where existing knowledges have been erased or downgraded. The narrowing of the human mind, its fragmentation into technical domains of expertise and Western intellectual hegemony are the inevitable consequences of this knowledge regime.

And finally, we must mention the human quest for happiness, for inner peace. Institutionalised religion is not a modern invention. But the “secular age” inaugurated and universalised by Western modernity has transformed the nature of all religions. For most parts of the world, it has not meant the decline of religion but a more conscious enumeration and demarcation of religious communities and their mutual competition. This has also resulted in the rise of commodified and fundamentalist expressions of religion. You can argue that modern humans are materially better off and more knowledgeable than before but it would be hard to claim that they are happier than their predecessors.

The word *bhuta* has a third meaning that refers to the basic elements of the universe. Hindu religious texts identify five such *maha-bhutas*: Earth, air, water, fire and sky. The 21st century invites us to identify five such basic elements of human nature: Self-rule, belonging, well-being, truth and happiness. And it offers us an opportunity to redesign fresh institutional templates to respond to these five elementary quests. Such a redesigning need not begin in thin air. Templates of Western modernity that have dominated for long now face an atrophy, thus offering us an opening. Many older forms in the rest of the world have survived and can still germinate. And we have seen the rise of innovative hybrids across the world. If we have the confidence to think beyond Western modernity, we could turn the 21st century into a *bhuta-kaala* in the best sense of the term.

The writer is member, Swaraj India, and national convenor, Bharat Jodo Abhiyaan. Views are personal

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Himalayan paradox

THE HIMALAYAN region faces a paradox: Development is essential for livelihoods, yet infrastructure expansion in fragile terrain accelerates environmental collapse (‘As glaciers melt, prepare for Himalayan challenge’, *IE*, August 31). Infrastructure projects must undergo rigorous environmental assessment. Equally important is continuous cross-border glacier monitoring and data sharing between India, Nepal and China.

K Chidanand Kumar, Bengaluru

Prioritise equality

THE DEBATE on OBCs should move beyond political labels and focus on unequal access to education, jobs and opportunity (‘On OBCs, the way forward is to shift the frame’, *IE*, August 31). A uniform approach may overlook differences within the category. Socio-economic data can help identify disadvantaged groups and design targeted measures. Creamy-layer provisions and periodic reviews should be applied fairly and transparently. The objective should be substantive equality, not numerical representation. Evidence-based policy can make affirmative action credible.

S P Suganya Devi, Coimbatore

PM in Tashkent

THE RECENT discussions between India and Uzbekistan (‘Delhi & Tashkent discuss long-term uranium supply to India, upgrade relations’, *IE*, August 31) are a welcome and timely step towards strengthening the friendship between the two countries. The proposed long-term uranium supply agreement is important for India’s energy needs, while the \$5 billion trade target by 2030 shows both sides’ confidence in growing economic ties. It is equally encouraging that the two countries are expanding cooperation in defence, agriculture, education, healthcare, technology and critical minerals. Such wide-ranging discussions can bring real benefits to both nations and their people.

Ansh Dubey, IIMC



TRISHA MUKHERJEE

I FIRST encountered Yayoi Kusama’s famous yellow, polka-dotted pumpkin in 2018 in Hong Kong. Installed at the Harbour Arts Sculpture Park, it looked out over Victoria Harbour. It was a windy afternoon and I wondered: If a freak tide were to sweep the area, would Kusama’s pumpkin sink or float?

A few years later, I found the answer to my question at her retrospective, “Yayoi Kusama: 1945 to Now” at the M+ Museum: Kusama’s pumpkin would always stay afloat. It brought together nearly eight decades of her practice. But I found myself drawn to two works, which have since shaped my view of

Yayoi Kusama, an artist of self-obliteration

Kusama — the woman and the artist.

The first was ‘Self-obliteration’. Unmissable in its breadth and multiplicity of elements, it features six female mannequins, standing around a dining table, in conversation. It would have been an ordinary social scene had it not been for the hypnotic, grid-like pattern covering every single surface in the installation — the mannequins, the table and the mugs, plates, pitcher, ashtray, plastic plants, flowers and fruit on it, the chairs and the handbag hanging from one of them. Everything was painted in different colours and then covered with the same pattern, blurring their individualities. Kusama began exploring this pattern, which she called the infinity net, in the late 1950s, when she moved from Japan to New York. She suffered abuse as a child and began hallucinating

from the age of 10. She described the repetitive, almost obsessive act of making the infinity net as a way of coping with her visions.

The other work was a child-like self-portrait. Essentially an outline of a face, it sported Kusama’s signature blunt bob, two circles for eyes, an inverted T for a nose and an oval, distorted to resemble lips. The palette was bright: Yellow, red, green, pink.

There were other self-portraits too. More defined, more refined, an apt reflection of

Even as Kusama was finding her own voice, her practice was never about asserting the self. She was aware of the smallness of her existence

the skills of an artist of Kusama’s stature. In them, you could see Kusama. But in the first one, you had to find her, almost become her, because that is what she was doing when she arrived on the New York art scene dominated by “hyper-masculine” abstract expressionists like Jackson Pollock and Willem de Kooning. Against their high-octane practices, her nets and dots were meditative.

But even as Kusama was finding her own voice, her practice was never about asserting the self. She was aware of the smallness of her existence. After moving back to Japan, she voluntarily lived in a psychiatric hospital, leaving each day for her studio to paint before returning. On multiple occasions, she spoke of forgetting oneself, that her life was a “dot lost amongst thousands of other dots”. I had become a fan. So imagine my ex-

citement when her ‘Infinity Mirrored Room’ came to NMACC in Mumbai and I was in town. But the tickets were sold out. My social media, though, has since been full of selfies from NMACC, the irony becoming clearer with each post: People indulging in hyper-individualism against an artwork about dissolving the self.

As if to manifest my intrusive thought, in 2021, Typhoon Lupit swept away Kusama’s pumpkin sculpture on Japan’s Naoshima island. The pumpkin didn’t sink. It floated with the tide before it was recovered. Perhaps Kusama understood what we have forgotten: Staying afloat doesn’t always mean holding on too tight. Often, it means quiet surrender.

The writer is associate editor, The Indian Express. trisha.mukherjee@expressindia.com

Framed in the light of Jantar Mantar, Congress & BJP



VANDITA MISHRA

IF THE students’ movement is important for the light it throws on others and the silences it breaks long after its full-throated voice has faded — if “Gen Z” is not merely shorthand for a new player of the old game — the question is: What has it made more visible, what looks clearer after Jantar Mantar, even if just a bit? From this vantage point, take a look at the BJP and Congress, the ruling party and its main Opposition, as they face the people, and as they go about their inner lives.

The BJP is in its third term at the Centre, staleness is creeping in. There is restlessness, even among the believers. A journey through poll-bound Uttar Pradesh in June, as the Jantar Mantar agitation was taking off in Delhi, turned up signposts of a sputtering Yogi-Modi double engine, and of the paper leaks issue gathering other discontents around it.

The issues are not new — price rise and corruption, education and jobs. But a faraway war has given the first a sharper edge, and the students’ upsurge frames the last two more starkly. Education and jobs present a twin challenge that defies the poll-eve quickfix. On education, the BJP’s choices over 12 years are returning to haunt — despite the boasts of the National Education Policy, it has focused, to the exclusion of all else, on conquering institutions and advancing ideological projects.

Voices can also now be heard against the pall of fear that has made speaking up against the government costly, and the wielding of “bulldozer justice” by BJP state governments against a voiceless minority, copying the template set in UP. Add to that the “*chanda chori*” controversy at the Ram temple in Ayodhya that sings the BJP-RSS intimately, and the reopening of the caste question by anti-reservationists and the backlash against the UGC regulations on discrimination — the BJP seems back on the ledge on Mandal, and newly defensive on Mandir.

The party that faces these vulnerabilities bristles with rising resentments within. The tight Modi-Shah grip at the centre means that discontents are not voiced openly, at least not in Delhi, but down the line, the cracks are showing.

The Bihar BJP leaders’ glee at their own party’s rout in Bankipur pointed to unease with the appointment of Samrat Choudhary. Choudhary’s elevation as chief minister is part of a pattern of uninspiring state-level promotions and appointments by a high command that wants to retain control, above all. Or take the rumblings in the BJP’s West Bengal unit about opening the door too wide, letting the defeated opponent in. The spectre of “*Trinamoolification*”, after a mandate that was more against the TMC than for the BJP, is made worse by the absence of state-level leadership that could manage the friction between old and new.

Murmurs can also be heard in the BJP’s upper echelons against the increasing outsourcing of decision-making to professional political consultancies. A party that has prided itself on its sprawl of committed *karyakartas* and its perfectly oiled machine is being presented to do lists and perception indexes by the omnipresent external agencies.

On the other side of the political fence, it is now being said that Rahul Gandhi is pulling ahead of his own party. The journey through UP also showed that voters acknowledge, more than before, that Gandhi raises resonant issues, persists in taking the fight to the BJP. But Gandhi’s outreach to the young, or his *dharma* outside the PM’s residence, or his sit-in at a police station to force an FIR over a student’s spelt injuries — all frame the leader without the party. The latter two events showed the leader taking his party by surprise. Like his two cross-country yatras, they frame Gandhi’s breakthrough, while pointing to a Congress standstill.

The Bharat Jodo yatras helped Gandhi climb out of the corner he had been backed into by the BJP’s propaganda machine and by his own lack of a strong politics/government CV. But Gandhi seems to be making his way forward without carrying his party with him. This is not just because Congress, out of power for long, is burdened with inertia and slowed down by factional infighting. It is also because of Gandhi’s scepticism towards his party.

There are images of this distrust. Of the *yatris* who flocked to Gandhi from civil society, marched alongside him during his two yatras, only a handful were later inducted in Congress, little effort was made to create room for them in the party. The coterie that surrounds Gandhi is made of those who did not come up with him. This is not just because Congress, out of power for long, is burdened with inertia and slowed down by factional infighting. It is also because of Gandhi’s scepticism towards his party.

Gandhi may have decided to take the plunge alone, until the party he owns becomes the party of his dreams. But by not working through it, by distrusting its processes, he is complicit in leaving its crises unattended. The toll is visible in the poll-bound states of Punjab and UP. The Uttar Pradesh Congress Committee, dissolved in 2024 to jumpstart an overhaul, is still to be reconstituted. In Punjab, the party is divided into jostling camps that don’t meet.

In the aftermath of the students’ movement, then, are two parties, which did not expect the sudden shaft of light on them, and still seem blinded by it. They need to find their bearings, and a way forward. That is their test, after Jantar Mantar.

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If there are questions of current or contemporary relevance that you would like explained, please write to explained@indianexpress.com

• POLICY

Will ‘talking’ cars reduce road accident deaths?

Dheeraj Mishra
New Delhi, August 31

THE UNION Ministry of Road Transport and Highways will soon mandate its new road-safety intervention, the Vehicle-to-Vehicle (V2V) communication system, through which cars will essentially talk with each other wirelessly to warn drivers about upcoming accident risks.

In the draft Central Motor Vehicles (Amendment) Rules, 2026, published on July 22, the Ministry had sought objections and suggestions from the public on the V2V system within 30 days.

Proposed rules

The draft Rules propose mandating the minimum technical and safety features for V2V-fitted vehicles before they are rolled out on roads, besides setting a deadline for manufacturers to install the system.

Vehicles such as two- and three-wheelers, cars, buses, and goods vehicles manufactured on or after October 1, 2027, will be required to comply with Automotive Industry Standard-230 (AIS-230), if fitted with a V2V system. Such vehicles, manufactured on or after October 1, 2028, will be required to be fitted with V2V, meeting AIS-230 specifications.

AIS-230 is a technical backbone for the V2V system, which specifies a list of requirements and provides for phased introduction of other safety features.

• AERIAL PARALLELS

The V2V system is somewhat similar to technology used in aviation, where aircraft broadcast their position, speed, and altitude — and the nearby aircraft and ground station receive it.

While this system is now common in the aviation sector globally, the road sector is still evolving.

changes, obstacles like parked vehicles on roadsides, fog or any potential collision risk. For instance, if a car applies brakes suddenly, the nearby vehicles will get an alert to slow down before seeing it. Usually, V2V systems have a range of 300 metres and can detect vehicles in this range.

Officials said that OBUs will cost Rs 5,000 to Rs 7,000. This will be first installed in new vehicles.

The traditional safety features — such as the camera-based advanced driver assistance systems — depend on the line of sight of a driver, that is, how far one can see the road. The V2V system, however, works beyond the line of sight such as blind corners or behind large trucks, and it alerts the driver by establishing contact with other vehicles. So, it is expected to complement ADAS and predict forward collision risk. The vehicles will continuously exchange real-time data including speed, position, direction, and acceleration.

So far, V2V is working in a few countries such as the US.

Privacy concern

Since the V2V system will store a large amount of data about the vehicles, there is a potential risk of it being susceptible to cyber attacks.

It is unclear whether the allocated frequency band will support all vehicles. Also, miscommunication might lead to crashes.

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• NEPAL DISASTER

Himalayas’ hanging glacier threat

There are around 219 hanging glaciers in the Alaknanda basin of the Garhwal Himalayas. Better monitoring and preparedness are needed

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ANIL SASI

Nepalese soldiers recover bodies of flash flood victims from a river in Chitwan, Nepal, on Monday. AP

THE DEVASTATING flooding in Nepal has similarities with at least four major incidents in India over the last decade-and-a-half, each involving a sudden release of a large volume of water in the mountainous rivers.

But there are more warning bells for India. As rising temperatures and shifting regional precipitation patterns reduce the stability of the Himalayan glaciers, some of them could evolve into “hanging glaciers” — ice masses perched on steep slopes that can detach and trigger massive avalanches.

An April study published in *Nature* has found that there are as many as 219 hanging glaciers in the Alaknanda basin of the Garhwal Himalayas. Nearly a third of this unstable ice, according to the study, is concentrated in the Upper Alaknanda basin.

Formation

The study — by Ashim Sattar of the School of Earth, Ocean and Climate Sciences, Indian Institute of Technology, Bhubaneswar, and Nandu Krishnan of the Divecha Centre for Climate Change, Indian Institute of Science, Bengaluru, with two colleagues — flagged that Himalayan glaciers are increasingly exhibiting “geometric and dynamic instability” owing to rapid warming and climate variability.

Unstable glaciers are essentially those whose velocity may change by an order of magnitude and more during a comparatively short period of time. The result is redistribution of ice, accompanied by geometric and structural-and-tectonic shifts.

This instability then leads to the development of hanging glaciers on steep slopes. While these glaciers have been extensively studied in the Alps, basin-scale assessments in the Himalayas remain limited.

Prospect of breaking off

Hanging glaciers pose a significant risk of break-offs. The study’s simulations indicated that the resultant avalanche flows could exceed 50 metres in height in Uttarakhand’s Badrinath-Mana sector. Such a severe event would swallow major settlements and infrastructure.

The break-offs from hanging glaciers can also trigger secondary hazards such as glacial lake outburst floods.

The study identified a total of 219 hanging glaciers in the Alaknanda basin of the Garhwal Himalayas, covering 71.7 ± 3.5 sq km, with an estimated ice volume of 2.39 ± 0.42 km³, including 0.74 ± 0.14 km³ of hanging ice mass.

Hanging fire

Unstable glaciers are essentially those whose velocity may change by an order of magnitude and more during a comparatively short period of time.

The result is redistribution of ice, accompanied by geometric and structural-and-tectonic shifts.

This instability then leads to the development of hanging glaciers on steep slopes.

Growing risk

Exposure to avalanche-related risks in this basin is projected to increase over the next decade, with 120% more buildings and infrastructure land area at risk by 2030 compared with 2000, said the study. The number of people living in these at-risk areas is projected to surge by 17%. This underscores the need for systematic identification and monitoring of high-risk glaciers, alongside risk-informed land-use planning, to reduce downstream hazards in mountain regions.

“This study... sadly predicted the tragic events (and)... underscores the need to monitor such ‘hanging glaciers’ closely to give better warning of such catastrophes... This will require much greater funding of monitoring programs; but such funding is small compared to the costs of loss of life and livelihoods,” Pam Pearson, Director of International Cryosphere Climate Initiative, told *The Indian Express*.

“This should also, however, prove a wake-up call that we really must accept that the era of fossil fuel use needs to end, and transition to carbon-free energy sources, on an emergency basis. Here again, the economic costs of such a transition will be far less than the cost of continued use, in terms of such disasters alongside other economic burdens from drought (in part from lesser snowpack) and heatwaves,” said Pearson.

Preparing for calamity

Another relevant study, published in *Nature* on March 6, made an interesting point of preparedness in the event of a calamity in the warming Himalayas.

The study, by Anshuman Bhardwaj, Rayees Ahmed and two other colleagues, compared two events. The first was the 2021 Chamoli disaster that saw a massive wall of ice and rock collapse into the Rishiganga valley. The event destroyed hydropower plants, swept away bridges and killed over 200 people. Four years later, a large ice-rock avalanche buried most of the village of Blatten in Switzerland. Only one person died.

The difference between catastrophe and survival, the study said, “was not luck, but preparedness, monitoring, and rapid response”. In Blatten, authorities and residents acted on precursory signs of slope instability, enabling timely evacuation.

Bhardwaj, Head of Department (Planetary Sciences) at the School of Geosciences, University of Aberdeen, told *The Indian Express*: “The Nepal event highlights that we need to think of these as cascading hazards, rather than isolated landslides, avalanches, or floods... Second, we need to strengthen anticipatory monitoring and preparedness... Third, this is also a transboundary risk-management issue... Finally, we should be careful not to rush process attribution while responding to the immediate emergency.”

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Lessons India, China, and Nepal must learn



EXPERT EXPLAINS
MAHENDRA P LAMA

HONORARY SENIOR ADVISER
AT ICIMOD, KATHMANDU

THE DEVASTATING flood in the Bhotokoshi and Trishuli rivers in Nepal’s thinly populated (48,000) Rasuwa district has killed hundreds and destroyed the region’s traditional villages, urban settlements, tourist spots, trade routes, social infrastructure, roads, bridges and hydel power projects. This has triggered four debates across the fragile Himalayan region.

Borderland management

First, the border as a geometric line — whose breach by another sovereign nation is considered the uppermost national security concern — is not respected by natural disasters. Amid speculation over the Nepal deluge’s origin, scientists and glaciologists have confirmed that the flood was caused by an avalanche and glacial collapse on the Chinese-controlled side of the glaciers near Langtang Lirung.

Nation states can no longer afford dependence-generating diplomacy in terms of sharing information and expertise. Interdependence — in data sharing, joint studies, institutional collaboration, non-sovereignty-centric treatment of climate change impact, and a close inter-governmental early warning framework — has become central.

Translating science into simple public goods for awareness; retraining border defence personnel for changing security threats; ensuring human security in these far-flung terrains; and drawing on traditional knowledge in operations have all acquired new urgency.

Trans-border energy stakes

Second, the flood’s damage to over 15 hydro projects along the Trishuli, and the downstream exposure it triggered, could cause huge national-to-transborder environmental damage. Cascading effects within Nepal, China and India, and further downstream in Bangladesh could disrupt cross-border energy trading and regional power pools, causing energy insecurity.

India’s Central Water and Power Commission took the initiative in 1953 to build the first hydel project on the Trishuli. An agreement was signed in 1958, and this 21 MW run-of-the-river project was commissioned in the sleepy mountain village of Tuphe, 6.4 km upstream from Trishuli Bazar, in June 1972 at a cost of Rs 13.55 crore. It long supplied power to Kathmandu. The project now remains largely decimated.

Many China-built highways to Kathmandu run through river belts. The first — a 115-km highway between Kathmandu and Kodari in Tibet, built in 1967 — runs through the Sunkoshi valley, both for strategic reasons and easy access to sand and boulders. Huge settlements have since sprung up as ribbon development along these highways. This flood and others have pushed donors for big infra projects to rethink their strategies.

Disconnect in response

Third, the Rasuwagadhi flood surfaced a formidable local-versus-national dynamic. The impact falls at a very local level, where the area’s residents are both first victims and first responders — while

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Satellite photos by Planet Labs PBC show part of the Langtang Lirung glacier area along the Nepal-Tibet border on August 25 (top) and August 26 (above). AP

the response comes from distant, capital-centric institutions in Kathmandu.

Similar examples exist in India. In October 2023, massive calving from the South Lhonak glacier’s snout triggered a glacial lake outburst flood in North Sikkim; within hours, the Teesta rose 15-20 metres. Downstream townships in Sikkim, West Bengal and Bangladesh were buried in slush and debris. Damage was estimated at over Rs 25,000 crore — nearly 60% of Sikkim’s 2022-23 GDP. The loss of 1,800 MW of generation alone cost over Rs 19,000 crore. Though the state’s Chief Minister led the disaster response with National and State Disaster Management teams, the devastation exposed several critical gaps in climate impact management.

Local institutions lacked training, technique and orientation, and their coping mechanisms had little resilience. Municipalities and panchayats stood helpless before the scale of destruction, without training, awareness, preparedness or means to cope. No early warning mechanism existed, and no agency was responsible for one. This underscored the need to base national institutions and resources at the local level.

Common climate policy

Fourth, the Himalayan region lacks a robust climate policy framework spanning local, national and regional levels.

The International Centre for Integrated Mountain Development (ICIMOD), based in Kathmandu, has published evidence-based reports warning of tipping points in the region’s deteriorating glaciology. India has a National and State Action Plan on Climate Change and eight sectoral missions, including one for the Himalayas. The SAARC Convention on Cooperation on Environment was signed and took effect in 2013. These scattered approaches must be brought onto a common platform.

• GLOBAL

Why the US, world’s top oil producer, wants to control Venezuela’s crude

Sukalp Sharma
New Delhi, August 31

THE US says it will gain majority control over more than 65 billion barrels of Venezuelan oil — or 20% of its proven oil reserves — under an agreement with the South American country.

US President Donald Trump said this “biggest oil deal in world history” will be implemented through a partnership involving private companies “at no cost to the American taxpayer”.

Venezuela has the world’s largest proven oil reserves, estimated at about 300 billion barrels, but produces and sells only about 1% of the crude the world is using. After the US captured Venezuela’s President Nicolás Maduro in January, Trump declared that Washington would take control of the country’s oil sector and that American majors would invest billions of dollars to revive it.

Now, his announcement represents an ambitious attempt to combine American capital and technology with Venezuela’s

massive but dilapidated oil production infrastructure. The deal could mark the beginning of a reorientation of Venezuela towards the US.

Globally, the US is the largest oil producer and also a top exporter. So, why does it want to have a high degree of control of Venezuelan crude?

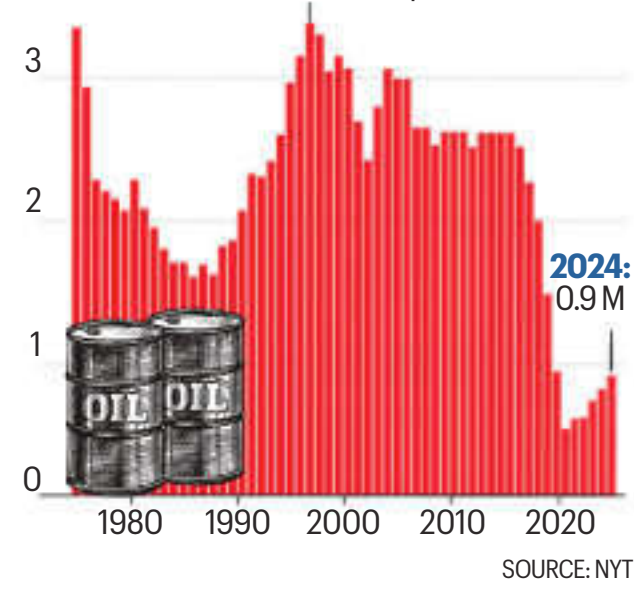
Some reasons are self-evident — energy market dominance, reducing international oil prices amid the Strait of Hormuz crisis, and building up reserves. But a key reason is the very nature of Venezuelan oil — highly viscous, sticky, and “sour”.

Big announcement, few details

At this stage, the precise legal and commercial structure of the US-Venezuela agreement remains unclear. Some reports suggest the deal would likely involve a new private company jointly owned by US interests and an operator, with the US side holding a 55% operational share. The company would develop 17 oil fields, while US buyers would purchase oil at cost. The Venezuelan govern-

• Venezuela’s oil production

(in million barrels per day or bpd)
1997: 3.5 million bpd



ment, meanwhile, has put the potential economic impact at roughly \$100 billion in private investment and more than \$209 billion in tax revenues.

Venezuela has historically maintained strong state control over its oil industry. A deal giving foreign companies significant ownership or operational control of its oil producing assets could become politically contentious.

Moreover, there are questions over whether Venezuela’s interim administration has the authority to commit to long-term oil agreements. Reports indicate that opposition leaders in Venezuela are already up in arms against any deal giving control to American companies.

The legal structure of the new agreement will, therefore, be crucial.

Why US wants Venezuelan oil

Crude oil is not exactly a fungible commodity in practice because of the differences in quality of various types or grades of oil. And which type of crude is likely to be easily available in adequate volumes is a key factor in refinery configurations.

A key reason for US interest is the grade of Venezuela’s oil, the bulk of which is clas-

sified as “heavy sour” crude: “heavy” because it is thicker and denser than the lighter crude oil grades, and “sour” because of its high sulphur content.

By contrast, the majority of US oil production is “light” and “sweet”, denoting low viscosity and sulphur content. But much of the American refining infrastructure — particularly the US Gulf Coast refineries — were specifically engineered to process heavy crudes from Latin America and Canada.

The US is also not on the best of terms with other countries that have significant heavy crude reserves, such as Iran and Russia. So, the US still has to import heavy sour crudes to feed these refineries, even as it exports massive volumes of its own “light sweet” oil.

There are also geopolitical considerations. The Trump administration wants a reliable and nearby supply source after its war on Iran prompted Tehran to choke oil supplies through the Strait of Hormuz — the narrow waterway that used to see a fifth

of the world’s energy flows in peacetime.

The challenges

Notwithstanding Trump’s highly optimistic outlook for Venezuela’s oil industry, scaling up production again will be no mean task. Norway-based energy research and intelligence firm Rystad Energy had estimated in January that Venezuelan oil production can return to late 1990s levels by 2040 if the new investment cycle starts as early as 2026. For this to happen, over \$180 billion would have to be invested over the next 15 years.

With US sanctions on Venezuela greatly constraining the flow of Venezuelan crude in the international oil market, China became its leading destination. Over the past couple of decades, both China and Russia have invested heavily in the Venezuelan petroleum industry.

Now, the outlook for these investments is uncertain. In that context, Trump’s declaration can also be seen as Washington’s attempt to cut Chinese and Russian influence in the Americas.

CENTRE NOTIFIES FRAMEWORK FOR SEMICON 2.0 PROGRAMME

Domestic chip design to receive a boost with Rs 1.27 lakh cr push

Soumyarendra Barik
New Delhi, August 31

THE CENTRE on Monday notified the operational framework for its Rs 1.27 lakh crore Semicon 2.0 programme, putting the design of Indian chips and intellectual property at the front of an expanded semiconductor strategy that will also subsidise manufacturing equipment, raw materials, fabrication plants and advanced chip packaging.

The new mission, approved by the Union Cabinet in July, divides government support into six pillars, with at least three being entirely devoted to chip design. Incentives are being offered for designing chips needed for strategic purposes, for the commercial market, for domestically developed chips deployed at scale.

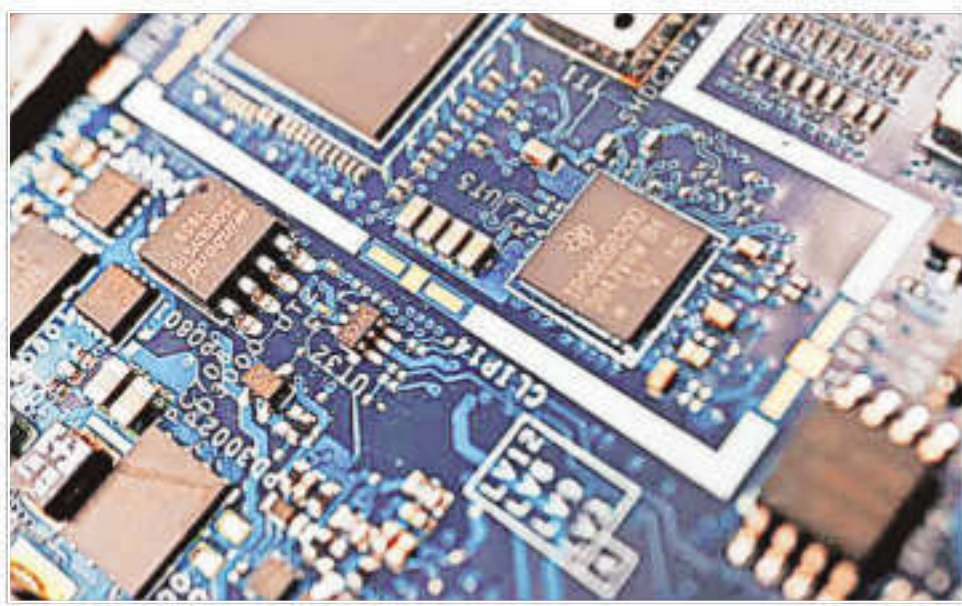
For chips meant for areas of national importance and critical infrastructure, the government will identify technologies and building blocks, including intellectual property (IP) for compute, memory, radio fre-

quency, power, networking and sensors, that it wants developed in India. Indian-owned and controlled companies can participate independently or with global companies, research organisations and academic institutions.

The Centre for Development of Advanced Computing (C-DAC), under the IT Ministry, will issue requests for proposals and select developers through competitive bidding. The IP created under these projects will be jointly owned by the company and C-DAC.

A second design track is aimed at building commercially viable Indian fabless chip companies. The scheme will provide eligible firms access to electronic design automation (EDA) tools, multi-project wafer fabrication, IP cores, compute sub-systems and post-silicon validation.

Start-ups and MSMEs designing commercial chips can receive seed funding of up to Rs 15 crore, or 50% of project cost, whichever is lower. The government can also make equity co-



The new mission divides government support into six pillars, with at least three being entirely devoted to chip design. REUTERS

Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RG9mljMzg1 they are owned and controlled by Indian citizens or Overseas Citizens of India (OCIs), provided they also have a significant operational and manpower presence in the country.

"I was also glad to see that the scheme has this time been opened up to OCIs companies owned by Overseas Citizens of India which is a very good decision, since they bring rich global experience that will

help create truly advanced design companies in India," said Arjun Malhotra, co-founder of HCL and chairperson of EPIC Foundation.

Beyond design, the scheme also attempts to build the largely imported upstream supply chain needed to operate semiconductor factories. Companies setting up R&D facilities for semiconductor equipment, plants making semiconductor-grade wafers, photomasks, photoresists, substrates, chemicals and gases, testing facilities, or units producing semiconductor equipment and components can receive capital expenditure support of 30%.

Equipment manufacturers will additionally get a declining production-linked incentive: 10%, 8%, 6%, 4%, and 2% over five years beginning FY 2028-29, on the value of their bill of materials sourced from domestic manufacturers. The combined support will be capped at 50% of eligible capital expenditure.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

FIIs pump \$3.1 bn into Indian stocks in August, highest in nearly 2 years

Akash Mandal
Mumbai, August 31

FOREIGN INVESTORS bought Indian equities worth \$3.1 billion in August, the highest monthly inflow since they bought shares worth \$6.9 billion in September 2024. This was the second straight month of foreign buying after a four-month selloff.

The renewed interest, following \$2.1 billion of foreign investment in Indian equities in July, has been driven by reasonable valuations, better-than-expected earnings for the April-June quarter, relatively stable macroeconomic conditions and a shift away from AI-heavy markets in recent months.

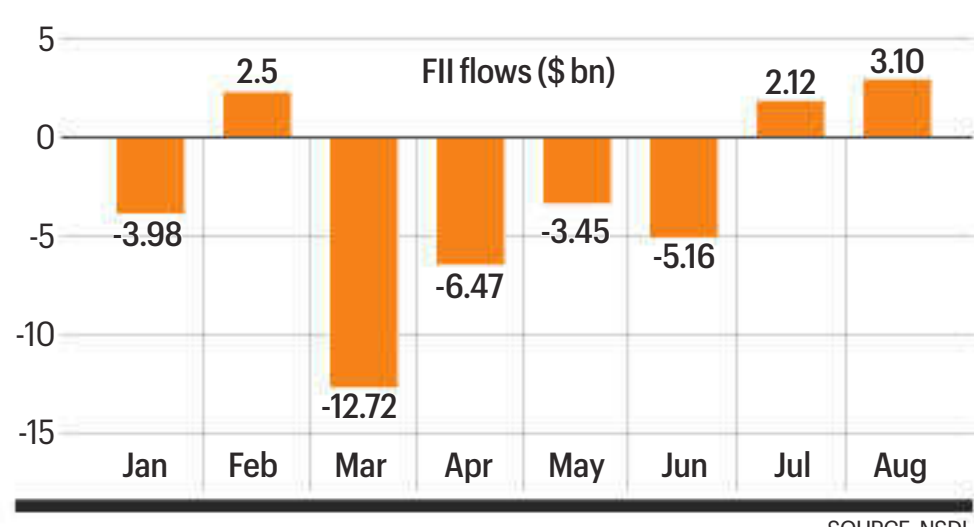
Reasonable valuations in the Indian stock market are among the biggest drivers of the revival, especially after one of the worst four-month stretches in years, when foreign investors sold Indian equities worth \$27.8 billion between March and June. The benchmark Nifty 50 and Sensex had declined around 5% during that period, weighed down by the conflict in West Asia and the AI-led rally in global markets.

In comparison, both indices are up around 1% since July. Broader mid- and small-cap indices have also gained 5-6% over the same period, suggesting that investors are finding opportunities across a wider range of the market.

These reasonable valuations, coupled with higher-than-expected earnings growth in Q1FY27, have provided foreign investors with an opportunity to buy Indian equities even as they continued selling stocks in the AI-heavy South Korean market through August.

The Reserve Bank of India also kept the key interest rate steady earlier this month, even as the minutes indicated rate

● FII flows have improved in recent months



SOURCE: NSDL

hikes going ahead as inflation is expected to rise over FY27.

While a rate hike by itself is not necessarily a positive or negative reason, the prolonged pause eases uncertainty at a time when valuations in several pockets of the Indian market are reasonable after months of continuous selling.

"Foreign investors turned buyers in August largely because the RBI kept policy stable while valuations had already absorbed months of selling pressure," noted a report from Maxiom Wealth last week.

A rate hike in itself is not a positive catalyst for foreign investors, but it can ease uncertainty at a time when valuations in several pockets of the Indian market have become more reasonable after months of sustained selling.

Financial services, auto among FIIs' top picks

The financial services sector attracted the strongest interest, with FIIs buying \$685 million worth of shares in the sector during the first half of August, according to data from the National Securities Depository Limited. The automobile sector saw an inflow of \$462 million during the period. Consumer services, healthcare and IT also

saw robust inflows of between \$200 million and \$400 million. Barring financial services, all these sectors had recorded positive inflows in the previous 15 days.

While data for the second half of the month has not yet been released, most of these sectors have continued to perform well. Healthcare gained around 1.2% in August, while IT and auto rose up to 1%. Financial services gained as much as 1.6% in early August before giving up some of those gains.

Despite the strong revival over the past two months, most market experts see the buying as temporary and opportunistic rather than the beginning of a structural revival. Foreign inflows are therefore expected to remain volatile and dependent on factors such as crude oil prices, geopolitical stability and taxation.

"It is not a structural reversal, as buying value is insignificant compared to their selling in the last 2 years...structural buying can happen if peace prevails in West Asia, and therefore, oil prices fall more than 20% from current levels," said G Chokkalingam, founder of Equinimix Research.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Industry and services sectors show 20%-plus credit offtake growth

George Mathew
Mumbai, August 31

BANK CREDIT growth accelerated sharply across major sectors as of July 2026, with non-food bank credit expanding 19.1% year-on-year to Rs 219.60 lakh crore, nearly doubling from the 9.9% growth recorded during the corresponding period a year ago, according to data released by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) on Monday. Industry and services sectors which showed 20% plus growth in credit offtake led the surge.

Credit to industry emerged as one of the key drivers of the expansion, growing 20% year-on-year as of July 31, compared with just 6.5% during the corresponding fortnight of the previous year. While large industry segment showed a 17.7% growth in credit offtake to Rs 32.28 lakh crore as against 1.6% a year ago, medium segment reported a growth of 30.5% (15.0% last year)

Rs 4.79 lakh crore. Micro and small segment registered 22.6% (20.9%) to Rs 10.92 lakh crore, according to RBI data. The sharp acceleration points to a broad-based strengthening in credit demand, with industry, services, agriculture and personal loans all registering faster growth than a year earlier.

Within industry, credit growth to both large and medium industries accelerated, while lending to micro and small industries maintained steady growth. The increase was spread across several major industrial segments. Infrastructure recorded buoyant credit growth, while lending to basic metals and metal products, engineering, chemicals and chemical products, petroleum and coal products and nuclear fuels, and textiles also registered strong year-on-year expansion.

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Happiest Minds to merge with ITC Infotech in 22% stake deal

George Mathew
Mumbai, August 31

HAPPIEST MINDS Technologies Ltd has signed definitive agreements to combine its business with ITC Infotech India Ltd, creating a scaled, AI-first global technology services enterprise with \$1 billion in annual revenue by FY28.

As part of the transaction, ITC Infotech, a subsidiary of ITC Ltd, will acquire an aggregate minority stake of 22.1% in Happiest Minds from the promoter and promoter entities across two tranches for a total consideration of Rs 1,330 crore, at an average price of Rs 395 per share. Further, the proposed merger will be effected through

a share swap, pursuant to which equity shareholders of Happiest Minds will receive 25 shares of ITC Infotech for every 81 shares of Happiest Minds held by them.

ITC Ltd will be the promoter of the merged company, with a 73.4% stake.

The new entity will have over 19,000 employees, serve 800 customers and have operations across several countries. The proposed combination brings together two highly complementary organisations with shared values, strong people-centric cultures, and a common vision of helping enterprises accelerate AI-led transformation, Happiest Minds said in an exchange filing.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Reasons why GDP growth overshoot expectations, and what lies ahead

Aanchal Magazine & Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, August 31

OFFERING A sliver of hope amid the uncertain global environment marred by the prolonged West Asia war, the Indian economy exhibited continued resilience by posting a real GDP growth rate of 7.8% in April-June.

While agricultural growth remained subdued, manufacturing and services expanded robustly to push growth beyond the 7% estimated by the Reserve Bank of India. A sharp surge of nearly 12% in investments was another key driver, while private consumption remained firm.

Key factors at work

Manufacturing and services: While manufacturing grew 9.2%, up from 8.3% a year ago, services expanded 10% as against 8%. Agriculture posted a modest growth of 3.6%, down from 4.4% last year, although Chief Economic Advisor V Anantha Nageswaran said the sector had fared better than what was expected in June when the monsoon shortfall was high.

Demand push: Private Final Consumption Expenditure was up 7.1% versus a growth of 6.8% last year. According to the CEA, the proxies of urban and rural demand have performed well in the last three months. Rural income-oriented policy measures such as PM Kisan, higher minimum support prices, and ensuring fertiliser affordability aided rural demand, he added.

Investment activity: Gross Fixed Capital Formation — a proxy for investments — jumped 11.9%, double last year's 5.8%, in real terms. But without adjusting for inflation, it was up a massive 20.4%, taking its share in the GDP to 34.3%, well above last year's 31.4%.

Increasing the share of investment in GDP is crucial to sustaining a high growth rate, with S Mahendra Dev, Chairman of the Economic Advisory Council to the Prime Minister, having previously said investments must rise to 34-35% to sustain 7%+ growth.

Resilience and risks

The key message from the data is "resilience", according to Nageswaran. With all three

sectors — agriculture, manufacturing, and services — contributing despite the West Asia war related uncertainties, the numbers have been, by and large, better than what was expected in the backdrop of the simmering conflict.

Risks to the growth outlook, however, remain in the form of high crude oil prices, especially given the flare-ups in the war between the US and Iran. According to the government's top economist, the "lurking risk" of disruptions to supply of crude oil will likely not allow prices to decline "materially and sustainably" below \$80 per barrel.

While the government has partially shielded Indian households from higher energy prices, other countries may face a demand hit. This could dim the prospects for India's exports.

Domestically, an intensifying *El Niño* — expected to peak in late 2026 — warrants "close monitoring" given its implications for rainfall, crop outcomes, and food inflation, the Ministry of Finance said in its monthly economic review, also released Monday.

FULL REPORT ON
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ONGC plans to spend Rs 1 lakh crore on deep-sea drilling over five years

Sukalp Sharma
New Delhi, August 31

INDIA'S LARGEST oil and gas producer Oil and Natural Gas Corporation (ONGC) plans to invest about Rs 1 lakh crore over five years on exploration activities in deepwater and ultra-deepwater fields in India's offshore basins, its chairman said Monday. Even as the state-owned energy giant remains focused on its core upstream activities, it also plans to set up a crude oil and petroleum product trading unit in either Dubai or

Singapore by the end of the year.

According to ONGC Chairman and CEO Arun Kumar Singh, the upstream oil and gas major plans to drill 87 deepwater and ultra-deepwater wells till 2030-31, with the total investment required for this campaign estimated at about Rs 1 lakh crore. ONGC's plans are consistent with the government's push for boosting oil and gas exploration and production activities in Indian waters, for which it announced the Rs 84,000-crore 'Samudra Manthan' scheme, or the Na-

tional Offshore Exploration Scheme, in July.

The scheme will provide financial support for exploratory drilling in deepwater and ultra-deepwater areas and support building of common infrastructure for production of the discovered hydrocarbon, apart from funding offshore data acquisition and developing hydrocarbon manufacturing and services zones. The outlay is for implementation till financial year 2030-31.

FULL REPORT ON
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GST 2.0 gave auto sector a boost: Maruti chairman

New Delhi: The GST 2.0 gave impetus not only to the automobile industry but to several sectors of the Indian economy, which continues to do well despite the impact of the West Asia war, Maruti Suzuki India Chairman RC Bhargava said, adding the tax reform provided the necessary buffer to navigate this uncertain period.

Addressing shareholders in the company's annual general meeting, Bhargava on Monday said Maruti Suzuki India expects the Indian "car industry will grow to 6.3 million by 2031, and that the share of the small car market will grow significantly faster" than it did in the previous five years, driven by the cuts in GST rates in September last year.

"The Indian economy continues to do well, and collections of GST remain higher than ever before. This is all despite the Iran problems, the West Asia war, and such issues. I do believe that without GST reforms, we may not have done so well in the difficult months that have elapsed," Bhargava said. PTI

● BRIEFLY

Mahajan Labs, Neuberg ink pact in North India

New Delhi: Integrated diagnostic healthcare provider Mahajan Imaging & Labs on Monday said it has entered into a joint venture partnership with Neuberg Diagnostics to expand pathology and wellness services across North India. The collaboration brings together Mahajan Imaging & Labs' experience in radiology, nuclear medicine, PET CT and advanced diagnostics, with Neuberg's pathology and genomics capabilities, and clinical and operational expertise, according to a release. PTI

Hero MotoCorp expands Central America network

Mumbai: Two-wheeler maker Hero MotoCorp has expanded its presence in Central America with the launch of the company's flagship store at Calle El Progreso in collaboration with San Salvador-based automotive distributor VE-LOSA (Oriental Motors, S.A.). Besides, the collaboration also expanded its retail network with two additional outlets at Metrocentro San Salvador and Plaza Mundo Soyapango in El Salvador, Hero MotoCorp said in a statement. PTI

● MARKETS

 Sensex 76957.27 -307.24 -0.40%	 NIFTY 24,080.40 -95.25 -0.39%	 Gold ▼ ₹1,55,835	 US Dollar ▼ ₹95.17
		 Silver ▼ ₹2,37,199	 Oil ▲ \$90.53

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION DATA
GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF AUGUST 28, 2026

● NTPC'S PROFIT GROWTH HAS OUTPACED ITS REVENUE GROWTH IN THE PAST THREE YEARS, COINCIDING WITH A PERIOD WHEN INDIA SIGNIFICANTLY RAMPED UP RENEWABLE ENERGY CAPACITY ADDITION

How India's top thermal power producer is making more profits from renewables

Pratysuh Deep
New Delhi, August 31

DESPITE SURGING commodity prices, the profits of India's largest power producer, state-owned NTPC Ltd, have grown at a faster clip compared with its revenues in each of the last three years. The reason — getting paid for backing up the growing share of renewable power generation.

In its annual general meeting Thursday, NTPC chairman and managing director Gurdeep Singh attributed this to fixed charges of thermal power plants, which he said contribute to the profitability of the state-owned power oper-

ator. Fixed charges are the payments received by thermal power generators for keeping its power plants available to generate electricity, irrespective of how much power they actually produce.

This highlights a key feature of India's changing power mix: rising renewable generation can reduce thermal power generation without reducing the payments made to thermal generators. During periods of high renewable output, particularly during the day, thermal plants are required to reduce generation or operate at lower utilisation. However, generators continue to receive fixed charges as long

as the capacity remains available to the grid.

While responding to queries by shareholders, Singh said the mismatch in profit and revenue growth proportion is primarily because the company's thermal power contracts are based on plant availability rather than generation.

"We generate as per the requirement of the grid. The profit comes from fixed charges," Singh said while explaining that the company's total revenue comprises fixed charges and energy charges, which also includes fuel costs.

The state-owned power operator's income fell 0.56% to Rs 1,89,798.56 crore in 2025-26



Rising renewable generation can reduce thermal power generation without reducing the payments made to thermal generators. REUTERS

from the previous year. At the same time, however, it recorded a 15% year-on-year increase in profit after tax (PAT) to Rs 27,545.76 crore.

In fact, barring 2022-23, NTPC's profit growth has outpaced its revenue growth in each of the past three years, coinciding with a period when India

Real Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F>

significantly ramped up renewable energy capacity addition. In 2023-24, the company's total income grew 1.79% year-on-year, while profit rose 24.6%. In 2024-25, profit grew 12.29% despite a 5.35% increase in income.

For DISCOMS (distribution companies), however, the shift creates a potential cost challenge. They continue to pay capacity charges for thermal capacity regardless of how much power they actually draw from those plants. This means that a growing share of renewable energy does not necessarily eliminate the cost of maintaining thermal capacity for periods when

the grid needs it.

The rapid expansion of renewable energy is, therefore, creating a new operating requirement for India's coal-fired power fleet: plants must be able to reduce generation when renewable output is high and ramp up quickly when it falls.

A key requirement for this transition is lowering the Minimum Technical Load (MTL) — the lowest stable generation level at which a thermal unit can operate without shutting down. Lower MTL would allow coal plants to back down further during periods of high renewable generation while remaining available to meet de-

mand when required.

The Central Electricity Authority (CEA) has also outlined a phased roadmap to enable coal-fired power plants to operate at 40% MTL by 2030.

The move, however, faces resistance from the industry, which has flagged the risks of operating thermal units below 55% load, citing increased thermal and mechanical stress on equipment such as turbines.

While greater flexibility from coal plants could help accommodate more renewable energy, it does not eliminate the costs of keeping those plants available.

FULL REPORT ON
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Classifieds

PERSONAL

I, Mustak Ali S/o Abdul Hakeem R/o, C-22/A, Gali-No-2, Jagat-Puri Thana, Araya Nagar, Gulab Devi Hospital Road, Jalandhar-1, GrainMarket, Jalandhar Punjab-144008. In my service record name of my father has been wrongly mentioned as Gyan Chand instead of Gian Chand as mentioned vide affidavit dated 25th August 2026 submitted before public notary Kupwara 0020519187-1

0040875436-10

I, MEENA W/o Mahesh Kumar Soni R/o-28, Block-65, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, Delhi-05 have changed my name to MEENA DEVI SONI.

0071057820-1

I, MANPREET SINGH CHADHA, S/O- GURDEEP SINGH, R/O- HOUSE NO-21, OAK DRIVE, DLF CHATTARPUR FARMS, DELHI-110030. Have Changed the Name of My Minor Daughter's Name AHILYA KAUR CHADDA to AHILYA KAUR CHADHA, for all future Purpose.

0040875450-11

I, Pooja, D/O- Pawan Kumar, R/o- B-31, APEEJAY SCHOOL SHEIKH SARAI, KHIRKI EXTN GUPTA COLONY, Malviya Nagar, South Delhi-110017 Have changed my name to Pooja Kashyap.

0040875434-4

I, MD Fahad, S/O- Mohammad Ismail, R/O-A, 227 third floor gali no.9 village wazirabad DELHI 110084, have changed my name to Fahad for all purposes.

0040875435-9

I, Prashant Kumar S/O, Yogender Kumar Gupta R/o HNo 03 Gali No 01 Molarband Extn Badapur New Dehl 110044 have changed my name to Prashant Gupta for all purposes.

0040875327-1

I, Rihana Khan, W/o- Mohammed Ashraf, R/o- H. No. -478, Khalsa No. -368, 20-Foot Road, Gali No.-8, Kardampuri, Delhi-110094, have changed my name from Rihana Khan to Rehana Khan for all future purposes.

0040875450-4

I, Upasna Sharma D/O Rakesh Sharma R/O H. No-32A, New Heera Park Dichaon Road Najafgarh New Delhi-110043 declare that my father's name is Rakesh Sharma, Rakesh Kumar and Rakesh Kumar Sharma. These are one and the same person names.

0071057842-1

I, Ex-No-9098992H, L-Hav Shakeel Ahmed Shah, R/O- Kachhama, Tehsil- Kralpora, District- Kupwara. In my service records the name and D o B of my wife has been wrongly mentioned as Hafiza Banoo, 25-05-1980 instead of Hafeeza Begum , 12-03-1979 as mentioned in the Aadhaar card. It needs correction. Objections be filed to Unit 3rd JAKLI within seven days.

0020519212-1

I, SAHIB S/O AMRIT PAL R/O HNO.407 F HUDDA SECTOR-6 PANIPAT HARYANA-132103. HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SAHIB KANDHAL.

0040875435-2

I, MANJU RANI RATHORE W/O RAJESH RATHORE R/O 431-B, GALI NO-2, GANESH NAGAR-2, MAGAN BHAWAN, SHAKARPUR, DELHI-110092. HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO MANJU RATHORE FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES.

0071057731-1

I, NARESH KUMAR S/O-UMRAO SINGH, R/O- H. NO-RZF-1/96, GALI NO-2, MAHAVIR ENCLAVE, PALAM SOUTH WEST DELHI, DELHI-110045. HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO NARESH KUMAR SHARMA for all Purposes.

0040875436-3

I, GUNJAN D/O PRAVEEN KUMAR GROVER R/O-B-393, Sudershan Park Moti Nagar Delhi Pin 110015. Have Changed my name to Gunjan Grover.

0040875434-6

I, SMITHA SANTHOSH, wife'- of, SANTHOSH M., presently, residing in, Flat-No 232 Aakas Darshan Apartment, Mayur-Vihar phase-1, New Delhi-110091, have changed my name from SMITHA SANTHOSH to SMITHA V, vide-Affidavit, date-31/08/26.

0040875436-12

I, Ritu Kejariwal W/o Navin Kumar Kejriwal R/o RZ-84, Main Dabari Palam Road, Dabri, Delhi-110045, have changed my name to Ritu Kejriwal permanently.

0040875335-2

I, MOHD GULFAM, S/O- ZAMIR KHAN, R/O- R-235 GALI-NO.3, JOGABAI EXT JAMIANAGAR OKHLA DELHI 110025 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME MOHD GULFAM TO GULFAM KHAN PERMANENTLY

0040875453-3

I, Varun Kumar Gupta, S/o Sh. Ashok Kumar Gupta, R/o A-2/44, Rajouri Garden, New Delhi-110027, have changed my name from Varun Kumar Gupta to Varun Gupta, for all future purposes.

0040875435-11

I, Mohammad Firoz Bhura Qureshi R/o-1113, Masjid Teliyan, Sohrahgate, Meerut have changed my son name to Affan Mohd to Mohd Affan.

0071057793-1

I, Indu, W/o- Rajvirender Singh R/o Flat No-64B First Floor Block AN Shalimar Bagh Delhi-110088, have changed my name to Indu Rani.

0040875450-6

I, Yogesh S/o Shri Ashok Kumar R/o B-9/447, Near Mother Dairy, Sector-3, Rohini, Delhi-110085 have changed my name to Yogesh Verma S/o Ashok kumar for all purposes.

0040875322-3

I, MOHD YUNUS S/O ABDUL GAFFOR R/O 106 OKHLA VILLAGE JAMIA NAGAR NFC SOUTH EAST DELHI-25 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO MOHD YOUNUS PERMANENTLY FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES.

0040875440-1

I, ANHAD PREET KAUR D/o Apyreet Singh, WZ-362, Lane-20, Shivnagar, Janakpuri, Delhi-58 have changed my name to ANHADPREET KAUR.

0071057775-1

I, SHABANA PARVEEN, D/o F-10/1 Malviya Nagar, New Delhi-17, declare that my husband's name in daughter SUSHIA's 10th marksheet is wrongly written as 'MOHD SHAKEEL ANSARI' and needs to be changed to 'MOHAMMAD SHAKEEL ANSARI' for all purposes.

0130068700-1

I, SANJEEV TYAGI, S/O- BHOOMITRA SINGH TYAGI, R/O- 2B-24 Vasundhara Ghaziabad Uttar Pradesh-20112, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME FROM SANJEEV TYAGI TO SANJEEV KUMAR TYAGI FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES.

0040875450-10

I, Monika Marwah alias Monika Taneja, W/o- Sachin Taneja R/o G-251, DLF, Sector-10, Faridabad HR have changed my name to Monika Taneja

0040875434-3

I, Pawan Kumar Pandey, S/o- Bhanu Pratap Pandey, R/o- 3/34, Palm Olympia, Near by Gaur City, Greater-Noida West, Gautam Buddha Nagar, UP-201301, have changed my name to Pawan Pandey for all purposes.

0040875435-8

I, ANCHAL MITTAL W/O NITIN GUPTA R/O 8/7, RAM KISHOR ROAD, CIVIL LINES, DELHI-110054, have changed my name to ANCHAL GUPTA

0040875436-7

I, Abid Ali S/O Mustak Ahmed, R/o- C-22/A, Gali-No-2, Jagat-Puri Thana, Radhey-Shyam Park-Ext., Krishna-Nagar, East-Delhi, Delhi-110051, have changed my name to Abid Saifi.

0040875436-9

I, Mohd Firoz S/o Mohammad Yaqoob R/o-1113, Masjid Teliyan, Sohrahgate, Meerut have changed my name to Mohammad Firoz Bhura Qureshi.

0071057785-1

I, Komal Chaudhary alias Komal, w/o Prashant Tomar, R/o-405 Sec-2, Shastri Nagar Meerut, Uttar Pradesh, have changed my name to KOMAL CHOUDHARY permanently.

0040875450-3

I, SANDEEP GUPTA S/O JAGDISH GUPTA R/O B-22, 1ST FLOOR, MP-NO-334, BASAI DARAPUR KIRTI NAGAR, RAMESH NAGAR, PO: RAMESH NAGAR DELHI-110015 have changed my name to SANDDEEP K GUPTA for all purposes.

0071057838-1

I, NARINDER SINGH S/O PARMJEET R/O C-294 AVANTIKA SECTOR-1 ROHINI DELHI-110085. HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO NARINDER SINGH BHALLA.

0040875435-1

I, Ramesh Kumar, S/o- Raghubir Singh, R/o- Near Shiv Mandir, Village-Wazirabad, Gurgaon (Haryana), have changed my name to Ramesh Kumar Yadav for all Purposes.

0040875436-2

I, Mohammad Ilyiyash, S/o Jalaluddin, R/O, C/128/19, Kiloka ri Sunlight-Colony-1, Maharani-Bagh, Delhi-110014, that my father's name is wrongly mentioned in my Passport-NO. UJ226200 as Mohammed Jalaluddin instead of his correct name Jalaluddin.

0040875436-11

I, Navin Kumar Kejariwal S/o Govind Prasad Kejriwal R/o RZ-84, Main Dabri Palam Road, Dabri, Delhi-110045, have changed my name to Navin Kumar Kejriwal permanently.

0040875335-1

I, SATY PAL S/o- Ramswarop R/O- GH-1/25, Archana Apartment Paschim Vihar New Delhi-110063, have changed my name to SATYAPAL, for all purposes

0040875453-2

I, Sarita Rani Monga W/o. Rajeev Monga R/o. B-46 Vishnu Garden New Delhi 110018 have changed my name to Sarita Monga for all future purposes.

0040875324-1

I, MD Ismail, S/O Mohammad Ayub, H.No.A-227 third floor, Gali no 5 wazirabad Village Delhi-110084, have changed my name to Mohammad Ismail for all purposes

0040875435-10

I, ARVIND KUMAR SHARMA S/o Shri Ram Lakahan Sharma, R/o House.No.180, Village Raispur, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-

0040875331-1

I, Baby Pravelli Thomas s/o Plavelli Abraham Thomas r/o JB-12T, LG Flats, Hari Enclave, Harinagar, Mayapuri, Delhi-110064 have changed my name to BABY THOMAS.

0040875344-1

I, Inder Mohan, S/o Roshan Lal R/O F-8, Oriental Enclave, Plot No-32, I P Extension, Patparganj, Delhi-110092 have changed my name to Indra Mohan.

0040875453-1

I, AYUSHIKA, D/O- MAHENDRA SINGH R/o Flat-103, Neelpadam-2, Sector-4, Vaishali, Ghaziabad-201010 have changed my name to AYUSHIKA SINGH for all future purposes.

0040875434-10

I, THOOL KAJAL RAJENDRA W/O ROHAN THAKUR R/O 443 2ND FLOOR STREET NO 13, WEST GURU ANGAD NAGAR OPP. GURUDWARA LAXMI NAGAR PO: LAXMI NAGAR EAST DELHI 110092 have changed my name KAJAL RAJENDR THUL for all future purpose

0071057733-1

I, Sahil, S/o- Sh. Dharmbir, R/o- Village Thana Khurd, Thana Khard (221), PO: Kharkhoda, Sonipat (Haryana)-131402, have changed my name Sahil Dahiya for all Purposes.

0040875436-4

I, Savitri Devi W/o Late. Amar Singh, R/o House No. D-115 B, Nihal Vihar, Nangloi, Delhi-110041 is also known as Savathri Devi. Both names are of one and the same person.

0040875366-1

I, Virpal, D/o-Onkar Nath W/o Raman Manan R/o-11/07/5765, Gali No.5, Subhash Mohalla, Gandhi Nagar, Delhi-110031 have changed my name to Ashma Manan Permanently.

0040875453-4

I, RAJESH, S/o- RAM PARKASH 182B, Town Tohana, Gupta Colony, Tohana Mandi, Fatehabad, Haryana-125120, have changed my name to RAJESH KUMAR for all future purposes.

0040875434-7

I, Charanjeet Bhutani, S/o Sh. Puran Chand Bhutani, R/o 19/A, Gurgaon Gaon, Gurgaon, Haryana-122001, inform that CHARANJEET BHUTANI and CHARANJEET, both names are same person.

0040875435-12

I, Mukta K Khosla, W/O Manav Khosla, R/O B-58, Prashant Vihar, Rohini, Sector-14, Delhi-110085 have changed my name to Mukta Khanna

0071057799-1

I, KIRAN BISHT, W/O- MUKUL SINGH LATWAL, R/O-56, MATA WALI GALI, BAKHTAWARPUR, DELHI-110036 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME KIRAN LATWAL FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES.

0040875450-7

I, GULPSA D/O MOHD TAHIR W/O USMAN R/O C-142 KAVITA COLONY NANGLOI DELHI-110041. HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO GULPASA.

0040875435-5

I, Avishek Sa S/o Dilip Kumar Sa residing at 146/1A, DR. G.S.Bose Road, Tiljala S/O, Kolkata, West Bengal -700039, have changed the name of my minor son Yasharth Sa Aged 12 years and he shall hereafter be known as Suryansh Sa.

0071057741-1

I, AFSHEEN FARAZ, W/O- FARAZ AHMED, R/O- H. NO.-N-71/C, 3rd Floor Near Khailullah Masjid Batla House Okhla Jamia Nagar South-Delhi 110025, have changed, my sur name to AFSHEEN IQBAL for all future Purposes.

0040875436-6

I, PARTH S/O SHRI SANJEEV KUMAR R/O FLAT NO.137, AMAR JYOTI APARTMENTS, MAYUR VIHAR PHASE-1, DELHI-110091, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO PARTH KUMAR FOR ALL PURPOSES.

0040875440-3

I, RAMINDER SINGH CHAWLA, S/O- JOGINDER SINGH CHAWLA, R/O- HOUSE NO-5H/90, FIRST FLOOR NIT FARIDABAD HARYANA-121001 HAVE CHANGE MY NAME TO RAMINDER SINGH

0040875434-9

I, USHA w/o Jagdish Kumar Baswala, 159, Gali No-16, Amrit Puri-B, Garhi, East of Kailash, Delhi-65 have changed my name to USHA BASWALA.

0071057773-1

I, HARISH CHANDER S/O CHATAR SINGH R/O F-287/18 LADO SARAI, DELHI-110030 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO Harish Chand.

0040875434-5

I, MAHESH KUMAR S/o Mahavir Prasad Soni R/o-28, Block-65, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, Delhi-05 have changed my name to MAHESH KUMAR SONI.

0071057811-1

I, OMVIR SINGH, S/O- ATAR SINGH, R/O- Jathouse Near, Gurdwara Ward-10 Mohalla Shyamapuri Narora Tehsil Diba, Bulandshahr Uttar Pradesh-202389, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME FROM OMVIR SINGH TO OMVEER SINGH, FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES.

0040875450-9

I, PRIYANKA, D/O- VIRENDER MISHRA, R/O- H.N. 31, SECTOR-6, R. PURAM, SOUTH WEST DELHI, DELHI -110022, CHANGED MY NAME TO PRIYANKA MISHRA.

0040875434-2

I, Titus Champakessiral, S/o Late Champakessiral Easho, R/O O-1601, Jaipuria Sunrise Greens, Indirapuram, Ghaziabad, UP have changed my name to Titus Easav Champakessiral for all purposes.

0040875435-7

I, Afsha Ahmed w/o Shabeel Ahmed / R/o E1-0704, Radicon Vedantam Gh-01B, Sector-16C, Greater NOIDA-201318 have changed my name to AFSHA IQBAL.

0040875331-1

I, Shashank Kumar Dwivedi, S/o- Ramesh Babu Dwivedi, R/o Jasmine-O/01, Nitoli Scottish Garden, Ahinsa Khand-2, Indirapuram, Ghaziabad (UP), have changed my name to Shashank Kumar for all future purposes.

0040875436-8

I, Kamal Kumar S/O Late Shri Dhamam Chand R/O H.No.53, Turab Nagar, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201001, have changed my name to Kamal Taneja for, all purposes.

0040875450-2

I, Naaz D/O, Mohd Sabir R/o RZ-3157, Street No.36, Tughlakabad Extension, New Delhi-110019 have changed my name to Naaz Sheikh.

0040875402-1

It is for general information that I, POONAM, D/O- NAVDESH KUMAR, R/o house no-109/11/2, firni road, Mundka, PO- Nangloi, DIST: West Delhi, Delhi-110041, declare that name of my father has been wrongly written as NAVDESH in my 10th and 12th class educational documents. The actual name of my father is NAVDESH KUMAR, which may be amended accordingly.

0040875434-11

I, SATYANISHTHA D/O TARLOK CHAND SHARMA R/O 180 TARUN ENCLAVE PITAMPURA DELHI-110034. HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SATYANISHTHA SHARMA.

0040875436-1

I, SURVINDER SINGH S/o Rajinder Singh Bhatia, Flat-No-4, Plot-No-2, Unique Society, Sector-13, Rohini, Delhi-85 have changed my name to SURVINDER SINGH BHATIA.

0071057778-1

I, ABDUL KADIR S/O MOHAMMAD ISLAM KHAN R/O D-968, 3 JAITPUR EXTN PART-2 BADARPUR DELHI-44 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO ABDUL QUADIR PERMANENTLY FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES.

0040875223-3

I, hitherto Known as MORAL S/O SHRIAJAY KUMAR MORAL R/O FLAT NO.301, DCP OFFICE COMPLEX, I.P. EXTENSION, DELHI-110092, have changed my name and shall hereafter be Known as ABHISHEK MORAL.

0040872501-1

LOST & FOUND
Lost my original Allotment Letter (In the name of Shri P.C.Jain) of Flat No-A-138, Nav Shakti C.G.H.S Limited, Sector-9, Rohini, Delhi-110085. Finder may Contact- Mrs Sha Ji Jain at above noted address.

0040875325-1

I, Shiv Sagar Suri, S/o Ujval Sagar Suri R/o 1-D, Sagar Apartments, 6, Tilak Marg, New Delhi-110001 had lost on 01.08.2026 agreement to sale i.e Builder Buyer Agreement along with various connected documents between Sequoia Construction Private Limited and Shiv Sagar Suri. Finder Must Contact: 9810157132

0040875323-1

Lost my original FDR (File No.F16(25958)2012RHN, Application-No.231797, Priority No.4653) of Plot No.568, Sector-37, Block-B, Pkt-3, Rohini, Delhi-85. Finder may Contact- Ranjeet Kaur, W/o- Late Shri Man Mohan Singh, R/o-19/1341, Hari Singh Nalwa Street, Karol Bagh, New Delhi-110005

0071057765-1

I, Ram Mohan Arora, S/o- Late Prof Krishna Kumar, R/o- P-601, Anupam Apartments, East Arjun Nagar, Shahdara, Delhi-110032, have lost my original Share Certificate and Allotment Letter of the above said property. A FIR LR-591124/2026, dated-30/08/2026, have been filed. Finder may inform.

0040875453-7

I Santosh Arora, W/o Late Sh. Lal Chand, R/o House No. 12/7, Old Rajinder Nagar, New Delhi-110060 have lost my Original Sale Deed registered as document No. 1544, in Book No. 1, Volume No. 9078, on pages 31 to 38, dated 20.02.1996, registered in the office of SR-III, New Delhi (Archives) duly executed by Sh. Vijay Kumar in favour of Smt. Santosh and Smt. Ishwar Devi Batra. Finders may contact at above address.

0040875322-2

BUSINESS
Share Market Convert Your Physical Shares to DEMAT FOR IEPF CLAIM CONTACT 9892886221 0050296537-1

FINANCE
SHARE MARKET CONVERT YOUR PHYSICAL SHARES TO DEMAT FOR IEPF CLAIM CONTACT 9892886221 0050296537-1

PUBLIC NOTICE
My clients Mrs Gudi and her husband Bilu both R/O H No 46 Gali No 3 Akash Vihar Bagnia Nagar Delhi 110043 have severed all their relations with their son Pawan daughter in law Meenakshi and grand children Anshika and Armaan and have debarrd them from all their moveable and immovable properties with immediate effect due to their abusive and disobedient conduct and working against their will and if any body deals with them will do at their own risk cost and consequences and my clients shall not be responsible for their acts in future in any manner whatsoever.

Sanjay Padam Jain (Advocate) Office: 113-A, DDA Flats, Pitam Pura, Behind Shiva Market, Delhi-110034

PUBLIC NOTICE
This is to inform to public at large that my clients Inar Hussain, Zahid Ali, Shah Alam and Shaheen all R/O B-11-B Shivgiri Kunj, Opposite B-1, Paschim Vihar, New Delhi-110063 have severed all relationship from Sahiba Alam and his wife Shaheen and their son Haasan and disowned and debarrd them from all moveable and immovable properties of my clients as they have become disobedient and they are out of control of my above clients and my clients have nothing to do with them. My clients shall not be responsible for their acts, deeds. If any person deals with them then he/she will be doing that at his/her own risk and consequences.

Sanjay Padam Jain (Advocate) Office: 113-A, DDA Flats, Pitam Pura, Behind Shiva Market, Delhi-110034

PUBLIC NOTICE
To be known to all that my client Vijay Sood S/o Sh. Santosh Kumar S/o R/o Flat No. E-30, DDA Flats, Munika, New Delhi-110067 The Original documents i.e. DDA Possession Letter, NOC for Electric and Water has been sent. An FIR to this has been lodged vide LR.584947/2026, dated-27-08-2026. Any Person(s) claiming any right, interest, having any objection or found in possession of original documents may write/contact with above named person at above address within 15 days from the date of publication of this notice. The person claiming any right, interest, objection with respect to this property can personally informed.

Sd/-B.B.N.Doo, Advocate SR I.B. Campus, Janki Puri, New Delhi-58

PUBLIC NOTICE
My clients Rajibha W/o Late Ram Kishan R/o H

राजस्थान सरकार

कार्यालय अर्थीक्षण अभियन्ता सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग वृत्त अलवर
 रा.नि.वि, पंचायत, अडोला टाउन के पास, कच्छाई रोड, अलवर
 फोन:- 0144-2373038, E-mail:-scatfw.pwd@rajasthan.gov.in

क्रमांक-Rajkaj Ref No: 24187528 दिनांक 21.08.26

Short Term NIT No 12/2026-27

Construction of Various Missing Link / Non-Patchable Roads under the Jurisdiction of PWD Divisions Alwar and Atal path at jurisdiction of PWD Div Kathumar, District Alwar Online bids are invited from eligible and interested bidders for the above-mentioned works. The bidding process will commence from **22.08.2026 at 02:00 PM** up to **01.09.2026 at 06:00 PM**. Detailed bidding documents and other particulars may be downloaded from the State Procurement Portal <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in>, <http://sppp.raj.nic.in>, and the PWD departmental website <http://pwd.rajasthan.gov.in>.

The approximate value of the procurements is **Rs. 872.06 Lakhs.**

UBN No: -

1. PWD2627WSOB11432
2. PWD2627WSOB11433
3. PWD2627WSOB11434
4. PWD2627WSOB11435
5. PWD2627WSOB11431

Sd/-
Superintending Engineer
PWD Circle Alwar

DIPRI/C/15483/2026

 34001/724/2627	GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER, NORTHERN (R&B) CIRCLE SAMBALPUR e - Procurement BID IDENTIFICATION No CCENC (R AND B) /05/ 2026-27 Mail ID: - sepwdshp@rediffmail.com
No. 3362	Dtd. 28.08.2026
1. The Chief Construction Engineer, Northern (R&B) Circle, Sambalpur on behalf of Governor of Odisha invites Percentage Rate bids in double cover system in ONLINE MODE for the construction of Building Works as detailed in the DTCN for the eligible class of contractors. 2. No of works= 05 (FIVE) (BUILDING Works) 3. Tender Cost: Rs. 10,000/- 4. Class of contractor: "B" Class, "A" Class and "Special" Class 5. Date & Time of available in web site & receipt of Bids From 09.09.2026 to 17.00 Hours of 24.09.2026. 6. Date of opening of Technical Bid 25.09.2026 at 11.00 Hours. 7. The Bidders have to participate in ONLINE bidding only. Further details can be seen from the website www.tendersodisha.gov.in. 8. Any corrigendum/Addendum will be displayed in the website www.tendersodisha.gov.in.	
Sd/- CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER, NORTHERN (R&B) CIRCLE	
OIPR-34001/34035/1/26-27/0004	SAMBALPUR

 JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU 																				
0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F), email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in																				
Hue and Cry Notice Rule No. 712/191																				
SDPO City East, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Mohd Younis S/O Noor Mohd R/O Not known is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 85/2018 U/S 120-B, 14 Foreign Act, 3/6 IP Act of P/S Bahu Fort, Jammu. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/s till absconded.. It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments/ Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact /Telephone numbers. Description Roll :- <table style="width: 100%; border: none;"> <tr> <td style="width: 30%;">Name :-</td> <td>Mohd Younis</td> </tr> <tr> <td>S/O :-</td> <td>Noor Mohd</td> </tr> <tr> <td>Address:-</td> <td>Not known</td> </tr> <tr> <td>Age :-</td> <td>35-40 Years</td> </tr> </table> Contacts/Telephone Numbers:- <table style="width: 100%; border: none;"> <tr> <td style="width: 30%;">1. DPO, Jammu</td> <td>:- 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578</td> </tr> <tr> <td>2. SSP Jammu Mail LD</td> <td>:- sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in</td> </tr> <tr> <td>3. PCR Jammu</td> <td>:- 0191-2605949</td> </tr> <tr> <td>4. SP City South</td> <td>:- 0191-2430002</td> </tr> <tr> <td>5. SDPO City East</td> <td>:- 01912433778</td> </tr> <tr> <td>6. P/S Bahu Fort</td> <td>:- 0191-2475133</td> </tr> </table>	Name :-	Mohd Younis	S/O :-	Noor Mohd	Address:-	Not known	Age :-	35-40 Years	1. DPO, Jammu	:- 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578	2. SSP Jammu Mail LD	:- sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in	3. PCR Jammu	:- 0191-2605949	4. SP City South	:- 0191-2430002	5. SDPO City East	:- 01912433778	6. P/S Bahu Fort	:- 0191-2475133
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For Sr. Superintendent of Police Jammu																				
DIP/J-9083/26 – DATE 31 AUG 2026 Date:- .08.2026																				

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE						
SR NO	NAME OF DEPARTMENT	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE DEPARTMENT	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	PWD B&R, HISAR	CONSTRUCTION OF RCC BRIDGE ON BALASMAND SUB BRANCH TO IMPROVE CONNECTIVITY FROM DAY SCHOOL TO SERVICE ROAD OF ROB LC-4A ON SOUTHERN BYPASS IN HISAR DISTRICT. (PDG. SHIFTING OF HT/LT LINES ONLY) + 1 WORKS	27.08.2026 02.09.2026	21.82 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01662225651 pwd-eeed-hissar@hry.nic.in
2	PWD B&R, HISAR	SPECIAL REPAIR OF OLD COURT COMPLEX AT HISAR (SPECIAL REPAIR TO VARIOUS ELECTRICAL SERVICES ONLY	27.08.2026 02.09.2026	63.20 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01662225651 pwd-eeed-hissar@hry.nic.in
3	PWD B&R, GURUGRAM	RENOVATION OF HOUSE NO.6, MOR CHOWK AT GURUGRAM	CLOSING DATE 02.09.2026	12.73 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01242322424 pwd-eeepd1-gurgaon@hry.nic.in
4	PWD B&R, GURUGRAM	CONSTRUCTION OF 4 NOS. RAIN WATER HARVESTING SYSTEM IN THE CAMPUS OF REST HOUSE AT GURUGRAM	CLOSING DATE 02.09.2026	13.15 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01242322424 pwd-eeepd1-gurgaon@hry.nic.in
5	PWD B&R, GURUGRAM	RENOVATION OF OUTER AREA IN HOUSE NO.11, OFFICER COLONY NO.2 AT GURUGRAM	CLOSING DATE 02.09.2026	5.07 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01242322424 pwd-eeepd1-gurgaon@hry.nic.in
6	PWD B&R, GURUGRAM	RENOVATION OF RECORD ROOM IN MINI SECTT. AT GURUGRAM	CLOSING DATE 02.09.2026	3.61 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01242322424 pwd-eeepd1-gurgaon@hry.nic.in
7	PWD B&R, GURUGRAM	RENOVATION OF HOUSE NO.5, MOR CHOWK AT GURUGRAM	CLOSING DATE 02.09.2026	6.88 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01242322424 pwd-eeepd1-gurgaon@hry.nic.in
8	PWD B&R, ROHTAK	CONSTRUCTION OF WORKSHOP BLOCK AND LIBRARY BLOCK IN THE CAMPUS OF GOVERNMENT POLYTECHNIC AT MEHAM IN DISTRICT ROHTAK (PDG. BALANCE EI WORK ONLY)	26.08.2026 02.09.2026	33.21 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9034929655 pwdeeedrohtak1@gmail.com
9	PWD B&R, ROHTAK	REVAMPING AND MODERNISATION OF DISTRICT INDUSTRIES CENTRE BUILDING AT ROHTAK (PROVIDING ELY SERVICES ONLY) + 3 WORKS	27.08.2026 07.09.2026	99.55 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9034929655 pwdeeedrohtak1@gmail.com
10	PWD B&R, KARNAL	RESTORATION OF ROAD CUT MADE BY PUBLIC HEALTH DEPARTMENT FOR LAYING SEWER LINE ON KARNAL MEERUT ROAD TO SOHANA RASULPUR ROAD (ROAD ID-7245) (ODR) IN GHARAUNDA CONSTITUENCY, IN KARNAL DISTRICT	27.08.2026 02.09.2026	17.88 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9876009311 pwd-eeepd-karnal@hry.nic.in
11	CIVIL AVIATION DEPARTMENT, HARYANA	ALLOTMENT OF BUILT-UP HANGARS AND OFFICE SPACE AT HISAR AIRPORT.	28.08.2026 28.09.2026	EMD 25 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01722709386 managing-director@hac.org.in
12	AGRICULTURE & FARMERS WELFARE, BHIWANI	VERTICAL DRAINAGE PROJECT VILLAGE - BARSI /DURJANPUR/MILAKPUR, BLOCK - BAWANI KHERA, DISTRICT-BHIWANI	26.08.2026 16.09.2026	554.68 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9215910040 ascobhiwani@gmail.com
13	PANCHAYATI RAJ, BHIWANI	CONST OF BC CHOUHAL AT VILLAGE DHARAN BLOCK TOSHAM (SCHEME-DMF) + 4 WORKS	27.08.2026 02.09.2026	90.55 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01664243927 prexeeng.bhw@hry.nic.in
14	PANCHAYATI RAJ, BHIWANI	CONSTRUCTION OF BOUNDARY WALL OF GOVT. AYURVEDIC DISPENSERY IN VILLAGE BARWAS BLOCK LOHARU + 3 WORKS	27.08.2026 02.09.2026	48.80 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01664243927 prexeeng.bhw@hry.nic.in
15	FOREST DEPARTMENT, BHIWANI	BHIWANI IST BLOCK NEW PLANTATION & MAINTENANCE AND 13 OTHERS WORK	27.09.2026 03.09.2026	599.12 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9813207322 dfo.bhiwani@yahoo.com
16	DIRECTOR GENERAL, SUPPLIES & DISPOSALS PANCHKULA, HARYANA	ANNUAL RATE CONTRACT OF HYDRAULICALLY OPERATED GRAB MACHINES DULY MOUNTED ON 2.7 TON (MIN) GVW VEHICLE CHASSIS	01.09.2026 30.09.2026		https://etenders.hry.nic.in dsndharyana.gov.in	0172-2570122 Supplies@hry.nic.in
17	DIRECTOR GENERAL, SUPPLIES & DISPOSALS PANCHKULA, HARYANA	TENDER FOR ARRANGING TWO YEARS RATE CONTRACT FOR THE PROCUREMENT OF RO SYSTEM	01.09.2026 30.09.2026		https://etenders.hry.nic.in dsndharyana.gov.in	0172-2570122 Supplies@hry.nic.in
18	DIRECTOR GENERAL, SUPPLIES & DISPOSALS PANCHKULA, HARYANA	TENDER FOR ARRANGING TWO YEARS RATE CONTRACT FOR THE PROCUREMENT OF MOTOR (WATER PUMP)	01.09.2026 30.09.2026		https://etenders.hry.nic.in dsndharyana.gov.in	0172-2570122 Supplies@hry.nic.in
19	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, ROHTAK	RECONSTRUCTION OF GHAT AT RD 26615 OF JASRANA MINOR. + 6 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 03.09.2026	16.45 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9812111077 xenwsdnrtk@gmail.com
20	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, CHARKHI DADRI	REQUIREMENT OF MATERIAL/JOB FOR FLOOD SITES AT RD-9000 LC (DADRI SIDE), RD 12500 LC AND RD-13000 LC (BHARVI SIDE) UNDER JURISDICTION OF LWS (M) SUB DIVISION NO. 1, CHARKHI DADRI AND 2 MORE WORKS	CLOSING DATE 07.09.2026	2.92 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01250-220058 xenlwsmech@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT www.etenders.hry.nic.in

NO. 48763/HRY

	PUNJAB STATE POWER CORPORATION LIMITED Regd. Office: PSB Head Office, The Mall Patiala-147001. Corporate Identity Number: U40109PB2010SGC033813. Website: www.pspcl.in (O/o Controller of Stores & Disposal (South), PSPCL, Patiala) (Email - cosandds@gmail.com, Mobile no. - 96461-19412, 96461-48165)
Serap e-Auction Notice Punjab State Power Corporation Limited (PSPCL) will conduct a forward e-auction on 02.09.2026 for the disposal of approximately 30956 Damaged/Unserviceable Distribution Transformers (Approximate Total Start price Rs. 47.65 crores), lying at various Transformer Receiving Yards and General Scrap, Battery Scrap, E-waste, Plastic Waste (Approximate Total Start price Rs.8.72crores) lying in various central Stores, TRYs and Outlet stores across Punjab, offered in separate multiple lots for each location. The e-auction will be conducted on the website portal https://www.mssteccommerce.com/auctionhome/index_new.jsp. The Detailed auction catalogue with Terms & Conditions of e-auction, corrigendum and material list etc. will be available on the website https://www.mssteccindia.co.in/content/Forcoming_e_Auctions_For_All_regions.aspx and on https://www.pspcl.in/e-auction/notices.aspx. For queries related to registration, please contact at Phone No. 7229068247 or 7230022882. No. 14708/PB	

UJVN LTD.

H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006

Telephone: 0135 - 2763808, Fax 0135-2763508
CIN No.- U40101UR2001SGC25866, Website : www.ujvn.com

Letter No 749	Tender Notice	Dated 31.08.2026
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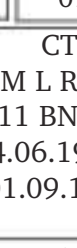
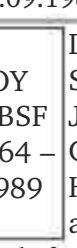
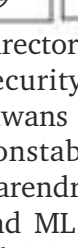
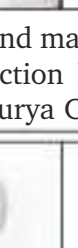
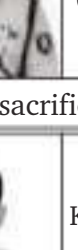
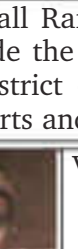
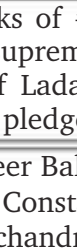
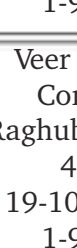
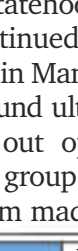
Office of Executive Engineer (Maint.) , Khodri Power House, invites sealed tender from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below,
Tender No:- 10/EE(Maint.) /Khodri/2026-27.
Name of work: Annual maintenance work related to turbine & associated parts of Unit No. 283 of Khodri Power Station.
Estimated cost: Rs. 24,52,460/- (GST extra).
Date of availability of bid Document on website: 01.09.2026, 10:00 hrs
Last date for submission of tender : 21.09.2026, 16:00 Hrs.
For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender document can be downloaded from the Nigam's website "www.ujvn.com".
Executive Engineer (Maint.) khodri power station

"Avoid Wasteful use of Electricity"

Date: 31-08-2026 Civil Division, New Delhi Invoites contracts of Water Vending way stations/locations:	कार्यालय परिचयोना प्रबन्धक, यूनिट-7 कन्स्ट्रक्शन एण्ड डिजाइन सर्विसेज उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम (गंगरी) (उप 30 सरकारी का उपकरण) का.पता -ए-212, साक-ए-7, वेव्यासपुरी, मेरठ-250005 E-mail Id: cds.unit7@gmail.com
Railway Stations	निविदा सूचना सं. : 3320/E-Tender/220 दिनांक : 27.08.2026
M at Garhi Harsaru, 01 WVM Judi Road, 01 WVM at Palam, Rohilla Railway Station).	ई-निविदा सूचना
Ms at Meerut City, 02 WVMs at Vivek Vihar, 03 WVMs at Station).	उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम, की ओर से अयोध्याखोरी द्वारा 'Remaining work (Audio Visual work) at New Nagar Nigam Office Building in District Meerut (U.P.)- Part-3 के निर्माण अनुमानित लागत ₹119.50 लाख (जी.एस.टी. रहित एवं लेबर सेस सहित) हेतु सी.एण्ड डी.एस. में यथोचित श्रेणी में भवन कार्य हेतु पंजीकृत टेक्रेडरों से विनांक 04.09.2026 के अपरान्ह 15.00 बजे तक ई-निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती हैं। उक्त कार्य हेतु ई-निविदा प्रपत्र दिनांक 27.08.2026 से दिनांक 04.09.2026 के मध्य उत्तर प्रदेश सरकार की e-procurement वेबसाइट https://etender.up.nic.in से डाउनलोड किये जा सकते हैं तथा ई-निविदा विनांक 04.09.2026 को अपरान्ह 16.30 बजे सी. एण्ड डी.एस. यूनिट-07, उ.प्र. जल निगम, मेरठ में निविदा खोली जायेगी। ई-निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य ₹ 10000.00+GST (18%) अतिरिक्त देय होगा।
WVMs at Jind, 02 WVMs at Tohana, 02 WVMs at Jakhal, ray Station).	निविदा से सम्बन्धित विस्तृत विवरण विभाग की वेबसाइट www.cdsupjn.org एवं प्रोक्योरमेन्ट पोर्टल https://etender.up.nic.in पर उपलब्ध हैं। समस्त शुल्क पत्र (Corrigendum) https://etender.up.nic.in पर ही अपलोड किये जायेंगे, इनका प्रयुक्त से कोई प्रकाशन नहीं किया जायेगा। निविदादाताओं को सलाह दी जाती है कि वे उक्त वेबसाइट का समय- समय पर अवलोकन करते रहें।
WVM at Baraut, 01 WVM at at Noli, 02 WVMs at Shamli, Maniharan and 04 WVMs at Station).	No.
WVMs at Panipat, 02 WVMs at WMs Bhodwal Majri Railway	MPS-163-25-2
WMs at Kurukshetra, 02 WVMs at Shahbad Marknda Railway	MPS-131-25-2
WVMs at Badli, 02 WVMs at Sonipat Railway Station).	MPS-115-25-2
	MPS-122-25-2
	MPS-158-25-2
	MPS-135-25-2

"IMPORTANT"

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GORKHA RIFLES			
 Indian Army and 11 Gorkha Rifles Salutes its brave heart, No 10374372 Late Rfn Kishan Rai 107 Inf Bn (TA) 11 GR, who made supreme sacrifice during OP MEGHDOOT on 01 Sep 1996.			
Colonel 11 GR & Sikhim Scouts and All Ranks BORDER SECURITY FORCE			
 L/NAIK T KHEHUTO SEMA 111 BN BSF 15.10.1956 – 01.09.1989	 CT BIRENDRA NATH NANDI 111 BN BSF 04.03.1966 – 01.09.1989	 CT HARENDRA CHANDRA NATH 111 BN BSF 29.01.1965 – 01.09.1989	 CT ASHADUL HAQUE 111 BN BSF 29.11.1966 – 01.09.1989
 CT M L ROY 111 BN BSF 24.06.1964 – 01.09.1989	Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawans Lance Naik T Khehuto Sema and Constables Birendra Nath Nandi, Harendra Chandra Nath, Ashadul Haque and ML Roy on their Balidan Diwas. On this day, they sustained fatal injuries in a fierce encounter with militants in area of CI Post "Laniya Bridge" (Manipur) and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.		
 HC Khunihoo Sema SHAURYA CHAKRA 111 BN BSF 20.11.1934 – 01.09.1989	Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Head Constable Khunihoo Sema, on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal injuries in a fierce encounter with militants in area of CI Post "Laniya Bridge" (Manipur). He fought bravely and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty. His sacrifice and gallant action have been aptly recognized by GOI by awarding him with Shaurya Chakra (Posthumously).		
 ASI KAMALJEET SINGH 200 BN BSF 04.01.1967 – 01.09.2017	Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Subordinate Officer, Assistant Sub Inspector Kamaljeet Singh on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained serious bullet injuries in counterpart firing in area of FDL Ghora, Poonch, J&K and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.		
 CONSTABLE PRAMOD KUMAR AZAD 114 BN BSF 25.06.1978 – 01.09.2017	Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Pramod Kumar Azad on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he made supreme sacrifice while on operational duty in Bareilly (UP).		
 CONSTABLE KEHARI SINGH 104 BN BSF 04.12.1965 – 01.09.1988	Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Kehari Singh on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injuries in an encounter with militants in Gurdaspur area (Punjab) and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.		
 CT XAVIER KINDO, PMG 28 BN BSF 10.03.1970 – 01.09.2012	Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Xavier Kindo on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he made supreme sacrifice in an IED blast triggered by Naxals in Koraput area (Odisha). His sacrifice has been aptly recognized by GOI by awarding him with Police Medal for Gallantry (Posthumously).		
CENTRAL RESERVE POLICE FORCE			
 Veer Balidani Sub Inspector Ranbir Singh 40 Bn 3-11-1932 To 1-9-1980	 Veer Balidani Constable Tikendra Kumar 40 Bn 1-2-1956 To 1-9-1980	DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to two bravehearts, who made the supreme sacrifice after being drown in Sindh river in Kargil district of Ladakh on 1 September 1980. #CRPF salutes the bravehearts and pledges never to let their sacrifice go in vain.	
 Veer Balidani Head Constable Ram chandra Sharma 45 BN 4-10-1934 To 1-9-1981	 Veer Balidani Naik Dariyao Singh 45 BN 10-2-1945 To 1-9-1981		
 Veer Balidani Constable P K. Vijayan 45 BN 30-12-1947 To 1-9-1981	 Veer Balidani Constable B. A. Kakkre 45 BN 28-1-1952 To 1-9-1981		
 Veer Balidani Constable Raghubir Sharma 45 BN 19-10-1951 To 1-9-1981	 Veer Balidani Constable Raghubir Singh 45 BN	Despite statehood having been bestowed upon Manipur in Jan 1972, the state continued to reel under insurgency even in the 80s. 45 BN was deployed in Manipur to carry out counter insurgency operations against the underground ultras. On 1 September 1981, a party of six troopers was out to carry out operations. Enroute an encounter was ensued with the insurgent group. The personnel retaliated the fire well and fought gallantly. All of them made supreme sacrifice of their lives in the line of duty.	
 Veer Balidani Constable Sachin Kumar 150 Bn 10-10-1988 To 1-9-2016	DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Sachin Kumar of 150 BN who made the supreme sacrifice on 1 September 2016 after being grievously injured in an IED blast on 26 August 2016 in Sukma district, Chhattisgarh. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.		

Government of Maharashtra

Forest Department

Mangrove Division-North Konkan

Abhimaan II, 5th Floor, Teen Haat Naka, Naupada, Thane (W)-400 602

Email-dformmcu@gmail.com

Parent Portal : <http://mahatenders.gov.in>

E-Tender

Online Tender Forms in B-1 Format, for the following work are invited by the Divisional Forest Officer, Mangrove Division- North Konkan, Abhimaan II, 5th Floor, Teen Haat Naka, Naupada, Thane (W)-400 602 from the contractors registered with the Government of Maharashtra in appropriate class of Tender Notice.

The blank tender documents should be downloaded from Government website <http://mahatenders.gov.in> from **31/08/2026 at 05.00 pm to 07/09/2026 at 05.00 pm**. Blank Tender documents will not be sold by this office; interested contractors have to download tender documents from the website. For any queries in this regard the interested contractors can contact on telephone no **022-69309286** during office hours.

All requisite information required for the submission of Bid Capacity documents is available on the above said website. If any assistance is required regarding e-Tendering (uploading/downloading) please contact NIC Help Desk number: **1800 3070 2232**.

Sl. No.	Name of work	Tender Notice No.	Tender cost. (Rs.)	Earnest Money Deposit (Rs.)	Time limit	Cost of Blank Tender Form (Non-Refundable)
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
1.	Construction of RCC Compound wall with Y-type Angle & 2.45 mm dia G.I.Pipe (Rezan/Conenti Deleted ire 0.75 mm dia) near Hanuman Mandir at Kalher in S.No.114/2/B /1, Part II in Kashe! Beat in Thane Mangrove Range of MDNK.	DFO/MDN K/THANE/ 01/26-27	81,51,712/-	81,517/-	4 Months.	Rs. 1180/- (Including GST)
2.	Construction of RCC Compound wall with Y-type Angle & 2.45 mm dia G.I.Pipe (Rezan/Conenti Deleted ire 0.75 mm dia) near Hanuman Mandir at Kalher in S.No.114/2/B /1, Part I in Kashe! Beat in Thane Mangrove Range of MDNK.	DFO/MDN K/THANE/ 02/26-27	81,54,826/-	81,548/-	4 Months.	Rs. 1180/- (Including GST)

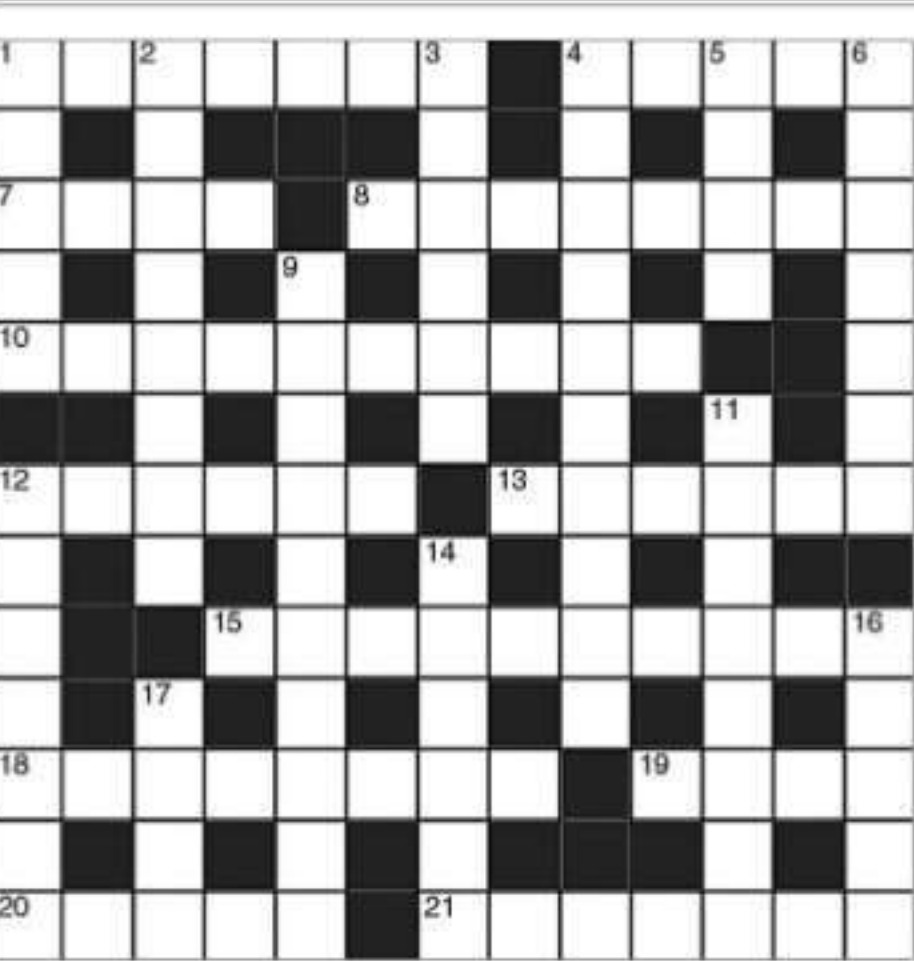
1) No changes are to be made by the contractor in the tender documents published on the website. If any changes are made the tender documents will be rejected & action accordingly will be taken against the contractor. Information published on the government website will be final.

2) Right to reject any or all the tenders without assigning any reason there of is reserved.

Sd/-
Divisional Forest Officer,
Mangrove Division North Konkan.

DGIPR/2026-27/2558

CROSSWORD



- ACROSS
- 1 Take commission away from a money collector (7)
- 4 Return of spirit in debate (5)
- 7 List of courses for chaps at university (4)
- 8 Members of this society have a lot in common (8)
- 10 Alibi tenor used to get release (10)
- 12 Pick a hundred socks with a hole in (6)
- 13 Note condition of property (6)
- 15 They may take an interest in banking (10)
- 18 They make up monograms for people (8)
- 19 Correct pronunciation for the ceremony (4)
- 20 Agree the score (5)
- 21 It's news put out for the viewer (7)
- DOWN
- 1 The animal arrived and left (5)
- 2 Suitable work for a lay reader? (8)
- 3 Show errors in feature lacking a proper revision (6)
- 4 Sister vessel's company? (10)
- 5 Got up we hear for breakfast (4)
- 6 Label in slipper means it can be changed (7)
- 9 In a way property is wealth (10)
- 11 The spirit of America (8)
- 12 He won't stand for his instrument being played! (7)
- 14 Don't take the lead but succeed (6)
- 16 Endeavours to eke out on board (5)
- 17 Quietly suffering medical treatment (4)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6081 ACROSS: 1 Show the flag, 9 Upright, 10 Delhi, 11 Game, 12 Gallants, 14 Report, 16 Enrage, 18 Antidote, 19 Rome, 22 Colon, 23 Trouble, 24 Paper chases DOWN: 2 Harem, 3 Wage, 4 Hit man, 5 Fiddling, 6 Atlanta, 7 Hunger march, 8 First eleven, 13 Prudence, 15 Patella, 17 Static, 20 Ombre, 21 Coda

JUMBLD WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

Better be wise by the ____ of others than by your own - Aesop (11)

LOWER

SYISS

EJKNTU

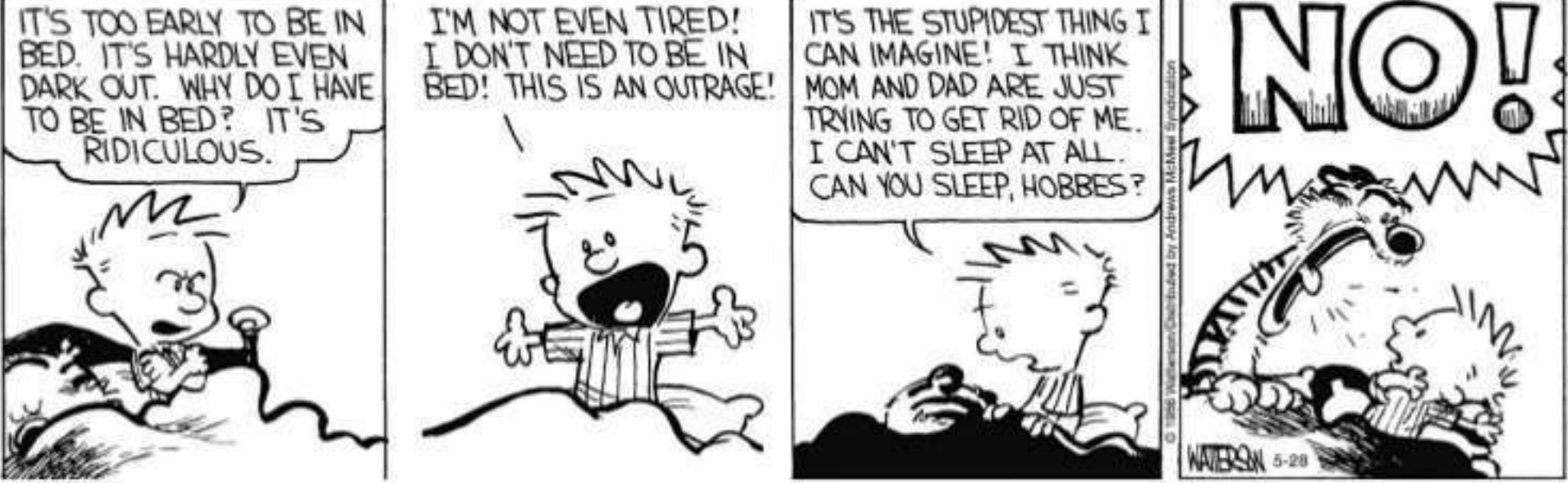
GLUUFM

ANSWER: Rowel, Sissy, Junket, Muglul SOLUTIONS

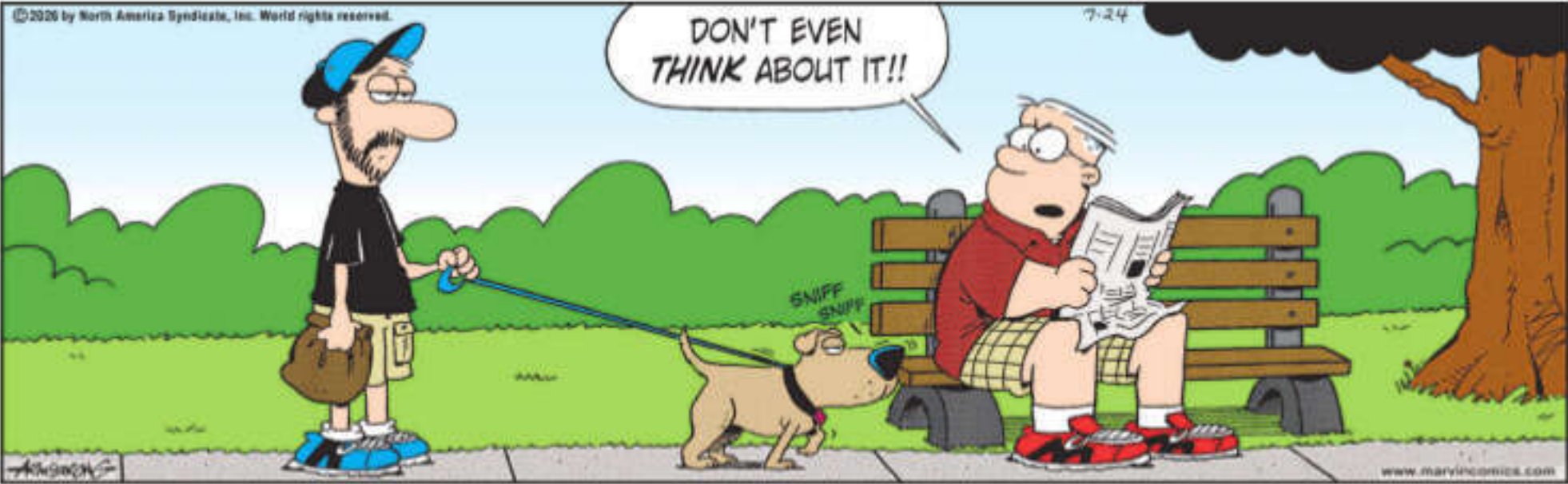
OVER THE HEDGE



CALVIN & HOBBS



MARVIN



DIFFICULTY LEVEL 2s INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL

1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy; 3s = Medium; 4s = Hard; 5s = Very Hard; 6s = Genius

SUDOKU 6428

1	7	4		3		5
		3	6		5	8
2						6
6			7			9
		4		2		
4			8			1
	8					9
		4	9		8	5
3	9		5	4		6

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6427

7	2	3	5	1	6	4	8	9
5	4	1	7	8	9	2	6	3
9	8	6	3	2	4	7	1	5
1	6	7	4	3	5	8	9	2
3	5	4	2	9	8	6	7	1
8	9	2	6	7	1	5	3	4
4	7	5	1	6	3	9	2	8
6	1	9	8	5	2	3	4	7
2	3	8	9	4	7	1	5	6

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Harpreet Singh, S/o. Jasbir Singh, R/o. S-378, 2nd Floor, Panchsheel Park, New Delhi-110007** Also at: **H. No. 201-B, First Floor, DDA Flats, Sadar Bazar Thana Road, Motia Khan, Swami Ram Tirth Nagar, Central Delhi Mobile No. 9818991833** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **CC No. 5490/2024 & CC No. 5491/2024 Both U/S. 138 NI ACT** registered at **P.S Kashmere Gate, North District, Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest thereupon issued stating that the said accused **Harpreet Singh** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Harpreet Singh** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Harpreet Singh**, accused of **CC No. 5490/2024 & CC No. 5491/2024 Both U/S. 138 NI ACT, P.S Kashmere Gate, North District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **03.12.2026 at 10.00 A.M.**

By Order, Arjun Kirar,
Judicial Magistrate First Class- NI ACT-05 (Central), Room No.02, CBA-1, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi.

DP/11865/N/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 82(2) (ii) Cr.P.C.)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Sunil W/o Naresh R/o Street No. 5, 25 Foota Road, Part-II, Mukandpur, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 258/2019, U/s 392/394/411/34 IPC, PS Bhalswa Dairy, Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Sunil** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Sunil** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Sunil** of case **FIR No. 258/2019, U/s 392/394/411/34 IPC, PS Bhalswa Dairy, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **13.10.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Rishabh Kapoor
Judicial Magistrate First Class-01 North, Room No. 116, 1st Floor Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/12228/ON/2026 (Court Matter)

KARNATAKA INDUSTRIAL AREAS DEVELOPMENT BOARD

(A Government of Karnataka Undertaking)

No.2, 2/1 & 2/3, Kalidasa Marg, 1st Main Road, Gandhinagar, Bengaluru - 560009. Phone No. 080-22265383 website:www.kiadb.in

No.:IADB/ENG/ETND-EP-09/693/2026-27 Date:31.08.2026

SHORT TERM NOTICE INVITING TENDER

(Through GOK KPP Portal Only)

Item Rate Tenders are invited as per the Karnataka Transparency in Public Procurement Act 1999 and Rules 2000 through electronic procurement from eligible Contractors registered in KCEI (Electrical)/KPWD (Civil) who have got adequate financial resources & sufficient past experience for the following works as per the schedule given below:-

Name of the works: (1) Repair and Reconditioning of deteriorated transformer accessories and faulty cable of existing 160KVA transformer yard at Raichur Growth Centre, Raichur District. (2nd Call). (Others) (2) Installation and Commissioning of Bulkflow Meter (Bulk Water Connection) for the 5MLD Water Supply in Kanagala Industrial Area, Hukkeri Taluk, Belagavi District. (2nd Call) (Category-1)

Last Date for submission of bids is **15.09.2026 upto 4:00 pm**.

Applicants May download bidding documents from the Karnataka Public Procurement portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>

Sd/-
Chief Engineer-2

DIPR/CP/2519/CC/2026-27

"IMPORTANT"

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IN REMEMBRANCE

Corps of Signals salutes its Signallers who left us for their heavenly abode during the month of Aug 2026.

(1) IC72557H Lieutenant Colonel Jayant Singh Balyan

(2) 15693434N Havildar Sandeep Kumar Dwivedi

(3) 15714499X Havildar Naveen Kumar Singh

(4) 15735441N Lance Naik Avtade Vaibhav Tatyaso

(5) A4356206F Agniveer Dhruv

Deeply mourned by Lt Gen Vivek Dogra, SM, SO-in-C, Col Comdt and all ranks of Corps of Signals.

GOVERNMENT OF MAHARASHTRA

HOME DEPARTMENT

(PORTS & TRANSPORT)

MAHARASHTRA MARITIME BOARD

Indian Mercantile Chambers, 2nd Floor, Ramjibhai Kamani Marg, Ballard Estate, Mumbai- 400 001.

Tel.: 022-69041777 Fax : 022-69041740

Website : <https://mahammmb.maharashtra.gov.in>

Email: ceo.mmb@maharashtra.gov.in/ceommmb@gmail.com

E-Tender Notice

Main Portal: <https://mahatenders.gov.in>

Maharashtra Maritime Board (MMB), Mumbai, hereby invites bids from the eligible agencies for the following work :

Sr. No.	Name of Work	Date and Time
1	Selection of Project Management, Design, Procurement Support, and Supervision Consultant for Development and Upgradation of Terminal, Navigational and Emergency Infrastructure for Mumbai Water Metro - Phase-I	27.08.2026 @ 1800 Hrs.

The details can be viewed online and downloaded directly from the Government of Maharashtra E-Tendering Portal <https://mahatenders.gov.in> from 27.08.2026 @ 1800 Hrs. till 17.09.2026 @ 1600 Hrs. MMB reserves the right to accept or reject any or all of the bids, without assigning any reason whatsoever.

Sd/-
Chief Executive Officer,
Maharashtra Maritime Board, Mumbai.

Date: 27.08.2026
Place: Mumbai
DGIPR/2026-27/2561

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **Akhil Rastogi, S/o: Rajender Rastogi R/o: A-92 Jagdamba Colony Ambedkar Vihar Johripur Bhajanpura, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 402/2024, U/S: 281/125B/106(1) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023, PS: IP Estate, Delhi**, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Akhil Rastogi**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Akhil Rastogi**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Akhil Rastogi**, of **FIR No. 402/2024, U/S: 281/125B/106(1) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023, PS: IP Estate, Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **09.12.2026**.

By Order
Preeti
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
Room No. 150 (Now 205 New Building)
Tis Hazari Court, New Delhi

DP/12127/CD/2026 (Court Matter)

RANCHI MUNICIPAL CORPORATION

Kutchery, Ranchi 834001

Contact No. : 0651-2211215, Fax: 06512211777

email: support@ranchimunicipal.com, website: www.ranchimunicipal.com

Tender Reference No:- 921 Date:- 31/08/2026

Very Short Notice Inviting e-Tender

S. No	Information	Details
1	Particulars of the work	Development of green patches at various locations (Deen Dayal Chowk to Judge Colony through L P N Sahdeo Chowk, Pandra etc.) under Ranchi Municipal Corporation
2	Bid Validity days	180 Days
3	Period of Work (including maintenance)	One year
4	Location	Ranchi
5	Pin Code	834001
6	Pre Bid Meeting	05/09/2026 at 1:00 pm
7	Pre Bid Meeting Address	Office of Dy. Commissioner, Ranchi Municipal Corporation, Ranchi Office of Dy. Commissioner, Ranchi Municipal Corporation, Ranchi
8	Bid Opening Place	Ranchi
9	Approximate value of work	Rs 83,25,092.78
10	Tender Fee	Rs 10,000/- (+) 18% GST (Through online Payment gateway of jharkhandtenders.gov.in)
11	EMD Fee	Rs 1,70,000/- (Through online Payment gateway of jharkhandtenders.gov.in)
12	EMD Exemption Allowed	No
13	Tender Publishing Date on website (jharkhandtenders.gov.in)	01/09/2026
14	Bid Submission Start Date	01/09/2026
15	Bid Submission End Date	15/09/2026 till 3.00 pm
16	Bid Opening Date	16/09/2026 after 3.00 pm
17	Inviting Officer	Ranchi Municipal Corporation
18	Inviting Officer Address /email :	Ranchi Municipal Corporation, Kutchery, Ranchi - 834001 email: support@ranchimunicipal.com

NOTE:-

1. Tender Fee and Earnest money deposit (EMD) is to be paid through online mode as per instruction of IT Dept. Govt. of Jharkhand letter no 120 dated 03.10.2023.

2. For further information please visit website:- jharkhandtenders.gov.in & www.ranchimunicipal.com

Sd/-
PR 388697 Ranchi Municipal Corporation(26-27)#D Dy. Municipal Commissioner, Ranchi Municipal Corporation, Ranchi.

ROYAL STARS

BY GEORGIA NICOLS

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): This is a poor day to achieve anything of substance at home or when dealing with family members. No matter what you suggest (or even what others suggest), it will probably fall flat. In the meantime, just work hard today. Tonight: Check your possessions.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): Today the Moon is in your sign at odds with Pluto, which can make you compulsive and impulsive. As a result, emotional power struggles with others, especially authority figures, are likely. Instead, perhaps seek pleasure in socialising. Tonight: You win.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): This is a poor day for discussions about purchases, possessions and money issues with a friend or a group. Nobody will agree. Also, steer clear of controversial issues, because this is a touchy day for everyone. Tonight: Enjoy solitude.

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): This is a challenging day for you, no question. Mars is in your sign, and today it's at odds with stern Saturn. Proceed slowly and cautiously. Obstacles, even a sense of fear or inadequacy, might prevent you from being effective. Tonight: Be friendly.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): You have a strong focus on money right now and, of course, lucky Jupiter is in your sign. Nevertheless, relations with parents, bosses and authority figures might be challenging today because of impulsive or compulsive actions. Tonight: You're admired.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): You need to have less expectations when it comes to the cooperation of friends and groups. Avoid controversial subjects. They will quickly escalate into power struggles. Tonight: Explore and learn.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): This is a poor day to ask for permission or approval. It will be tough to get the cooperation of authority figures. In addition to which, you might find that you're lacking the confidence that you need. (This is a tough day for everyone), Tonight: Check your finances.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): Avoid touchy subjects. You'll find that discussions with partners, spouses and close friends are too emotional. Tonight: Cooperate.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): Squabbles about shared responsibilities, and property are likely today. Quarrels over expenses related to social outings or vacations might also arise. Tonight: Work to get better organized.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): Discussions with partners, spouses and close friends will be challenged today for emotional reasons. People will change their mind. They will refuse to go along with your suggestions. You might do likewise. Be patient with kids and romantic partners. Tonight: Socialise.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): This is a challenging day at work. Likewise, health challenges might arise today. On top of this, discussions at home and with family members will be difficult. Tonight: Relax at home.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): Romance will be challenged today, along with dealing with kids. Because your emotions are caught up in certain issues, you might insist on having your way or doing what you want. However, others will not agree. Tonight: An interesting conversation.

EX-SERVICEMEN CONTRIBUTORY HEALTH SCHEME (ECHS)

POLYCLINIC, BULANDSHAHR - EMPLOYMENT NOTICE

1. Stn HQ, Babugarh (Distt-Hapur) invites applications to engage following staff on contractual basis for ECHS Polyclinic, Bulandshahr for a period of eleven/twelve months, renewable for additional period as per policy :-

Post	Vacancies	Salary	Max Age	Vacarising in
Officer-in-Charge, Polyclinic	01	95,000/-	65 Years	Dec 26
Medical Specialist	01	1,30,000/-	70 Years	Already vacant
Medical Officer	02	95,000/-	68 Years	Jan 27
Dental Officer	01	95,000/-	65 Years	Jan 27
Nursing Assistant	01	36,500/-	58 Years	Mar 27
Pharmacist	01	36,500/-	58 Years	Mar 27
Chowkidar	01	21,800/-	55 Years	Dec 26
Safaiwala	01	21,800/-	55 Years	Mar 27

2. For terms & conditions, kindly visit our website www.echs.gov.in. For any other query, please contact tele No 0122-2338002 (Extn 2311)/7599426822 between 0900-1300Hr. Last date of receipt of application is **26 Sep 2026** at Stn HQ, Babugarh, Distt-Hapur (U.P.), Pin Code-245201. Applicants whose applications are complete will be called for interview. Interview will be conducted on **15 Oct 2026** at **1100 hrs**. Candidates should bring original certificates at the time of interview. All Medical Officers and Medical Specialists should produce a certificate stating that "I will not do any private practice after selection in ECHS Polyclinic Bulandshahr".

3. Candidates should enclose experience & salary certificates if any along with application and two passport size photographs. Medical/Para Medical candidates should have working knowledge of computers.

4. Medical fitness certificate from SEMO/CMO should be attached with the application.

5. **On Job Training (OJT):-** Medical Specialist, Medical Officer and Dental Officer will carry out 10 days On Job Training (OJT) and obtain a certificate from OIC Polyclinic before signing the contract.

6. With regard to remuneration, ESM can exercise option as per GoI, MoD letter No 22D(19)/2017-D(WE/Res-1)(I) dt 24 Jul 2025, 22D(19)/2017-D (WE/Res-1)(ii) dt 24 Jul 2025 and dt 18 Sep 2025.

RANCHI MUNICIPAL CORPORATION

Kutchery, Ranchi 834001

Contact No. : 0651-2211215, Fax: 06512211777

email: support@ranchimunicipal.com, website: www.ranchimunicipal.com

Tender Reference No:-922 Date:- 31/08/2026

Very Short Notice Inviting e-Tender

S.No	Information	Details
1	Particulars of the work	Development of Green patches at various locations of Sahajanand Chowk, Harmu, Argora Chowk, Birsra Chowk & Kadru etc. under Ranchi Municipal Corporation
2	Bid Validity days	180 Days
3	Period of Work (including maintenance)	One year
4	Location	Ranchi
5	Pin Code	834001
6	Pre Bid Meeting	05/09/2026 at 1:00 pm
7	Pre Bid Meeting Address	Office of Dy. Commissioner, Ranchi Municipal Corporation, Ranchi Office of Dy. Commissioner, Ranchi Municipal Corporation, Ranchi
8	Bid Opening Place	Office of Dy. Commissioner, Ranchi Municipal Corporation, Ranchi
9	Approximate value of work	Rs 60,48,586.34
10	Tender Fee	Rs 10,000/- (+) 18% GST (Through online Payment gateway of jharkhandtenders.gov.in)
11	EMD Fee	Rs 1,21,000/- (Through online Payment gateway of jharkhandtenders.gov.in)
12	EMD Exemption Allowed	No
13	Tender Publishing Date on website (jharkhandtenders.gov.in)	01/09/2026
14	Bid Submission Start Date	01/09/2026
15	Bid Submission End Date	15/09/2026 till 3.00 pm
16	Bid Opening Date	16/09/2026 after 3.00 pm
17	Inviting Officer	Ranchi Municipal Corporation
18	Inviting Officer Address/email:	Ranchi Municipal Corporation, Kutchery, Ranchi - 834001 email: support@ranchimunicipal.com

NOTE:-

1. Tender Fee and Earnest money deposit (EMD) is to be paid through online mode as per instruction of IT Dept. Govt. of Jharkhand letter no 120 dated 03.10.2023.

2. For further information please visit website:- jharkhandtenders.gov.in & www.ranchimunicipal.com

Sd/-
PR 388700 Ranchi Municipal Corporation(26-27)#D Dy. Municipal Commissioner, Ranchi Municipal Corporation, Ranchi.



With Diego Maradona at the 2010 World Cup. AP



The moment Messi won the World Cup. AP



Lifting the 2022 World Cup trophy in Qatar. REUTERS

MESSI MAGIC ENDS

Sandip G
New Delhi, August 31

IF WORDS could cry, Lionel Messi's emotionally-constructed retirement sentences, rather than a full-fledged speech, did. The lines were posted on Instagram, a platform that did not exist when he first wore the sky blue and white stripes of Argentina 21 years ago, and defined the shirt and its hallowed number - 10. The lines were somewhat platitudinal yet so powerful that the reader could visualise Messi uttering those words, with hollow, sunken eyes; words stuttering, breath choking, the suffocating silence of the long pauses, the shrill voice echoing in the room, the applause and tears, the chaos and uproar in the room, and the immeasurable emptiness. "Time is running short, chapters come to a close, and this is one that hurts me deeply," he wrote.

Emptiness strikes. It is not simply the power of words, but the power of Messi's persona. The audience doubt the authenticity of the news, a part of their mind is still inclined to believe that it's all a handiwork of an expert hacker; they reel in the belief that something more was left of him, an unseen trick or turn, a conviction that his talent hadn't quite reached its end point. It is the intimacy that Messi had forged between him and his legion of fans.

But reality would sink in. It's the day football lost not only its greatest (without any reasonable cause for argument), but its concept of perfection too, footballing pinnacle compressed in 1.70 metres of flesh, bones and intelligence.

More decorated geniuses have prowled the grandest stage; Pele, arguably Messi's lone equal, has won three World Cups; romantics would keep virtuosos, like Garrincha and Diego Maradona, closest to their hearts; the quantophiles would salivate over the dizzying numbers of Ronaldo. But none was as perfect as Messi — he was football's ideal state, a footballer that was the blend of science and art, one composed of the most fearful symmetry, one that made an era his timeline. He retires with a stack of perishable records — most goals, assists and appearances in the World Cup — and imperishable moments that make those landmarks look trivial. He takes with him a slice

Football loses part of its soul as legend calls time on Argentine career after failure to defend World Cup crown and death of his father Jorge



“ I leave with the peace and pride of having given you, along with my teammates, dream-like moments. It was incredible to have experienced it with you all. ”

LIONEL MESSI, IN HIS RETIREMENT POST



of the sport's soul.

Not totally unexpected

A day as this was inevitable. There were signs too. His legs were tired after the heartbreaking World Cup retention bid and his heart crushed by his father Jorge's death last month. Shortly after, he wrote in a statement: "All I ever did was play football, and now I have a fair few doubts as to whether I'll carry on doing it for much longer." He revealed the extent of physical pain he suffered in the World Cup. "My legs couldn't go on any more," he wrote. "This time I tried to push myself beyond my physical limits, but I couldn't."

The self-phasing-out had begun some years ago. He dropped from the elite realms of European football three years ago, resorting to the less exhausting grind of Major League Soccer, and now he has folded that he says he wore most passionately, more than perhaps his dearest red and purple of Barcelona. He wrote at the start of the statement: "I swear to you that I always gave it my all — not just in these last few years when we won everything, but before that too."

The reader could feel the imaginary emphasis on the last fragment of the line. "Before that too." A time when he won nothing with the national

team; when his heart for his country was doubted; when he felt disillusioned and retired; a time when he, as former manager Jorge Sampaoli once said, "played with a revolver on his head"; when his was the heaviest burden in football.

Indian summer

The time after nearly did not arrive, but for the coaxing of incumbent manager Lionel Scaloni and his assistant Pablo Aimar. But the time did arrive. The last chapter, raging against the dying light, was his most glorious for the country. In eight years, he tasted success he thought he never would. He won a brace of COPA titles, real-

ised the dream of winning the World Cup, could have pulled off another, scored more goals in the World Cup's last two editions than in his first four episodes, and won a place next to Maradona in his country.

His relationship with his country was never straightforward, not so much for him as for the fans. Messi was passionate about playing for Argentina — and only his country, brushing aside advances from Spain. But the needle of suspicion hovered. Whether he was Argentine enough; whether his Spanish accent was less Argentine Spanish; whether his loyalties lay more with the club or the country. Every appear-

ance was a test of patriotism. Messi gave it his all, under different managers and with varied teammates. Every failure was a vindication that he was less Argentine. And every victory a test passed.

His most gratifying World Cup could be the 2022 instalment, but his most enjoyable could be the 2026 version — until the final step — when he played with a blithe spirit, liberated from the burdens of the past, without the shadow of Maradona swallowing him, when he was just himself. A chapter has ended in Messi's career, and an era in international football, leaving the world and the words to cry.

East Zone squander Sooryavanshi's 92, losing 10 for 105

Shankar Narayan
Mumbai, August 31

BEFORE THE final ball of the 18th over, Mukesh Kumar walked up to Mohammed Shami. Stumps were approaching, Rajat Patidar and Aman Mokhadde were looking to see out the day, and Sudip Gharami stood at silly point.

Whatever was discussed worked immediately.

Mukesh banged the ball in, much like the delivery with which he had dismissed Patidar in the first innings. This one was straighter, cramping the Central Zone captain for room as he tried to guide it towards third man. The ball took the inside edge and crashed into the stumps. Patidar was gone for 5, Central were 37 for 3, and Mukesh walked over to Shami after-ward and tried to touch his feet. It was a fitting late twist to a day on which neither side managed to hold control for long.

After East Zone were bowled out for 266, leaving the first-innings scores level, Mukesh and Abhijit Sarkar put Central under pressure. Their disciplined opening spells gave the batsmen little room to score, before Mukesh drew Kunal Chandel forward and found his outside edge for two.

Shami replaced Sarkar in the eighth over and kept up the pressure. His seam movement accounted for Aryan Juyal, caught in the slips, before Mukesh returned to remove Patidar. He almost had Mokhadde too, when the opener was given lbw, only for a review to show the ball missing the stumps.

Mokhadde survived to reach 23 not out, but at 45 for 3 after 20 overs, Central ended the day only 45 runs ahead.

Earlier, at 161 for 0, East were well and truly on top, threatening to take full control of the game. Vaibhav Sooryavanshi had dismantled Central's attack. His 92 off 81 balls had left Central searching for answers. The 15-year-old went after Yash Thakur from the outset, driving him through cover and straight down the ground before lofting him over his head for six.

Spin didn't slow him down either. Dropped on 40, after Saransh Jain deceived him in flight, Sooryavanshi stayed on the attack, reaching fifty in 42 balls to become the youngest batsman to score a Duleep Trophy fifty.

Dubey finally opened the door. Sooryavanshi tried to clear the fielder at deep mid-wicket but picked out Arshad Khan. The next delivery brought another wicket, Kumar Kushagra edging to Mokhadde at gully. East still went to lunch at 183 for 2, but Central finally had something to work with.

After lunch, Aryan Pandey kicked the door wide open.

The Madhya Pradesh seamer found better rhythm and kept attacking a good length. Easwaran, who offered little, was trapped for 69 by one that cut back sharply. Patidar reviewed a subdued appeal, and ball-tracking returned three reds.

Pandey then found Virat Singh's outside edge as the left-hander tried to drive, before re-



Vaibhav Sooryavanshi scored 92 runs in 81 balls. PTI

moving Sudip Gharami a few balls later. The ball angled in before straightening off the seam to take Gharami's edge. In around 15 minutes, East had slipped to 213 for 5.

At the other end, Dubey complemented the pacer and kept Central on top. The left-arm spinner settled into a probing spell, repeatedly landing the ball on a testing length and making the batsmen play.

That control mattered after the morning's carnage. East had attacked almost at will during the opening stand, but Dubey steadily squeezed the scoring. From around the wicket, he found enough turn, while his fuller deliveries outside off and around the stumps kept the batsmen guessing. Central built pressure from both ends, making it difficult to rotate strike or find boundaries.

The rewards followed. After taking two wickets before lunch, Dubey returned to remove Anukul Roy, stumped for 16 as East attempted a rebuild. He then dismissed Abhijit Sarkar after tea, finishing with 4 for 66 from 16 overs. Yash Thakur's day followed a different path. His first spell was expensive and erratic, Sooryavanshi punishing his width and short balls. But he recovered once Central fought their way back.

Thakur removed captain Ishan Kishan for 16, when the left-hander tried to cut without enough room and edged to Kunal Chandel at slip. He then used the short ball to dismiss Kounain Quaraishi, before taking the final wicket. From 161 for 0, East lost all ten wickets for 105 runs and could only match Central's 266. Sooryavanshi's dismissal opened the door, Pandey's removal of Easwaran kicked it wide open, and Dubey's sustained control, along with Thakur's recovery, completed the turnaround.

BRIEF SCORES: Central Zone 266 and 45 for 3 in 20 overs (Aman Mokhadde 23 not out; Mukesh Kumar 2/14, Mohammed Shami 1/13) lead East Zone 266 all out in 57 overs (Vaibhav Sooryavanshi 92, Abhimanyu Easwaran 69, Harsh Dubey 4/66, Aryan Pandey 3/43, Yash Thakur 3/66) by 45 runs. AT COE GROUND 2: North Zone 195 trail South Zone 285 for 9 in 94 overs (Tilak Varma 106 not out, Shreyas Gopal 87; Gurnoor Brar 4/70) by 90 runs.

NEW GROUND

Three Maharashtra wrestlers seal U23 Women's Worlds berths for first time

Prithish Raj
New Delhi, August 31

FOR THE first time in the nine-year history of the U23 Wrestling World Championships, the Indian women's squad will have three wrestlers from Maharashtra.

In a sport usually dominated by Haryana, Ahilya Shinde (55 kg), Vaishnavi Patil (65 kg) and Amruta Pujari (72 kg) won their respective trials at the KD Jadhav Indoor Stadium to book their berths for the U23 Worlds set to be held in Las Vegas, USA from October 12 to 18.

"It is heartening to see three girls from Maharashtra in the team. When I qualified for the Senior Worlds last year, I was the only one on the team," said Vaishnavi, who played at the senior World Championships in 2025.

Facing Anjali of Haryana in the final of the trial, Vaishnavi fell behind 0-2 after the Ha-

ryana wrestler pushed her out twice. She took down Anjali before the first half ended to make it 2-2.

In the second half of the bout, Vaishnavi scored four points after she threw Anjali on the mat to make 6-2. After that big move, she earned two more points for exposure to lead 8-2.

Anjali again pushed her out to make it 3-8 before producing a late surge in the dying seconds. Vaishnavi only conceded two points and eventually won the trial 9-5 due to her immaculate defence.

"The learnings of World Championships have helped me. I have worked on my stability after coming back from the World championships," said Vaishnavi.

Rising star

Ahilya, 19, who has won gold and bronze at the U17 and U23 Asian Championships, will be going to her first-ever Worlds. "I am very excited that

this is going to be my first-ever World Championships. Everybody in the family is also excited about this," quipped Ahilya.

The teenager took to the sport after watching her father and uncle wrestle on mud, and trains at Banage village in Kolhapur. She has been progressing well through the age-group level.

On Monday, Ahilya overcame Kajal of Haryana in a tight final bout.

In the 72 kg category, Amruta avoided a late surge from Tanu Sharma to book her spot. When Amruta was leading 8-4, Tanu took two points after taking her down and attempted two more before she ran out of time and breath.

Amruta, who won back-to-back Maharashtra Kesari titles, became the first wrestler from Maharashtra to feature in the heavyweight category. The Pune grappler will be India's representative in the 72



Ahilya Shinde, Vaishnavi Patil and Amruta Pujari. EXPRESS

kg category.

"It is always too tough at the national level. We have such good competition there and I am happy to overcome this field today," said Amruta.

While Vaishnavi has done all her training at Sushil akhada in Hisar, Haryana under coach Jasbeer, Ahilya and Amruta train at two different centres in Kolhapur district of

“ The girls who have played against these wrestlers in state championships or who spar with them on a daily basis can believe that they can also do it. Apart from the wrestlers, it also inspires the coaches at taluka and village levels to work harder ”

DADASO SOPAN LAVATE,
COACH AT SAI KOLHAPUR CENTRE

Maharashtra.

Rough transition

Rushi Shinde, uncle of Ahilya and a former wrestler, laments the bumpy transition from mud to mat.

"Mud wrestling is big in Maharashtra but what next for the

wrestlers? Mat wrestling provides a pathway for the wrestlers to bring glory for the nation," he told *The Indian Express*. "I did mud wrestling and so did Ahilya's father Shatrughn but when she took up wrestling, we wanted her to do it on mat and represent India at the global level," he added further.

Dadaso Sopan Lavate, known to his students at SAI Kolhapur centre as Dada Lavate, explains the impact of having multiple wrestlers from Maharashtra at the global level.

"I have been coaching for more than a decade and it is good to have three girls from Maharashtra for a major event like the U23 World Championships," he told this paper.

Dadaso, whose ward Nandini Salokhe broke the Haryana stranglehold in the 53 kg category back at 2021 Nationals, believes that more and more exposure will inspire the wrestlers and coaches alike.

"The girls who have played

against these wrestlers in state championships or who spar with them on a daily basis can believe that they can also do it. Apart from the wrestlers, it also inspires the coaches at taluka and village levels to work harder," said Dadaso.

However, he believes that the transition from age group to senior level needs to be smoother. "The wrestlers from Maharashtra are doing well at the age-group level but the transition needs to be smooth from U20 to U23 and senior level. We need to work more on the strength and conditioning of these wrestlers and that will help them become physically strong," said Dadaso.

WOMEN'S WRESTLING TEAM FOR U23 WORLD CHAMPIONSHIPS: Parveen (50kg), Sweetie (53kg), Ahilya Shinde (55kg), Neha Sharma (57kg), Neha (62kg), Vaishnavi Patil (65kg), Mansi Lather (68kg), Amruta Pujari (72kg), Diksha Malik (76kg)

